

IN THE DISTRICT COURT OF APPEAL OF THE STATE OF FLORIDA SECOND DISTRICT

IN RE: THE MARRIAGE OF

SARAH HANSON, Petitioner/Appellee/Wife,

And

CHRISTOPHER HANSON, Respondent/Appellant/Husband.

Case No.: 2D2025-1936 Lower Tribunal No.: 24-DR-001150

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NOTICE OF RELATED CASES

Pursuant to Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.545(d), Appellant Christopher Hanson hereby notifies the Court and all parties of the following related cases. These matters involve common issues of law and fact, overlapping parties, and interconnected acts in support of insider protectionism amounting to systemic corruption, judicial bias, attorney misconduct, and violations of constitutionally mandated transparency, all stemming from a single issue in the underlying Family Law matter.

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1. The issues pending before the Second DCA relate specifically to the core dispute between the parties – Husband’s consistent pursuit of financial discovery on marital income Wife concealed

during and after the marriage and Wife's objective of avoiding that very reasonable and necessary discovery to accomplish concealment of marital assets in violation of basic Florida jurisprudence. (See Certiorari Petition, Case No. 2D2025-0681).

2. In the related Case No. 2D2025-0681, Appellant (Petitioner in that action) seeks review of the lower court's denial of enforcement of mandatory disclosure and contempt for non-production of financial records, allowing months of non-compliance and a deceptively worded certificate of compliance that on its face fails to swear to the requirements under Fla. Fam. L. R. P. 12.285.

3. The 13th Circuit Court's actions—openly acting against Husband in not only excusing all of Attorney Davis's intentional discovery and ethical violations but also advancing his deceitful attempt to avoid compliance with mandatory disclosures—demonstrate extreme bias. This bias is at the heart of the sole issue Husband has consistently pursued: ensuring the imperative discovery to reach a fair and efficient result.

4. The related cases and their handling illuminate systemic corruption activated at multiple levels to continue the cover-up, protecting the core misconduct involving Judge Ayers and Attorney Davis, as others join the conspiracy to protect a growing number of peers from accountability.

5. The violations and consistent avoidance of Husband's core allegations at multiple levels and institutions for over a year represent a shocking willingness to commit new ethical violations to ignore gross misconduct from attorneys and judges.

6. The facts in the Exhibits attached to the lower tribunal filings and throughout the records in these cases illustrate an expanding conspiracy to avoid the accountability for Judicial insiders necessary to restore confidence in the Judiciary. Appellant will provide all records across the litigation if requested.

I. IDENTIFICATION OF RELATED CASES

• **24-DR-001150 (Family Law Case, Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, Hillsborough County):** The underlying dissolution of marriage proceeding involving allegations of judicial bias, evidence suppression, and attorney misconduct. It is the nexus for all related actions, with shared evidence of concealment and resulting ethical violations from protecting Attorney Davis (and now a growing list of Judges).

• **25-CA-010255 (Mandamus Suit, Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, Hillsborough County):** A mandamus action filed by Appellant seeking compliance with basic public records requests aimed at uncovering further evidence of the judicial misconduct that has caused over a year of unnecessary litigation and damage. The 13th Circuit Court has "circled the wagons," in violation of constitutional transparency requirements, to protect insiders from accountability irrespective of the damage it causes Husband and to the credibility of the Court system. It shares factual overlap regarding attorney and judicial misconduct involving multiple actors within the Thirteenth Circuit and requires transfer to a neutral venue (as argued in the instant Venue Appeal).

• **2D2025-0681 (Certiorari Petition, Second District Court of Appeal):** This petition challenges the trial court's specific orders denying enforcement of mandatory disclosure and refusing to sanction Attorney Scott Davis for concealing financial assets. It documents the specific judicial acts of "fixing" the case that necessitate the venue transfer sought in the instant appeal.

• **2025-CA-002469 (Mandamus/Declaratory Relief, Second Judicial Circuit, Leon County):** This recently filed action against The Florida Bar and its officers seeks access to records and reopening of a Bar complaint against attorney Scott Paul Davis for misconduct in the underlying family law case. It addresses Bar failures in investigating ethics violations, communicating with

the complainant, and refusals to comply with constitutional transparency requirements tied to this matter. The facts alleged in that Petition illustrate the involvement of the Florida Bar in obvious efforts to protect Davis and other insiders from accountability at the expense of litigants and Public Confidence in the Judiciary.

II. COMMON ISSUES OF FACT AND LAW SUPPORTING VENUE TRANSFER

A. INSTITUTIONAL CORRUPTION WITHIN THE 13TH CIRCUIT

7. The Thirteenth Judicial Circuit has abandoned its constitutional duty of transparency, engaging in a deliberate pattern of concealment and obstruction, in efforts to protect Judge Ayers and Attorney Davis's long history of severe bias, misconduct, and fixing the case against Appellant in these proceedings, by suppressing the discoverable evidence of marital assets at the core of the dispute. (See Fla. Const. art. I, § 24).

8. Despite multiple targeted requests for records and the requirements in Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution and Rule 2.420, the Circuit actively and deceitfully concealed critical communications, hearing videos, and recusal documents (specifically regarding Judge DePaul).

9. Instead, the Circuit buried the truth under mountains of irrelevant paperwork ("document dumping") while ignoring targeted inquiries about the deceitful tactics and concealing the requested information required under the Florida Constitution.

10. No affidavits, no explanations, no lawful exemptions—just silence and delay.

11. These tactics are not accidental; they are calculated to shield judges and court insiders from accountability for egregious misconduct, including bias, suppression of financial evidence, and enabling retaliatory litigation.

B. INSTITUTIONAL CORRUPTION AT THE FLORIDA BAR

12. Presented with unrefuted evidence of attorney Scott Davis's misconduct—delays, obstruction, and child weaponization—the Florida Bar dismissed the complaint without investigation, without explanation, and without transparency.

13. When pressed for records, the Bar produced a token response, omitting substantive communications and refusing to answer basic questions about its handling of the case.

14. No privilege log, no confirmation of searches, no engagement with the complainant as required by its own rules. This secrecy is not benign; it is a deliberate strategy to protect powerful actors and perpetuate a culture of impunity.

15. The Florida Bar, entrusted with safeguarding ethical standards, has instead become a fortress for insiders, lacking and openly shirking the oversight and transparency necessary for public confidence in the Judiciary.

16. Urgent action is necessary to restore order, fairness, and good faith to the Florida Bar's operation.

**RELEVANT CASE LAW ON ABUSES IN DOCUMENT PRODUCTION DEMAND
TIMELY ACTION – RELIEF FOR APPELLANT AND CONSEQUENCES FOR THOSE
IN THE FLORIDA BAR AND 13TH CIRCUIT GUILTY OF MISCONDUCT**

17. Florida courts have repeatedly condemned discovery abuses like concealment, obfuscation, and bad faith non-compliance, demanding severe consequences to deter systemic corruption and restore judicial integrity—standards that must apply equally, if not more stringently, to institutions like the 13th Circuit and The Florida Bar, which are held to the same ethical and constitutional duties as attorneys and judges.

18. Why should Circuit Court systems avoid any scrutiny or consequences when they engage in this same type of misconduct when responding to document requests mandated under the Florida Constitution?

19. Especially given the responsibility entrusted to the Courts to handle disciplinary matters within the Judiciary, the constitutional requirements on transparency, and the allegations of severe and widespread bias and corruption herein, this Court must hold these other institutions accused of intentionally concealing evidence of insider misconduct accountable with full investigations and appropriate sanctions.

20. In *ICMfg & Assoc., Inc. v. Bare Board Grp., Inc.*, 238 So. 3d 326 (Fla. 2d DCA 2017), this Court affirmed dismissal for intentional concealment and alteration of evidence, holding:

"Dismissal affirmed where parties intentionally concealed and altered evidence central to the issues in the litigation and repeatedly and willfully violated their discovery obligations."

21. The bias, corruption, and the Court's and Bar's concealment of evidence supporting the allegations are at the center of all of the related cases and the present one before this Court. Yet, in all of the related cases, Judicial officials have kept a blind eye on these salient facts demonstrating such severe concerns undermining confidence in the judiciary. Why should Judicial institutions get a pass when they engage in such bad faith conduct?

22. The 13th Circuit's "document dumping" of unrequested materials while concealing requested hearing records mirrors this willful violation, demanding similar harsh oversight to prevent institutional evasion.

23. Similarly, in *Ramey v. Haverty Furniture Cos. Inc.*, 993 So. 2d 1014 (Fla. 2d DCA 2008), this Court affirmed dismissal for fraudulent concealment, criticizing "unconscionable schemes" that hamper fair adjudication. The Florida Bar's token responses omitting key communications

with Davis constitute such a scheme, warranting sanctions and investigations to enforce transparency.

24. The Florida Supreme Court in *Bainter v. League of Women Voters of Fla.*, 150 So. 3d 1115 (Fla. 2014), strongly condemned obfuscation and delay in discovery, stating: "Courts should not countenance or tolerate actions during litigation that are not forthright and that are designed to delay and obfuscate the discovery process." Why would it be ok for Courts themselves to act in manners that are designed to obfuscate the discovery process and violate constitutional transparency requirements, especially in a case where there is a long history of severe judicial bias and corruption allegations?

25. Both the 13th Circuit's silence on concealment accusations and the Bar's refusal to engage with requests for Davis correspondence align with this, demanding certiorari and mandamus relief and accountability to uphold constitutional mandates.

26. In *Mercer v. Raine*, 443 So. 2d 944 (Fla. 1983), the Court condemned bad faith disregard, ruling severe sanctions apply for "deliberate callousness." Institutions must face equivalent consequences, as their failures also demonstrate willful violation of constitutional mandates—here, the 13th Circuit's and Bar's undisputed obstructions demand referrals for discipline and investigations.

SUMMARY OF THE RELATED CASES' COMMON FOUNDATION AND REQUESTS FOR RELIEF IN THE PRESENT CASE

27. The undisputed facts across these cases reveal a web of misconduct that has inflicted irreparable harm on Husband and his children, demanding immediate intervention to enforce discovery, impose sanctions, and initiate investigations.

28. When intentionally concealing information, institutions always have a motive, generally one that directly opposes that of the Requestor. In this case, that's Husband who has diligently pursued all litigation options available to ensure a fair result as multiple officials and institutions simply avoid the difficult reality that sometimes insiders commit misconduct so severe that it demands uncomfortable consequences to uphold the rule of law.

29. Given the facts of this case, it is unmistakably clear that these powerful judicial bodies are intentionally violating their constitutional duties to protect insiders from accountability for a long history of misconduct, specifically directed to Husband's detriment.

30. The totality of these circumstances and facts that demonstrate the misconduct and damage to Husband fills the dockets of these related cases and any and all information can be provided across institutions and venues upon request.

31. It is imperative to provide timely relief necessary to minimize damage to Husband and the children, and to ensure accountability for insiders and restore public confidence in the judiciary.

32. Additionally, Appellant submits that the following is necessary given the levels of misconduct throughout these related cases:

- This Court push the core discovery issue forward expeditiously under Fla. Fam. L. R. P. 12.285, compelling full production of concealed marital assets with contempt findings for non-compliance, awarding attorney's fees, costs, and stripping Wife of any objections to Husband's request for financial discovery.

- Refer Judge Ayers and attorney Davis for formal disciplinary proceedings by The Florida Bar and JQC for bias, suppression, and ethical violations under Rules Regulating The Florida Bar 4-3.4 and Code of Judicial Conduct Canon 3.

◦ Order independent investigations into the 13th Circuit, Florida Bar, and JQC for their roles in the cover-up, including transparency violations and non-responses, to restore public confidence (Article I, § 24, Fla. Const.). These actions are essential to halt the tyranny and ensure justice.

33. The following offers a very limited picture of just some of the underlying chain of misconduct the 13th Circuit and the Florida Bar wish to ignore, but desperately requiring action.

BRIEF REVIEW OF THE UNDERLYING MISCONDUCT INVOLVING DAVIS AND AYERS, CATALYST FOR THE INSIDER PROTECTIONISM AND SYSTEMIC CORRUPTION DESCRIBED ABOVE

34. The scope of the misconduct involving Davis, Judge Ayers, the 13th Circuit, and the Florida Bar is so broad that review of multiple documents across the litigation is necessary to have a complete understanding of how broad and invasive these concerns have grown.

35. However, a brief review of some of the core facts at various stages of the litigation and cover-up attempts illustrates how the corruption and misconduct spread, making the continuing cover-up efforts worse and more harmful than the underlying misconduct as they raise real questions about whether the Florida Judiciary is willing and able to hold insiders accountable for gross misconduct at the expense of litigants.

36. The litigation stems directly from attorney Scott Paul Davis's (Wife's counsel) bad faith concealment and suppression of financial discovery, violating mandatory disclosure under Fla. Fam. L. R. P. 12.285 and refusing to produce responsive documents even for Requests for Production for which he has offered no objection.

37. Davis delayed any attempt at compliance/production for four months after a June 28, 2024 stipulated deadline for production, making no effort to produce documents or explain the delays until October 22, 2024, just before a hearing on the issue.

38. By March 17, 2025, Davis committed over a dozen clear and undisputed discovery and ethical violations, including blanket objections, non-responses to requests, and strategic trickling of documents to evade enforcement and conceal discoverable marital assets at the core of the parties' dispute.

39. When the delay and obstruction tactics failed to deter Husband's discovery efforts, Davis escalated with retaliatory tactics: filing an amended petition for primary custody to create a bargaining chip for use in ending discovery efforts.

40. He then attacked, suddenly openly weaponizing the children with four motions (despite filing none during the first several months of litigation) on December 13, 2024—the day Husband's counsel withdrew.

JUDGE AYERS'S MISCONDUCT IN COVERING UP DAVIS'S ETHICAL VIOLATIONS WHILE ASSISTING TO SUPPRESS EVIDENCE

41. Judge Ayers actively assisted Davis with his tactics delaying resolution and requiring all the litigation in these related cases as she denied enforcement of mandatory disclosure and contempt findings, and suppressed scrutiny of misconduct, rendering case progress impossible.

42. With respect to the December 13, 2024 hearing, Judge Ayers grossly violated Husband's due process rights by rushing the hearing on his attorney's request to withdraw (despite its lacking any good faith basis) over his objection and unavailability for the hearing on a single day's notice.

43. Ayers excused Davis's absence from the January 9, 2025 hearing—where his misconduct was central to the issues before the Court, again violating Husband's due process.

44. Ayers manifested bias by assisting concealment: ignoring ethical violations under Rules Regulating The Florida Bar 4-3.4, suppressing financial evidence central to equitable distribution, and enabling child weaponization to thwart discovery.

45. The misconduct from Davis in the underlying case has continued to expand (based on the lack of accountability) as described in the Exhibits below as those in charge of handling such misconduct have joined or at least worked to cover up the corrupt and unethical schemes of Davis rather than do what's necessary under the facts and law.

THE ATTORNEY AND JUDICIAL MISCONDUCT IS OBVIOUS, HARMFUL, AND INTENTIONAL, SUGGESTING AYERS AND DAVIS BELIEVE THEY ARE SIMPLY ABOVE THE LAW OR AT LEAST ABOVE ACCOUNTABILITY FOR VIOLATIONS

46. No reasonable attorney or Judge could look through the dockets of these related cases or even just the attachments below and believe that Husband has received a fair process.

47. There are multiple layers of attorneys and Judges guilty of misconduct that demonstrate deep failures within the Judiciary's ability to handle disciplinary matters internally.

48. Husband pleads with this Court for timely action to begin restoring due process and honesty as critical principles under Florida Law.

VERIFICATION

I, Christopher Hanson, certify that I have read the foregoing Notice of Related Cases, and that the facts stated herein are true and correct to the best of my knowledge and belief. I make this verification under penalty of perjury pursuant to Section 92.525, Florida Statutes. Executed on this 11th day of January, 2026.

/s/ Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson Self-Represented Appellant
cahanson77@yahoo.com

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I HEREBY CERTIFY that a true and correct copy of the foregoing Notice of Related Cases has been furnished via the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal and served through the Portal's e-service system on this 11th day of January, 2026.

Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson

Self-Represented Appellant

**IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT IN AND FOR
HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA**

CASE NO.: [To be assigned]

DIVISION: [Civil, as appropriate]

CHRISTOPHER HANSON, as attorney and next friend for his minor children [7 years old]
and [6 years old], Plaintiffs,

v.

THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT COURT,

CLERK OF THE COURT FOR THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT,

CHIEF JUDGE CHRISTOPHER C. SABELLA,

JUDGE KELLY AYERS,

GINA JUSTICE (Court Administrator),

MIKE MOORE,

**VERIFIED PETITION/COMPLAINT FOR WRIT OF MANDAMUS, DECLARATORY RELIEF,
AND ATTORNEY'S FEES**

I. Introduction and Parties:

1. This is an action under Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, to enforce the constitutional and statutory right of access to public records, brought by Christopher Hanson as attorney and next friend for his minor children [6] and [7].
2. Plaintiff seeks a writ of mandamus compelling the production of public records unlawfully withheld by the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit and its officers. These records relate to judicial bias, corruption, and misconduct in the underlying family law case involving attorneys on both sides and the bench itself, (24-DR-001150), directly impacting the children's welfare.
3. Plaintiff also seeks declaratory relief and attorney's fees under §119.12, Florida Statutes and any other basis under the law including both statutory, regulatory, and common law grounds.

II. Jurisdiction and Venue

4. This Court has jurisdiction under Article V, §5 of the Florida Constitution and §26.012, Florida Statutes.
5. Venue (prior to the Court's consideration of the corruption and conflicts involved) is proper in Hillsborough County under §47.011, Florida Statutes, because the defendants reside here and the cause of action primarily accrued here.

III. Parties

6. Plaintiff Christopher Hanson is a licensed Florida attorney acting on his own behalf and acting as attorney and next friend for his minor children, who are residents of Florida and have a direct interest in the requested public records under Chapter 119, as they pertain to their welfare in the underlying family law case.
7. Defendant Thirteenth Judicial Circuit Court is a public agency subject to Chapter 119 responsible for maintaining and disclosing judicial records with custodial duties over the records per Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420.
8. Defendant Clerk of the Court for the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit is the entity responsible for custodial duties over judicial records under Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420.
9. Defendant Chief Judge Sabella of the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, a public officer subject to Chapter 119 who oversees administrative operations, including records management.
10. Defendant Judge Kelly Ayers is a judge in the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit and a public officer subject to Chapter 119, with potential custodial responsibilities over relevant communications and records.
11. This is an action under Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, to enforce the constitutional and statutory right of access to public records, brought by Christopher Hanson as attorney and next friend for his minor children [6] and [7].
12. Plaintiff seeks a writ of mandamus compelling the production of public records unlawfully withheld by the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit and its officers. These records relate to judicial bias, corruption, and misconduct in the underlying family law case involving attorneys on both sides and the bench itself, (24-DR-001150), directly impacting the children's welfare.
13. Plaintiff also seeks declaratory relief and attorney's fees under §119.12, Florida Statutes and any other basis under the law including both statutory, regulatory, and common law grounds.

IV. Relevant Facts:

14. Plaintiff submitted multiple requests for records including several formal letters (Exhibit Composite, filed separate, "EC" pp. 3-10) to the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit between July 24, 2025 and September 4, 2025, seeking access to:
 - Judicial disqualification and recusal records and associated documents and communications
 - Administrative and all other communications regarding the GAL issue including Judge Ayers request for a summary and Husband's objection to excusing him from drafting the summary.
 - Transcripts and filings referenced in public proceedings
 - Email and text communications of Judges Kelly Ayers and Wendy DePaul and their judicial assistants related to this case including those related to scheduling and objections,
 - Visual and audio recordings of specified hearings
15. Despite statutory deadlines, consistent immediate action from Husband given the urgency of the situation, and persistent follow-up correspondence, Defendants failed to produce the requested records, provide a lawful justification, or even respond at all to several questions and additional correspondence.
16. Plaintiff received partial responses and purported justification for withholding relevant records from Gina Justice, Court Administrator, dated August 21, September 4, and September 8, 2025, acknowledging the existence of responsive records, but asserting exemptions and requiring payment for access.
17. These responses were inadequate and failed to address key concerns.
18. The September 8, 2025 response specifically denied access to the April 4, 2025 video recording on grounds of confidentiality under Fla. R. Admin. 2.420(c)(8) and §119.071(3)(a), F.S., despite the video being offered on the record by Judge Ayers during the hearing, raising concerns about inconsistent treatment and potential concealment.
19. Plaintiff has exhausted all informal remedies and administrative channels, including follow-ups on August 26, August 31, September 9, September 12, September 24, and October 9, 2025. Defendants never responded to any of the follow up requests for documents or explanations from September 9, 2025 forward besides an email from Moore acknowledging receipt and ensuring processing in a "reasonable" time).

20. Four weeks have passed since that last flimsy attempt at feigning compliance, constituting constructive denial and evidence of bad faith. Specific failures include:

- No response to requests for affidavits describing search methods, including which devices were searched (e.g., personal devices under §119.011(12), F.S.) to confirm completeness.
- No explanation for the lack of any communications regarding the hearings on December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025, which raise concerns about irregular proceedings and potential concealment given the existence of emails surrounding less controversial
- No clarification on how "security" video exists only for the April 4, 2025 hearing (Docket #198), whether the camera recording that footage is part of an actual security system, and why no similar footage exists for other relevant hearings or cases.
- Refusal to provide any information by email, despite repeated requests, leading to inefficiencies such as Plaintiff's September emails and the Court's September 4, 2025 letter crossing in the mail. This reliance on U.S. Mail appears deliberate to delay access and violates the intent of Chapter 119 for prompt, efficient disclosure.
- No written explanations with specific statutory citations for any withholdings even with the detailed questions posed.

21. Defendants' complete non-response to these specific concerns and requests, combined with the partial responses (raising significant concerns about strategic withholding/concealment of specific materials of relevance), provides further evidence of bias, bad faith, and a pattern where 13th Circuit "Clubhouse" members are circling the wagons to protect fellow members, in significant violation of Florida Public Records law.

22. This obstruction has caused ongoing harm to Plaintiff and his family. The October 9, 2025 email (Exhibit F, pp. 19–23) explicitly stated: "The ongoing and intentional concealment of evidence critical to my case... is causing ongoing and increasing damage to my children and my health. I do not believe there's any good faith basis to conceal the evidence identified nor even offer any clarification regarding the video evidence. I have real concerns about the veracity of some of the representations and the court's failure to even confirm devices searched." (EC pp. 19–23)

23. Defendants' failure to respond since their September 8, 2025 letter aside from the form response, demonstrates active concealment and bad faith, particularly in light

of the pre-suit notice under §119.12(1)(b), F.S., and the problem with fraud and dishonesty in the underlying case.

24. The Thirteenth Judicial Circuit is acting in bad faith, as evidenced by the deliberate pattern of delays, non-responses, and incomplete disclosures that seem to protect Judge Ayers in concealing extensive evidence that could cause her embarrassment and likely more significant discipline.
25. The singular issue in the underlying case (24-DR-001150) Husband's discovery efforts given Wife's concealment of marital assets at the time the parties entered a post marital agreement without counsel.
26. Judge Ayers actively assisted Wife and her attorney's obstruction strategies, suppressed evidence of obvious ethical misconduct from multiple attorneys, all to Husband's detriment, and actively sought to advance Wife's clearly retaliatory litigation (e.g., Exhibit G, pp. 24–82, detailing procedural irregularities, suppression of discovery, and failure to address ethical violations).

V. Legal Basis for Relief

27. Under Article I, §24 of the Florida Constitution and Chapter 119, public records are presumed open. (See also *Woodard v. State*, 885 So. 2d 444 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004)).
28. The public records law is a critical tool that offers citizens a check on state corruption, and it's critical the Court system act efficiently in allowing this statutorily mandated tool to function as intended.
29. Defendants' failure to produce records and respond to clarifications violates §119.07 and entitles Plaintiff to mandamus relief. The asserted exemptions are invalid or overly broad under §119.07(1)(d), as no specific statutory basis was provided that fits with the facts and documents at issue. (*Town of Manalapan v. Rechler*, 674 So. 2d 789 (Fla. 4th DCA 1996), finding unreasonable delay or non-response constitutes bad faith warranting fees).
30. The non-responses to specific inquiries (e.g., devices searched, explanations for lack of footage/communications) and refusal to use email demonstrate unreasonable and intentional delay, bad faith, and a pattern of inserting inefficiency in an attempt to advance concealment efforts.
31. The September 8, 2025 response's exemption claim for the April 4, 2025 video is a last ditch, feeble attempt to justify continuing concealment of evidence the Judge offered to provide, when she attempted to use the offer as a threat that might help restore her credibility. (EC pp. 17)

32. It was immediately after Husband insisted on the record that Ayers follow through with her threat when the concealment efforts started, and have now continued ever since. (EC pp. 19–20)
33. Additionally and alternatively, it seems the explanation on security footage. Defendants' failure to respond to the October 9, 2025 email, which asserted "ongoing and intentional concealment" and fee entitlement, further evidences active bad faith. (EC pp. 19–23)
34. Plaintiff is entitled to declaratory relief for himself and on behalf of his minor children under Chapter 86, Florida Statutes, to order production of the materials, clarify the legal duties of the Defendants, and/or otherwise mandate compliance. (See *Doe v. State*, 217 So. 3d 1020 (Fla. 2017), affirming next friend authority in child-related suits).
35. Plaintiff is entitled to attorney's fees under §119.12, Florida Statutes, including enhanced awards for bad faith based on the pattern of delays, obstruction, non-responses to follow-ups, and evidence of bias/concealment.

VI. Certification/Declaration:

36. I, Christopher Hanson, declare under penalty of perjury that the following is true and correct to the best of my knowledge:

- I am acting as attorney and next friend for my minor children, whose interests are directly affected by the withheld records in the underlying litigation wrought with corruption and harmful delays and obstruction supported by the 13th Circuit.
- I submitted the public records requests attached as Exhibit A (Composite of First 5 Requests, pp. 2–11).
- I received the responses attached as Exhibit B (August 21, 2025 Letter from Gina Justice, pp. 12–14), Exhibit C (September 4, 2025 Letter from Gina Justice, p. 15), and Exhibit D (September 8, 2025 Response from Gina Justice on Video Availability, p. 16), and the September 15, 2025 acknowledge email.
- I reference the transcript excerpts attached as Exhibit E (April 4, 2025 Hearing Transcript – Pages 75 and 193, EC - pp. 17–18), which document the Court's acknowledgment of video footage and refusal to retrieve it.
- I submitted timely follow-up correspondence, including that included within the October 9, 2025 email chain to Mike Moore, attached as Exhibit F (Email Chain to Moore, pp. 19–23).
- I filed the motion to supplement the appellate record attached as Exhibit G

due to the video's critical evidence to the underlying case. (Motion to Supplement the Record with Video of 4/4/25 Hearing and Recusal Documents, pp. 24–82), which documents bias through procedural irregularities (e.g., pp. 24–25, 31–32 on video offer and non-production; pp. 26–30 on ethical violations ignored).

- Some of the records sought pertain to judicial scheduling, recusal, and procedural communications in Case No. 24-DR-1150.
- The responses confirm the existence of responsive records and the refusal to produce them without payment or under claimed exemptions.
- I have experienced retaliatory conduct following lawful public records requests, including unaddressed questions and concerns (that independently raise further concerns over bias and corruption in this proceeding).
- The partial responses (EC pp. 13-17) failed to address follow-ups on August 26, August 31, September 9, September 12, September 24, and October 9, 2025, including requests for affidavits on search methods/devices, explanations for lack of communications on December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearings, clarification on "security" video existence only for April 4, 2025, whether the camera is part of a security system, and why no footage exists for other cases. Defendants refused to use email, resulting in delays like emails and the September 4, 2025 letter crossing in the mail.
- Judicial officers have obstructed access to records and failed to comply with Chapter 119, as evidenced by the pattern of ignored ethical concerns detailed in Exhibits G and H (Correspondence to Chief Judge Sabella, pp. 83–169). This non-response pattern supports the bias, concealment, and "13th Circuit Clubhouse" culture where all the “members” have circled their wagons to protect insiders, violating public records law, despite the pain and damage it’s causing this Hillsborough county family..
- The EC, (filed separately provides solid unrefuted evidence supporting these 13th Circuit’s failures, refusals, and intentional actions in violation of Husband’s due process rights.

Certified and executed on October 13, 2025.

/s/Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson

cahanson77@yahoo.com

727-409-5738

VII. Prayer for Relief

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff respectfully requests that this Court:

A. Issue a writ of mandamus compelling Defendants to produce the following records immediately and without hearing, as time is of the essence:

- All email and text communications of Judges Kelly Ayers and Wendy DePaul and their judicial assistants regarding the undersigned's litigation in the 13th Circuit, including anything related to scheduling or attendance at hearings on December 13, 2024; January 9, 2025; and April 4, 2025
- All visual and audio recordings of hearings listed in Plaintiff's requests, including Docket #198 (April 4, 2025)
- All communications regarding the April 28, 2025 Order of Recusal
- All communications regarding the April 7, 2025 request for summary of Wife's testimony and Husband's motion to strike

B. Compel Defendants to provide affidavits describing search targets, methods, including which devices were searched (e.g., personal devices), to confirm completeness of production, what applications, emails, text programs searched to confirm compliance, and if applicable, justification for failing to search personal devices including text messages of Judge Ayers, her assistant, and other individuals involved in the events described above.

C. Compel Defendants to provide written explanations, with specific evidentiary and statutory citations, for:

- The lack of any communications regarding the hearings on December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025.
- How "security" video exists only for the April 4, 2025 hearing.
- Whether the camera recording footage on April 4, 2025, is part of an actual security system.
- Why no footage exists for other relevant hearings or cases.
- Any withholdings or exemptions claimed in the partial responses.

D. Declare that Defendants violated Chapter 119 through unlawful refusal, non-response to clarifications and follow-ups, refusal to use email, failure to answer requests for clarification and access, provide explanations, and patterns of delay evidencing bias and

concealment;

E. Award attorney's fees and costs under §119.12, including enhancements for bad faith;

F. Grant such other relief as the Court deems just and proper.

Respectfully submitted,

/s/Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson, as attorney and next friend for his minor children
3934 E Eden Roc Cir
Tampa, FL 33634
727-409-5738
cahanson77@yahoo.com (<mailto:cahanson77@yahoo.com>)

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I HEREBY CERTIFY that a true and correct copy of the foregoing Verified Complaint for Writ of Mandamus, Declaratory Relief, and Attorney's Fees, along with all accompanying exhibits, was filed through the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal and service attempted via the Portal's e-service system on October 14, 2025, (with additional email service directly from plaintiff) to the following recipients:

Clerk of Court for the 13th Judicial Circuit at info@hillsclerk.com

13th Judicial Circuit Court at rowlanda@fljud13.org

Gina Justice, Court Administrator at gina.justice@fljud13.org

Mike Moore, Public Information Officer, mike.moore@fljud13.org

Judge Kelly Ayers at famlawdivd@fljud.org

Judge Christopher Sabella at cornelcm@fljud13.org.

/s/ Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson, Esq.
Florida Bar No. 44094
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**IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT IN AND FOR
HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA**

CASE NO.: [25-CA-10255]

DIVISION: [B]

CHRISTOPHER HANSON, individually and as attorney for himself and attorney/next friend for his minor children [8 years old] and [6 years old], Plaintiffs

v.

THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT COURT,

CLERK OF THE COURT FOR THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT, GINA JUSTICE (AND/OR CURRENT COURT ADMINISTRATOR, CHIEF JUDGE CHRISTOPHER C. SABELLA, JUDGE KELLY AYERS, JUDGE MATTHEW FELIX, MIKE MOORE

**AMENDED VERIFIED PETITION/COMPLAINT FOR WRIT OF MANDAMUS, DECLARATORY
RELIEF, AND ATTORNEY'S FEES**

Plaintiff Christopher Hanson, as attorney and next friend for his minor children [8 years old] and [6 years old], hereby amends his original Verified Petition/Complaint for Writ of Mandamus, Declaratory Relief, and Attorney's Fees, filed on October 14, 2025 (E-Filed October 15, 2025), pursuant to Florida Rule of Civil Procedure 1.190(a). This amendment is filed as a matter of course, as no responsive pleading has been served. The amendment adds defendants, updates factual allegations to reflect ongoing efforts to cover up attorney and judicial misconduct in the 13th Circuit as of November 12, 2025, (including non-responses to additional Public Records Requests 6, 7, and 8), and reiterates the legal bases for relief including on Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution and Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420, and arguments for the extension of Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, to judicial records, at least where there is evidence of systemic corruption. This amended petition is brought pursuant to Rule 2.420(l) for expedited review of the denial of access to judicial branch court and administrative records. To the extent any requested records are subject to a prior determination of confidentiality (none of which has been identified to Plaintiff), this petition also seeks review and vacation of such determination as

permitted under Rule 2.420(d) and (e). All allegations from the original petition are incorporated herein unless modified.

I. Introduction and Parties:

1. This is an action to enforce the fundamental constitutional right of access to judicial branch records under Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution, which declares that "[e]very person shall have the right to inspect or copy any public record made or received in connection with the official business of any public body, officer, or employee of the state, or persons acting on their behalf," expressly including "the legislative, executive, and judicial branches of government." Fla. Const. art. I, § 24(a). This petition invokes the presumption of openness that permeates Florida's constitution and broad jurisprudence on state action, where "public trials and deliberations about court records are presumed open" and any exemptions must be narrowly tailored with the burden on the custodian to justify confidentiality. Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113, 116 (Fla. 1988) (emphasizing that "a strong presumption of public access to the court's records exists" and closure is warranted only *upon specific findings* of necessity, with alternatives considered and restrictions as narrow as possible).
2. Plaintiff seeks a writ of mandamus compelling the production of judicial records unlawfully withheld by the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit and its officers. These records, identified in detail below and in relevant correspondence, relate to judicial bias, corruption, and misconduct in the underlying family law case involving attorneys on both sides and the bench itself (24-DR-001150). The intentional lack of transparency has directly impacted the children's welfare with no legitimate state interest served. The only apparent motive for the initial, strategic production of documents and the more recent complete non-responsiveness is to cover for Courthouse (clubhouse) insiders who wish to avoid consequences for their misconduct.
3. As the Florida Supreme Court has held, the Constitution's access provision "was adopted to ensure public access to all records that by law were made or received by the personnel of these [governmental] institutions or by persons acting on behalf of these institutions," underscoring that judicial records are not exempt from this mandate absent a justified exemption. Media Gen. Convergence, Inc. v. Chief Judge of the Thirteenth Jud. Cir., 840 So. 2d 1008, 1013 (Fla. 2003) Here, the presumption in favor of transparency is critically important given 13th Circuit representatives

misconduct in the case and motive to conceal damaging materials for no reason other than to avoid consequences for misconduct. Allegations of systemic misconduct demand scrutiny, and any claimed exemption must be "no broader than necessary to accomplish the stated purpose" with specificity, as required by Article I, Section 24(c). See also Rhea v. Dist. Bd. of Trs. of Santa Fe Coll., 109 So. 3d 851, 857 (Fla. 1st DCA 2013) (public records laws "liberally construed in favor of openness").

4. Plaintiff also seeks declaratory relief and attorney's fees under Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420(l) and any other basis under the law, including statutory, regulatory, and common law grounds. Although Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, does not directly apply to judicial branch records per Times Publishing Co. v. Ake, 660 So. 2d 691, 698 (Fla. 1995) (holding that "chapter 119 has no application to judicial records" but affirming that Rule 2.420 "provides the public access to judicial records required by article I, section 24 of the Florida Constitution"), access remains independently mandated by the Constitution itself and Rule 2.420, which implement a presumption of openness where exemptions must be narrowly construed. Woodard v. State, 885 So. 2d 444, 446 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004) (reiterating constitutional access to judicial records).
5. In balancing interests here—where high-level judicial misconduct threatens public trust and family welfare—the scales tip decisively toward disclosure, as "the burden of the party seeking closure [is] to prove that closure is necessary," with no reasonable alternative and the least restrictive means employed. Barron, 531 So. 2d at 118. Here, the 13th Circuit has fought transparency at every step, causing great damage to this family and public perception of Florida's judicial system. No prior motion for determination of confidentiality under Rule 2.420(e) or (f) is required for this mandamus action, as the denials are administrative in nature and not based on a court order determining confidentiality.

II. Jurisdiction and Venue

6. This Court has jurisdiction under Article V, §5 of the Florida Constitution, §26.012, Florida Statutes, and Rule 2.420(l)(2) for mandamus review of access denials by judicial branch custodians.
7. Venue (prior to the Court's consideration of the corruption and conflicts involved) is proper in Hillsborough County under §47.011 and Rule 2.420, because the defendants reside here and the cause of action primarily accrued here.

III. Parties

8. Plaintiff Christopher Hanson is a licensed Florida attorney acting on his own behalf and acting as attorney and next friend for his minor children, who are residents of Florida and have a direct interest in the requested judicial records, as they pertain to their welfare in the underlying family law case.
9. Defendant Thirteenth Judicial Circuit Court is the judicial branch entity subject to Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution and Rule 2.420, responsible for maintaining and disclosing judicial records with custodial duties over the Circuit's Court and Administrative records.
10. Defendant Court Administrator/Clerk of the Court for the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit is the entity responsible for custodial duties over judicial records under Rule 2.420(b)(3).
11. Defendant Gina Justice, former Court Administrator, recently left her employment at the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, and no replacement has been named.
12. Defendant Chief Judge Christopher C. Sabella is the Chief Judge of the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, a public officer who oversees administrative operations, including records management, and serves as custodian under Rule 2.420(b)(3).
13. Defendant Judge Kelly Ayers is a judge in the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit and a public officer with potential custodial responsibilities over relevant communications and records under Rule 2.420(b)(3).
14. Defendant Judge Matthew Felix is a judge in the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit and a public officer with potential custodial responsibilities over relevant communications and records under Rule 2.420(b)(3), including those related to emergency filings and recusal in Case No. 24-DR-001150.
15. Defendant Mike Moore is the Public Information Officer for the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, involved in processing public records requests.

IV. Relevant Facts:

16. Plaintiff submitted multiple requests for records including several formal letters (Docket #6, Exhibit A, pp. 3–12) to the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit between July 24, 2025, and September 4, 2025, seeking access to:
 - Judicial disqualification and recusal records and associated documents and communications

- Administrative and all other communications regarding the GAL issue including Judge Ayers' request for a summary and Husband's objection to excusing Attorney Davis from drafting the summary.
 - Transcripts and filings referenced in public proceedings
 - Email and text communications of Judges Kelly Ayers and Wendy DePaul and their judicial assistants related to this case including those related to scheduling, objections, and disqualification/recusal.
 - Visual and audio recordings of specified hearings, primarily the April 4, 2025 hearing, offered by Judge Ayers as part of a lie/threat made on the formal transcript.
17. The Court Administrator's response on August 21, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit B, p. 14), confirmed the existence of records satisfying these requests, acknowledging responsive communications but providing only partial, redacted productions without affidavits confirming complete searches or explanations for omissions. Here, the Court administrator's responses confirm sufficient identification of my legal right to clearly defined information, the Court identified and confirmed its availability (Docket #6, Exhibit B, p. 14). However, in follow-up correspondence on October 9, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit F, p. 20), Plaintiff highlighted the complete absence of any records relating to the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025 hearings in the records produced, despite the Administrator's confirmation of their existence—indicating deliberate withholding.
18. The evidence demonstrates defendants' intent to subvert the truth and conceal evidence of judicial misconduct. (Docket #6, 10, 11). The Court administrator failed to produce the requested records (relating to the 12-13-24 and 1-9-25 hearings prior to and during which, the Court obviously and severely violated plaintiff's due process rights) while providing voluminous records never requested (communications associated with all hearings not referenced in Plaintiff's requests).
19. The Court failed to respond at all to several questions and attempts to investigate the obvious failures to cooperate in good faith with these public records requests. Docket #6, p. 20-24. No court order determining confidentiality of these records has been issued or provided to Plaintiff. This failure contravenes the presumption of transparency, especially amid credible, unrefuted allegations of misconduct at the highest levels of the 13th Circuit. Given the Public Interest in uncovering systemic corruption, any exemption must be narrowly tailored (see Rhea v. Dist. Bd. of

Trustees of Santa Fe Coll., 109 So. 3d 851 (Fla. 1st DCA 2013), stressing that public records laws are to be liberally construed in favor of openness).

20. Plaintiff received responses full of tedious unrequested information while the 13th Circuit sneakily concealed the evidence actually requested and relevant to plaintiff while the Court offered purported justification for withholding the specific video at issue that will show Judge Ayers demonstrating obvious bias in open Court, lying about it, and then offering to get the video in a threatening manner. (Docket #6, 10, 11). Correspondence from Gina Justice, Court Administrator, dated August 21, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit B, pp. 13–15), September 4, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit C, p. 16), and September 8, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit D, p. 17). The Court acknowledged the existence of responsive records, but continued the pattern of clubhouse corruption in concealing the relevant evidence that would expose insider misconduct. There is nothing in the responsive documents from the 13th Circuit that constitutes a formal determination of confidentiality under Rule 2.420(d) or (e). The Court confirmed the existence of relevant evidence while failing to justify deviation from the presumption of openness, particularly given concerns of judicial misconduct that heighten the public interest in transparency (see Barron, 531 So. 2d at 118, requiring overriding public necessity for closure).
21. These responses were inadequate and failed to address key concerns, including the selective omission of materials Plaintiff requested for the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025 hearings. Instead, Ms. Justice produced only voluminous, unrequested records for unrelated proceedings, suggesting an intent to obscure the concealment of evidence of systemic misconduct and corruption in the 13th Circuit. (Docket #6, p. 13-22).
22. The September 8, 2025 letter from Ms. Justice denied access to the April 4, 2025 video recording referencing the confidential nature of Court surveillance video, without ever identifying the April 4 video as coming from the surveillance system. The Court administrator refused to acknowledge Judge Ayers' offering the video on the record, raising concerns about inconsistent treatment, open and obvious bias, and concealment of Public Records to avoid consequences within the Circuit Clubhouse. This denial is administrative and reviewable by mandamus under Rule 2.420(l). The confidentiality referenced lacks the narrow tailoring required for any exemption amid allegations of high-level misconduct in the 13th Circuit (see Media Gen. Convergence, 840 So. 2d at 1013-14, mandating specific findings to overcome the presumption of access).

23. Plaintiff has exhausted all informal remedies and administrative channels, including follow-ups on August 26, August 31, September 9, September 12, September 24, and October 9, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit F, pp. 20–24). Defendants never responded to any of the follow-up requests for documents or explanations from September 9, 2025 forward besides an email from Moore acknowledging receipt and ensuring processing in a “reasonable” time. As of November 12, 2025, no further responses or productions have been received, exacerbating the ongoing harm.

24. On October 14, 2025, Plaintiff submitted additional Public Records Requests 6, 7, and 8 to Defendants, seeking records directly related to the ongoing misconduct in Case No. 24-DR-001150 (Addendum Composite, pp. 1-12), including:

- Request 6: Handling of correspondence with Chief Judge Sabella's office, including emails/letters from January 22, February 12, March 11, August 13, and August 16, 2025, regarding ethical violations by attorney Scott Davis and Judge Ayers' bias/cover-up (Addendum Composite, pp. 1-3).
- Request 7: Communications involving Judge Felix and his assistants about Plaintiff or the case, including emergency filings (Docket Nos. 246, 245, 233, 232, 230, 210, 209, 181) and post-recusal correspondence (Addendum Composite, pp. 4-5).
- Request 8: Judge Ayers' disqualification records/complaints from January 1, 2020, to present, including those related to GAL issues or the Ayo and Iken law firm (Addendum Composite, pp. 6-7).

25. These requests received only a form acknowledgment email on October 14, 2025, with no substantive response, production, timeline, or explanation for delays (Addendum Composite, pp. 8-12, including follow-ups on October 27, 2025 and November 12, 2025, demanding timely compliance. This total silence contrasts with partial responses to earlier requests, suggesting a more direct approach to the Court’s obstruction efforts. In their completely unlawful efforts to avoid consequences for the clubhouse insiders guilty of severe misconduct and directly responsible for serious harm to a Florida family, the Court’s current actions demonstrate an intentional strategy to subvert the truth to cover for bad judicial actors even at the expense of the citizens they’ve sworn to serve. The Court has completely failed to offer any materials sought in the most recent requests (e.g., Sabella's non-responsiveness, Felix's involvement, Ayers' disqualifications), further evidencing bad faith and constructive denial.

26. Ongoing failures include:

- Intentional concealment of records relating to due process violations and bias associated with the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearings and the April 4, 2025 video, all with no good faith basis under the Florida Constitution and Rule 2.420.
- No explanation for the Court's concealment and/or lack of any communications regarding the hearings on December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025, which raise concerns about irregular proceedings and concealment given the existence of emails surrounding less controversial matters.
- No clarification on how "security" video exists only for the April 4, 2025 hearing (Docket #6, Docket #198), whether the camera recording that footage is part of an actual security system, and why no similar footage exists for other relevant hearings or cases.
- Refusal to provide any information by email, despite repeated requests, leading to inefficiencies such as Plaintiff's September emails and the Court's September 4, 2025 letter crossing in the mail. This reliance on U.S. Mail appears deliberate to delay access and violates the intent of Rule 2.420 for prompt disclosure.
- No written explanations with specific citations for any withholdings even with the detailed questions posed.
- No response to requests for affidavits describing search methods, including which devices were searched (e.g., personal devices) to confirm completeness.

27. Defendants' complete non-response to these specific concerns and requests, combined with the partial responses (raising significant concerns about strategic withholding/concealment of specific materials of relevance), provides further evidence of bias, bad faith, and systemic corruption. There is an undeniable pattern where 13th Circuit "Clubhouse" members are circling the wagons to protect fellow insiders, in violation of public access rights under Rule 2.420. Such actions undermine the presumption of transparency, especially when misconduct at the highest levels is at stake, requiring strict scrutiny and narrow tailoring of any restrictions (see Rhea, 109 So. 3d at 857).

28. This obstruction has caused ongoing harm to Plaintiff and his family. The October 9, 2025 email (Docket #6, Exhibit F, pp. 20–24) explicitly stated: "The ongoing and intentional concealment of evidence critical to my case... is causing ongoing and increasing damage to my children and my health. I do not believe there's any good faith basis to conceal the evidence identified nor even offer any clarification

regarding the video evidence. I have real concerns about the veracity of some of the representations and the court's failure to even confirm devices searched."

29. Defendants' failure to respond since their September 8, 2025 letter aside from the form response, demonstrates active concealment and bad faith, particularly in light of the pre-suit notice and the problem with misconduct, corruption, and dishonesty in the underlying case.
30. The Thirteenth Judicial Circuit is acting in bad faith, as evidenced by the deliberate pattern of delays, non-responses, and strategically incomplete disclosures that seem to protect Judge Ayers, attorney Scott Davis, and other insiders by concealing extensive evidence that would cause the Court and the bar embarrassment and likely more significant discipline. This pattern heightens the need for transparency to expose misconduct at the highest levels, as the presumption favors disclosure unless narrowly justified (see Barron, 531 So. 2d at 119).
31. The singular issue in the underlying case (24-DR-001150) is Husband's discovery efforts given Wife's concealment of marital assets at the time the parties entered a post-marital agreement without counsel. Attorney Scott Davis, representing Wife, proceeded with a legal strategy to delay, harass, burden, and obstruct Husband's access to obviously discoverable and critically relevant financial discovery, in direct violation of the Florida Bar Rules.
32. Judge Ayers actively assisted Wife and her attorney's obstruction strategies, suppressed evidence of obvious ethical misconduct from multiple attorneys, all to Husband's detriment, and actively sought to advance Wife's clearly retaliatory litigation (e.g., Docket #6, Exhibit G, pp. 25–83, detailing procedural irregularities, suppression of discovery, and failure to address ethical violations; Docket #6, Exhibit H, pp. 84–170, correspondence to Chief Judge Sabella).
33. Plaintiff sought assistance from the Chief Judge on numerous occasions as he consistently ignored the gross misconduct occurring in the Court he's sworn to oversee. (Docket #6, p. 84-170).
34. With respect to requested Court communications on the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearings (Docket #6, p. 3-4, 7-8), Ms. Gina Justice, as Court administrator, intentionally concealed relevant evidence of judicial misconduct while actively burdening Plaintiff with irrelevant and unrequested documents. (Docket #6, 10, 11).
35. The Court Administrator not only failed to comply with the Court's duties under Rule 2.420 and the Florida constitution, the evidence demonstrates intentional deceit

with the Court's voluminous response consisting of unrequested records with the relevant ones requested conspicuously absent. (Docket #6, 10, 11).

36. These actions underscore the need for unhindered public access to records to ensure accountability and strict compliance with the Court's duty to narrowly tailor any Court and administrative records withheld from production, aligning with the constitutional presumption of openness (see Media Gen. Convergence, 840 So. 2d at 1014).
37. The Judicial system has clearly allowed ethical compliance to falter to a point where the events described herein are a reality causing active harm to citizens.
38. A "Fox guarding the hen house" style of oversight dominated proceedings to date in the 13th Circuit and the Public Records request process.
39. The Florida and Federal Constitutions demand transparency to restore public trust in the institution.

V. Legal Basis for Relief

40. Under Article I, §24 of the Florida Constitution, every person has a right to inspect or copy any public record made or received in connection with the official business of any public body, officer, or employee of the state, or persons acting on their behalf, except with respect to records exempted pursuant to this section or specifically made confidential by the Constitution. This includes judicial branch records, with a strong presumption in favor of access (see Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113 (Fla. 1988); see also Woodard v. State, 885 So. 2d 444 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004)).
41. Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420 implements this constitutional right for judicial branch records, establishing procedures for access, exemptions, and review of denials through mandamus or other appropriate relief (Rule 2.420(l)). The rule presumes openness, and exemptions must be narrowly construed. The requested records are "court records" or "administrative records" under Rule 2.420(b)(1) and are not exempt under Rule 2.420(c) unless properly determined confidential, which has not occurred here. Given allegations of misconduct at the highest levels of the 13th Circuit, any claimed exemption must be justified with specificity and narrowly tailored to override the presumption (see Rhea v. Dist. Bd. of Trustees of Santa Fe Coll., 109 So. 3d 851 (Fla. 1st DCA 2013)).
42. While Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, did not apply to judicial branch records under Times Publishing Co. v. Ake, 660 So. 2d 691 (Fla. 1995), Plaintiff submits that the

level of corruption that's festered in the 13th Circuit under these facts require reassessing applicability of Chapter 119 to the Judiciary. Ake should be distinguished or reconsidered here, as the requested records (e.g., communications and videos) are administrative in nature and essential to combating corruption. Nonetheless, relief is independently available under the Federal and Florida Constitutions and Rule 2.420.

43. Defendants' failure to produce records and respond to questions about obvious failure and concealment efforts violates Rule 2.420 and entitles Plaintiff to mandamus relief under Rule 2.420(l) and attorney fees and costs under relevant common law. The Defendants' asserted exemptions are invalid, intentionally misleading, and/or overly broad under Rule 2.420(c), as no specific basis was provided that fits the facts and documents at issue, and no court order determining confidentiality exists under Rule 2.420(d) or (e). (Town of Manalapan v. Rechler, 674 So. 2d 789 (Fla. 4th DCA 1996), finding unreasonable delay or non-response constitutes bad faith warranting fees).
44. The presumption of transparency is particularly vital here to address concerns of judicial misconduct, requiring any withholding to be narrowly tailored (see Media Gen. Convergence, Inc. v. Chief Judge of the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, 840 So. 2d 1008 (Fla. 2003)). The non-responses to Requests 6-8 exemplify this pattern, violating the presumption of openness and shifting the burden to Defendants to justify exemptions (Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113 (Fla. 1988)).
45. The intentional concealment and non-responses to specific inquiries (e.g., devices searched, explanations for lack of footage/communications) demonstrate unreasonable and intentional delay, bad faith, and a pattern of inserting inefficiency in an attempt to advance concealment efforts.
46. The September 8, 2025 response's exemption claim for the April 4, 2025 video is a last-ditch attempt to justify continuing concealment of evidence the Judge offered to provide, when she attempted to use the offer as a threat that might help restore her credibility. (Docket #6, Exhibit E, pp. 18–19) This claim does not meet the requirements for a confidentiality determination under Rule 2.420(d)(1)(B) or (e), failing the narrow tailoring requirement amid high-level misconduct concerns (see Barron, 531 So. 2d at 118).
47. It was immediately after Husband insisted on the record that Ayers follow through with her threat to produce the video when the concealment efforts started, and have now continued ever since. (Docket #6, Exhibit F, pp. 20–24). There are now

multiple layers of misconduct stemming largely from Defendants' efforts to assist Mr. Davis in his misconduct to conceal financial evidence and marital assets. Plaintiff is constitutionally entitled to the very transparency that has the change to restore justice for the Citizens of Hillsborough County.

48. Additionally and alternatively, Defendants' failure to respond to the October 9, 2025 email, which asserted "ongoing and intentional concealment" and fee entitlement, further evidences active bad faith. (Docket #6, Exhibit F, pp. 20–24)
49. Plaintiff is entitled to declaratory relief for himself and on behalf of his minor children under Chapter 86, Florida Statutes, to order production of the materials, clarify the legal duties of the Defendants under Rule 2.420, and/or otherwise mandate compliance.
50. Plaintiff is entitled to attorney's fees under Rule 2.420, Chapter 86, and Common Law for Defendants' bad faith and unreasonable obstruction to accessing Public Records, including enhanced awards for bad faith based on the pattern of delays, obstruction, non-responses to follow-ups, and evidence of bias/concealment. Alternatively, fees are available under §119.12 if Chapter 119 applies, or under common law/equity for bad faith conduct (see *Wood v. Marston*, 442 So. 2d 934 (Fla. 1983)).
51. Mandamus is appropriate where a petitioner demonstrates (1) a clear legal right to the requested relief, (2) an indisputable legal duty on the part of the respondent to perform the act, and (3) the absence of any other adequate remedy at law. See *Huffman v. State*, 813 So. 2d 10, 11 (Fla. 2000). Plaintiff satisfies each element here largely based on admissions from the 13th Circuit Court administrator who responded to the first 5 requests, acknowledging the right, duty, and existence of responsive records. (Docket #6, pp. 13-17).
52. Plaintiff has a clear legal right to access judicial records under Article I, § 24 of the Florida Constitution and Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420, which establish a strong presumption of openness. Second, Defendants, as custodians of judicial and administrative records, have an indisputable legal duty to produce those records unless a valid, narrowly tailored exemption is established. No such exemption or confidentiality finding exists despite the Circuit's obvious efforts toward concealment of its systemic corruption. Plaintiff lacks any adequate alternative remedy, having exhausted informal and administrative channels without response, leaving mandamus as the only mechanism to compel compliance with critical constitutional and statutory duties.

VI. Certification/Declaration:

53. I, Christopher Hanson, declare under penalty of perjury that the following is true and correct to the best of my knowledge:

- I am acting as attorney and next friend for my minor children, whose interests are directly affected by the withheld records in the underlying litigation wrought with corruption, harmful delays and intentional obstruction subverting Truth and Justice, all actively supported by the 13th Circuit Defendants.
- I submitted the public records requests attached as Docket #6, Exhibit A (pp. 3–12).
- I received the responses attached as Docket #6, Exhibit B (pp. 13–15), Exhibit C (p. 16), and Exhibit D (p. 17), and the September 15, 2025 acknowledgment email.
- I reference the transcript excerpts attached as Docket #6, Exhibit E (pp. 18–19), which document the Court’s acknowledgment of video footage and refusal to retrieve it.
- I submitted timely follow-up correspondence, including that included within the October 9, 2025 email chain to Mike Moore, attached as Docket #6, Exhibit F (pp. 20–24).
- I filed the motion to supplement the appellate record attached as Docket #6, Exhibit G (pp. 25–83) due to the video’s critical evidence to the underlying case, which documents bias through procedural irregularities (e.g., pp. 25–26, 32–33 on video offer and non-production; pp. 27–31 on ethical violations ignored).
- Some of the records sought pertain to judicial scheduling, recusal, and procedural communications in Case No. 24-DR-001150.
- The responses from the Court Administrator confirm the existence of responsive records without qualifying the public records sought under any exemptions.
- I have experienced retaliatory conduct following lawful public records requests, including unaddressed questions that independently raise further concerns over bias, corruption and ongoing cover-up attempts during plaintiff’s year and a half under the Court’s jurisdiction.
- The Court administrator (Docket #6, Exhibits B-D) failed to address follow-ups on August 26, August 31, September 9, September 12, September 24, and October 9, 2025. Specifically, Defendants concealed relevant evidence, pursued a strategy of burying Plaintiff in irrelevant, unrequested documents, and refused to offer explanations for lack of communications produced for requested hearings, December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025. The Defendants also specifically failed to qualify the April 4, 2025 hearing video under any exemption and refused Plaintiff’s requests for clarification on "security" video

existence only for April 4, 2025, whether the camera is part of a security system, and why no footage exists for other hearing dates if it's truly "security" footage.

- Judicial officers have obstructed access to records and failed to comply with access rights under Rule 2.420, as evidenced by the pattern of ignored ethical concerns detailed in Docket #6, Exhibits G and H (pp. 84–170). This non-response pattern further confirms the bias, concealment, and "13th Circuit Clubhouse" culture where all the "members" have circled their wagons to protect insiders, violating public access rights.
- I submitted additional Public Records Requests 6, 7, and 8 on October 14, 2025 (Addendum Composite, pp. 1-12), and follow-ups, with no substantive response as of November 12, 2025, further evidencing bad faith.
- The exhibits provide solid unrefuted evidence supporting the 13th Circuit's failures, refusals, and intentional actions in violation of Plaintiff's due process rights.

Certified and executed on November 13, 2025.

/s/Christopher Hanson
Christopher Hanson
cahanson77@yahoo.com
727-409-5738

VII. Prayer for Relief

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff respectfully requests that this Court:

A. Issue a writ of mandamus under Rule 2.420(l) compelling Defendants to produce the following records immediately and without hearing, as time is of the essence:

- all emails and text messages and/or any other form of written communication, sent or received by Judge Kelly Ayers, her judicial assistant, (Dwauna Heyward), and/or any other 13th Circuit representative who participated in scheduling the 12-13-24 hearing on Case No. 24-DR-1150, In Re: The Marriage of Sarah Hanson and Christopher Hanso. Specifically, I'm requesting all of these materials from December 1, 2024, to December 20, 2024, including communications with court staff, attorneys and/or their agents, or others about scheduling and/or attendance at the hearing on December 13, 2024 (per Records request, pp. 3-4),
- all emails and text messages and/or any other form of written communication, sent or received by Judge Kelly Ayers, her judicial assistant (Dwauna Heyward), and/or any other 13th Circuit representative who participated in scheduling the January 9, 2025 hearing on Case No. 24-DR-11550, In Re: The Marriage of Sarah

Hanson and Christopher Hanson. Specifically, I am requesting all of these materials from December 21, 2024, to January 20, 2025, including communications with court staff, attorneys and/or their agents, or others about scheduling and/or attendance at the hearing on January 9, 2025.

- All visual and audio recordings of the April 4, 2025 hearing,
- All emails and text messages and/or any other form of written communication sent or received by Judge Wendy J. DePaul, her judicial assistant, and/or any other 13th Circuit representative who participated in or discussed the recusal in and/or all other documentation regarding Judge DePaul's involvement with Case No. 24-DR-001150, In Re: The Marriage of Sarah Hanson and Christopher Hanson. Specifically, all materials from April 1, 2025, to May 31, 2025, including communications with court staff, other judges, attorneys and/or their agents, or others about the recusal, the decision to recuse, or the issuance of the Order of Recusal dated April 28, 2025. This includes, but is not limited to, any internal memos, notes, drafts, or correspondence related to the recusal process.
- All communications regarding the April 7, 2025 request for summary of Wife's testimony and Husband's motion to strike
- All records responsive to Public Records Requests 6, 7, and 8 dated October 14, 2025 (Addendum Composite, pp. 1-12), including handling of Sabella correspondence, Felix communications, and Ayers disqualification records.
- all public records related to the handling of concerns described in the letters and emails I sent to Chief Judge Christopher C. Sabella and/or his judicial assistant(s) concerning Case No. 24-DR-001150 (In Re: The Marriage of Sarah Hanson and Christopher Hanson) as further specified at Addendum composite (recently filed), p. 1-3.
- all public records of communications involving Judge Felix (and/or his judicial assistant(s)) about Christopher Hanson and/or Case No. 24-DR-001150 (In Re: The Marriage of Sarah Hanson and Christopher Hanson) in the Family Law Division as further specified at Addendum composite (recently filed), p. 4-5.
- all public records related to Judge Kelly Ayers' involvement in any and all disqualification scenarios, complaints, or concerns about her impartiality, honesty, and professionalism as further specified at Addendum composite (recently filed), p. 6-7.

B. Due to the bad faith and efforts in support of concealment exhibited thus far, compel Defendants to provide affidavits describing search targets, methods, including which devices were searched (e.g., personal devices), to confirm completeness of production, what applications, emails, text programs searched to confirm compliance, and if applicable, justification for failing to search personal devices including text messages of Judge Ayers, her assistant, and other individuals involved in the events described above.

C. Compel Defendants to provide written explanations, with specific evidentiary and rule-based citations, for:

- The lack of any communications regarding the hearings on December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025.
- How "security" video exists only for the April 4, 2025 hearing.
- Whether the camera recording footage on April 4, 2025, is part of an actual security system.
- Why no footage exists for other relevant hearings or cases.
- Specification on withholdings or exemptions claimed in the partial responses.
- The delays and inconsistent handling of Requests 6-8 compared to earlier requests.

D. Declare that Defendants violated Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution and Rule 2.420 through unlawful refusal, non-response to clarifications and follow-ups, refusal, and patterns of delay evidencing bias and concealment; to the extent any confidentiality determination exists, declare it invalid and vacate it under Rule 2.420(d) and (e);

E. Award attorney's fees and costs under Rule 2.420(l), §119.12 (alternative), §86.111, and common law/equity for bad faith, including enhancements;

F. Grant such other relief as the Court deems just and proper.

Respectfully submitted,

/s/Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson, as attorney and next friend for his minor children

727-409-5738

cahanson77@yahoo.com

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I HEREBY CERTIFY that a true and correct copy of the foregoing Amended Verified Petition/Complaint for Writ of Mandamus, Declaratory Relief, and Attorney's Fees was filed through the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal and service attempted via the Portal's e-service system on November 13, 2025, (with additional email service directly from Plaintiff) to the following recipients: Clerk of Court for the 13th Judicial Circuit at publicinfo@fljud13.org and rowlanda@fljud13.org, Gina Justice, Court Administrator at gina.justice@fljud13.org, and TCA@fljud13.org, Mike Moore, Public Information Officer, mike.moore@fljud13.org, Judge Kelly Ayers at famlawdivd@fljud13.org, Judge Matthew Felix at famlawdiva@fljud13.org, Judge Christopher Sabella at cornelcm@fljud13.org,

/s/ Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson, Esq.

Florida Bar No. 44094

cahanson77@yahoo.com

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
IN AND FOR HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA

FAMILY DIVISION A

CASE NO.: 24-DR-001150

SARAH HANSON,

Petitioner/Mother,

v.

CHRISTOPHER HANSON,

Respondent/Father.

NOTICE OF RELATED CASES AND MOTION TO DISQUALIFY ALL 13TH CIRCUIT COURT
JUDGES

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IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
IN AND FOR HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA

FAMILY DIVISION A

CASE NO.: 24-DR-001150

SARAH HANSON,

Petitioner/Mother,

v.

CHRISTOPHER HANSON,

Respondent/Father.

_____ /

NOTICE OF RELATED CASES AND VERIFIED
MOTION TO DISQUALIFY ALL 13TH CIRCUIT COURT JUDGES

Pursuant to Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.545(d), Respondent Christopher Hanson hereby notifies the Court and all parties of the following related cases, which involve common issues of law and fact, overlapping parties, and interconnected allegations of systemic corruption, judicial bias, attorney misconduct, and violations of constitutionally mandated transparency, all stemming from this underlying family law matter. These cases warrant timely action by the Courts to avoid the continuing and mounting appearance of impropriety and/or even silent coordination and collusion across the bench and within the Judiciary at large.

- 25-CA-010255 (Mandamus Suit, 13th Judicial Circuit, Hillsborough County): This is a mandamus action filed by Respondent/Husband/Petitioner in the underlying suit against the 13th Circuit (amended petition for mandamus attached as Exhibit A), seeking to compel proper handling of judicial misconduct complaints related to bias and evidence

suppression in the instant family law case. It shares factual overlap regarding attorney and judicial misconduct involving multiple actors within the 13th Circuit and requires transfer to a new venue given the direct adversarial relationship between Respondent/Husband/Petitioner in this mandamus action and the 13th Circuit.

- 2D2025-1936 (Venue Appeal, Second District Court of Appeal): This appeal challenges the denial of venue change in the instant family law case (based on stale and now incomplete facts) due to judicial bias in the 13th Circuit. It involves the same core allegations of systemic issues affecting fair adjudication.
- 2D2025-0681 (Certiorari Petition, Second District Court of Appeal): This certiorari petition seeks review of Judge Ayers' actions in the instant family law case, which amounts to "fixing" the case against the undersigned - suppressing financial evidence and enabling child weaponization tactics – all to unlawfully thwart Husband's sole objective in the litigation for over a year and a half. It is interconnected through shared evidence and misconduct claims.
- [New Case No., To Be Assigned] (Mandamus/Declaratory Relief, 2nd Judicial Circuit, Leon County): This recently filed action (petition attached as Exhibit B) against The Florida Bar and its officers seeks access to records and reopening of a Bar complaint against attorney Scott Paul Davis for misconduct in the instant family law case. It addresses Bar failures in investigating ethics violations, communicating with the

complainant, and refusals to comply with constitutional transparency requirements tied to this matter, with potential implications for attorney discipline and case integrity.

**ADDITIONAL EVIDENCE OF 13th CIRCUIT BIAS, MISCONDUCT,
AND CONSTITUTIONAL VIOLATIONS DEMONSTRATING
IMPOSSIBILITY OF A FAIR PROCESS FOR RESPONDENT.**

1. On December 18, 2025, Respondent received three letters from the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit (attached as Exhibits C, D, and E) in response to clarifications sought in email correspondence dated December 2, 2025. While the excessive costs for basic records review are problematic, the more significant concern is the Court's continuing refusal to explain, dispute, or rectify its "Intentionally Deceitful, Obstructive and Bad Faith Production: Flooding with Irrelevant Records to Conceal and Deny Access to Requested Materials" in responding to Respondent's July 2025 request for materials related to the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearings.
2. Attached as Exhibit F, the email chain leading up to the December 18, 2025 correspondence demonstrates consistent and pointed criticisms at the Court's bad faith conduct intentionally concealing evidence of Ayers' judicial misconduct.
3. While the Court did address the costs of review for the limited scope on the more recent requests (Exhibits C, D, and E), there was no attempt whatsoever to dispute or respond to the facts supporting the bad faith and intentional concealment of records related to the hearings where Respondent's due process rights were clearly violated in this underlying proceeding.
4. The Court's ongoing refusal to account for such bad faith conduct—conduct that violates constitutionally mandated transparency—appears directly tied to systemic efforts to shield Judge Ayers from accountability for documented misconduct.

5. The willingness of the Thirteenth Circuit to violate constitutional requirements at the very core of the present dispute in this case represents such obvious and extreme systemic bias that continuing under this jurisdiction would be a clear violation of due process for Respondent and his family.
6. The updated estimates (\$512.19 for Sabella-related correspondence, \$973.39 for Felix materials, and \$236.02 for Ayers materials) reflect the Circuit's ongoing obstruction and attempts to avoid constitutional transparency requirements.
7. These charges, largely for reviewing documents for confidential material, are even more concerning when contrasted with the hundreds of pages of unrequested records the Court previously produced in response to the Public Records request for the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearing related materials.
8. The Court produced unrequested correspondence without charging for review, yet now demands exorbitant fees for the same activity when the records are specifically requested.
9. The continuing obstacles—excessive fees, lack of explanation, and active and intentional concealment since a July 2025 request—make clear that Respondent cannot obtain a fair process within the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit.
10. This pattern of bad faith amplifies the appearance of impropriety already documented in this motion and throughout the docket, underscoring the urgent need for reassignment to a neutral circuit to preserve due process and public confidence.

**MOTION TO DISQUALIFY ALL 13TH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT JUDGES AND FOR
REASSIGNMENT TO A NEUTRAL CIRCUIT AND IN THE ALTERNATIVE TO SET
HEARINGS ON DAVIS'S MISCONDUCT/SANCTIONS**

COMES NOW, Respondent Christopher Hanson, pursuant to § 38.10, Florida Statutes;
Florida Rule of General Practice and Judicial Administration 2.330; and Canon 3E(1) of the

Florida Code of Judicial Conduct, and moves to disqualify all judges of the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, and requests reassignment to a neutral circuit. As grounds, Respondent states: This motion is timely filed within a reasonable time after additional events confirming institutional bias (Court's refusal to dispute, explain, or rectify its concealment of requested evidence, with document dumping intended to distract from the concealment) constituting grounds for Circuit wide disqualification, as required by Rule 2.330(c).

11. The arguments for disqualification in the public records case (25-CA-010255), as detailed in the attached Motion to Disqualify filed on October 31, 2025 (Exhibit F), are even more pertinent in this family law case (24-DR-001150).
12. In the public records action, the motion highlights institutional conflicts and bias within the 13th Circuit that prevent fair adjudication of transparency issues tied to Judge Ayers' misconduct documented throughout the present docket.
13. These concerns are amplified here, where Ayers directly presided over sensitive family matters involving child custody and financial discovery at the core of the parties' dispute.
14. Despite Judge Ayers' disqualification and multiple opportunities, Judge Felix has done nothing to resolve the core issue relating to Judge Ayers' "fixing the case" against Husband, thru suppressing the financial discovery into marital assets.
15. This refusal to take action on such obvious misconduct from Ayers is consistent with the document dumping with concealment described above providing further certainty of the systemic corruption focused on burying the long history of ethical violations in these proceedings.
16. The 13th Circuit was on notice of the parties' core issue and the impact delays were having on Respondent and his family for what will be 2 years in May. (See Docket #22).

17. There is mounting, unrefuted evidence of very serious and intentional prejudice that undermines due process, confidence in the judiciary, and most problematically the children's best interests (See Article I, Section 9 of the Florida Constitution and Florida Rule of General Practice and Judicial Administration 2.330(e)).
18. The systemic protectionism, shielding insiders like Ayers and Davis, demands reassignment to a neutral circuit to ensure impartiality.
19. Alternatively, if the Court declines disqualification or venue transfer, Respondent requests immediate hearings and findings of fact on sanctions related to Davis's misconduct and the core discovery issue raised before this Court in May of 2024.
20. Mr. Davis's obvious and unrefuted misconduct includes ethical violations under Rules Regulating The Florida Bar 4-3.4(c) (failure to comply with discovery obligations) and 4-8.4(d) (conduct prejudicial to the administration of justice), evidenced by ongoing concealment of financial records central to this case.
21. The systemic protectionism and clubhouse corruption described in Husband's article (linked here: <https://x.com/Truthoverchaos/status/1992245722901577796?s=20>) extends to the Circuit at large and the Florida Bar, necessitating Disqualification and the Petition for Mandamus, Exhibits A and B.
22. This request builds on the petition against The Florida Bar, which seeks reopening and reassessment of the complaint against Davis for his wrongdoing in this matter, alongside Ayers' complicity in suppressing evidence and enabling child weaponization.
23. Petitioner first raised pursuing sanctions in correspondence dated December 5, 2024, over a year ago. Docket #59, 60).

24. After excusing Davis's refusal to attend the January 9, 2025 hearing where his misconduct was at the center of the issues, the Court has continued its complete refusal to make findings of fact on Davis's misconduct now ongoing for more than a year.
25. Hearings are requested on the following: Docket 177 (Motion to Strike Wife's Motions for Guardian Ad Litem, Psychological Evaluation, Vocational Evaluation, and Temporary Relief for Lack of Prosecution/Compliance with Court's Request for Summary of Wife's Testimony): This motion addresses Wife's failure to comply with the Court's April 7, 2025 request for a summary of her testimony, warranting sanctions for non-prosecution and striking her pending motions.
26. Docket 239 (Objection to October 9, 2025 Hearing, Motion for Sanctions, and Request for Findings of Fact): This filing objects to procedural irregularities in the hearing, seeks sanctions against Davis for misconduct including evidence suppression and child weaponization, and requests formal findings of fact to document the pattern of bias and ethical violations.
27. Docket 245 (Verified Emergency Motion for Sanctions Including Striking All of Wife's Objections to Financial Discovery, Awarding Husband Fees and Costs, and Referral of Misconduct): This motion demands transparency measures to protect system integrity amid corruption allegations, and sanctions striking Wife's discovery objections due to Davis's concealment tactics, plus fees, costs, and referrals for investigation. It references prior dockets (#112, 183, 192, 197, 198, 209, 211) evidencing the corruption pattern supporting sanctions.

28. Respondent has a well-grounded fear that he will not receive a fair process due to prejudice stemming from the direct, adversarial relationship against the 13th Circuit and multiple Judges within it, including the current Judge, Judge Felix.
29. The history of the case underscores these objectivity concerns with institutional conflicts, personal relationships, and a pattern of protecting insiders, as evidenced in the attached Motion to Disqualify from Case No. 25-CA-010255 (filed October 31, 2025).
30. This extends circuit-wide, as Chief Judge Sabella and others have ignored complaints, fostering a "clubhouse" culture. See *Livingston v. State*, 441 So. 2d 1083, 1086 (Fla. 1983) (disqualification warranted where fear of bias is objectively reasonable).
31. Reassignment to a neutral circuit (e.g., Pasco County, Petitioner's residence) is necessary to preserve due process and public confidence, as the 13th Circuit's self-regulation cannot ensure impartiality. See § 38.10, Fla. Stat. (authorizing disqualification for prejudice); Canon 3E(1) (requiring disqualification where impartiality might reasonably be questioned).

WHEREFORE, Respondent moves for disqualification of all 13th Circuit judges and reassignment to a neutral circuit. Or in the alternative, scheduling the hearings requested above to correct Judge Ayers attempts at “fixing” the case through her suppression of Husband’s core objective, discovery into marital assets concealed during and after the marriage.

VERIFICATION

I, Christopher Hanson, being first duly sworn, depose and say that I am the Respondent in the above-entitled cause; that I have read the foregoing Motion to Disqualify; that the facts stated therein are true and correct to the best of my knowledge and belief; and that this verification is made under penalty of perjury pursuant to Section 92.525, Florida Statutes.

Executed on this 19th day of December, 2025.

/s/ Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson, self-represented

FL Bar #44094

cahanson77@yahoo.com (mailto:cahanson77@yahoo.com)

727-409-5738

Certificate of Service

I HEREBY CERTIFY that a true and correct copy of the foregoing Notice of Related Cases and Motion to Disqualify All 13th Circuit Court Judges has been furnished via the Court's efling system on this 19th day of December, 2025.

/s/Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson,

FL bar #44094

cahanson77@yahoo.com (mailto:cahanson77@yahoo.com)

727-409-5738

**IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT IN AND FOR
HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA**

CASE NO.: [25-CA-10255]

DIVISION: [B]

CHRISTOPHER HANSON, individually and as attorney for himself and attorney/next friend for his minor children [8 years old] and [6 years old], Plaintiffs

v.

THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT COURT,

CLERK OF THE COURT FOR THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT, GINA JUSTICE (AND/OR CURRENT COURT ADMINISTRATOR, CHIEF JUDGE CHRISTOPHER C. SABELLA, JUDGE KELLY AYERS, JUDGE MATTHEW FELIX, MIKE MOORE

**AMENDED VERIFIED PETITION/COMPLAINT FOR WRIT OF MANDAMUS, DECLARATORY
RELIEF, AND ATTORNEY'S FEES**

Plaintiff Christopher Hanson, as attorney and next friend for his minor children [8 years old] and [6 years old], hereby amends his original Verified Petition/Complaint for Writ of Mandamus, Declaratory Relief, and Attorney's Fees, filed on October 14, 2025 (E-Filed October 15, 2025), pursuant to Florida Rule of Civil Procedure 1.190(a). This amendment is filed as a matter of course, as no responsive pleading has been served. The amendment adds defendants, updates factual allegations to reflect ongoing efforts to cover up attorney and judicial misconduct in the 13th Circuit as of November 12, 2025, (including non-responses to additional Public Records Requests 6, 7, and 8), and reiterates the legal bases for relief including on Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution and Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420, and arguments for the extension of Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, to judicial records, at least where there is evidence of systemic corruption. This amended petition is brought pursuant to Rule 2.420(l) for expedited review of the denial of access to judicial branch court and administrative records. To the extent any requested records are subject to a prior determination of confidentiality (none of which has been identified to Plaintiff), this petition also seeks review and vacation of such determination as

permitted under Rule 2.420(d) and (e). All allegations from the original petition are incorporated herein unless modified.

I. Introduction and Parties:

1. This is an action to enforce the fundamental constitutional right of access to judicial branch records under Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution, which declares that "[e]very person shall have the right to inspect or copy any public record made or received in connection with the official business of any public body, officer, or employee of the state, or persons acting on their behalf," expressly including "the legislative, executive, and judicial branches of government." Fla. Const. art. I, § 24(a). This petition invokes the presumption of openness that permeates Florida's constitution and broad jurisprudence on state action, where "public trials and deliberations about court records are presumed open" and any exemptions must be narrowly tailored with the burden on the custodian to justify confidentiality. Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113, 116 (Fla. 1988) (emphasizing that "a strong presumption of public access to the court's records exists" and closure is warranted only *upon specific findings* of necessity, with alternatives considered and restrictions as narrow as possible).
2. Plaintiff seeks a writ of mandamus compelling the production of judicial records unlawfully withheld by the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit and its officers. These records, identified in detail below and in relevant correspondence, relate to judicial bias, corruption, and misconduct in the underlying family law case involving attorneys on both sides and the bench itself (24-DR-001150). The intentional lack of transparency has directly impacted the children's welfare with no legitimate state interest served. The only apparent motive for the initial, strategic production of documents and the more recent complete non-responsiveness is to cover for Courthouse (clubhouse) insiders who wish to avoid consequences for their misconduct.
3. As the Florida Supreme Court has held, the Constitution's access provision "was adopted to ensure public access to all records that by law were made or received by the personnel of these [governmental] institutions or by persons acting on behalf of these institutions," underscoring that judicial records are not exempt from this mandate absent a justified exemption. Media Gen. Convergence, Inc. v. Chief Judge of the Thirteenth Jud. Cir., 840 So. 2d 1008, 1013 (Fla. 2003) Here, the presumption in favor of transparency is critically important given 13th Circuit representatives

misconduct in the case and motive to conceal damaging materials for no reason other than to avoid consequences for misconduct. Allegations of systemic misconduct demand scrutiny, and any claimed exemption must be "no broader than necessary to accomplish the stated purpose" with specificity, as required by Article I, Section 24(c). See also Rhea v. Dist. Bd. of Trs. of Santa Fe Coll., 109 So. 3d 851, 857 (Fla. 1st DCA 2013) (public records laws "liberally construed in favor of openness").

4. Plaintiff also seeks declaratory relief and attorney's fees under Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420(l) and any other basis under the law, including statutory, regulatory, and common law grounds. Although Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, does not directly apply to judicial branch records per Times Publishing Co. v. Ake, 660 So. 2d 691, 698 (Fla. 1995) (holding that "chapter 119 has no application to judicial records" but affirming that Rule 2.420 "provides the public access to judicial records required by article I, section 24 of the Florida Constitution"), access remains independently mandated by the Constitution itself and Rule 2.420, which implement a presumption of openness where exemptions must be narrowly construed. Woodard v. State, 885 So. 2d 444, 446 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004) (reiterating constitutional access to judicial records).
5. In balancing interests here—where high-level judicial misconduct threatens public trust and family welfare—the scales tip decisively toward disclosure, as "the burden of the party seeking closure [is] to prove that closure is necessary," with no reasonable alternative and the least restrictive means employed. Barron, 531 So. 2d at 118. Here, the 13th Circuit has fought transparency at every step, causing great damage to this family and public perception of Florida's judicial system. No prior motion for determination of confidentiality under Rule 2.420(e) or (f) is required for this mandamus action, as the denials are administrative in nature and not based on a court order determining confidentiality.

II. Jurisdiction and Venue

6. This Court has jurisdiction under Article V, §5 of the Florida Constitution, §26.012, Florida Statutes, and Rule 2.420(l)(2) for mandamus review of access denials by judicial branch custodians.
7. Venue (prior to the Court's consideration of the corruption and conflicts involved) is proper in Hillsborough County under §47.011 and Rule 2.420, because the defendants reside here and the cause of action primarily accrued here.

III. Parties

8. Plaintiff Christopher Hanson is a licensed Florida attorney acting on his own behalf and acting as attorney and next friend for his minor children, who are residents of Florida and have a direct interest in the requested judicial records, as they pertain to their welfare in the underlying family law case.
9. Defendant Thirteenth Judicial Circuit Court is the judicial branch entity subject to Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution and Rule 2.420, responsible for maintaining and disclosing judicial records with custodial duties over the Circuit's Court and Administrative records.
10. Defendant Court Administrator/Clerk of the Court for the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit is the entity responsible for custodial duties over judicial records under Rule 2.420(b)(3).
11. Defendant Gina Justice, former Court Administrator, recently left her employment at the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, and no replacement has been named.
12. Defendant Chief Judge Christopher C. Sabella is the Chief Judge of the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, a public officer who oversees administrative operations, including records management, and serves as custodian under Rule 2.420(b)(3).
13. Defendant Judge Kelly Ayers is a judge in the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit and a public officer with potential custodial responsibilities over relevant communications and records under Rule 2.420(b)(3).
14. Defendant Judge Matthew Felix is a judge in the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit and a public officer with potential custodial responsibilities over relevant communications and records under Rule 2.420(b)(3), including those related to emergency filings and recusal in Case No. 24-DR-001150.
15. Defendant Mike Moore is the Public Information Officer for the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, involved in processing public records requests.

IV. Relevant Facts:

16. Plaintiff submitted multiple requests for records including several formal letters (Docket #6, Exhibit A, pp. 3–12) to the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit between July 24, 2025, and September 4, 2025, seeking access to:
 - Judicial disqualification and recusal records and associated documents and communications

- Administrative and all other communications regarding the GAL issue including Judge Ayers' request for a summary and Husband's objection to excusing Attorney Davis from drafting the summary.
- Transcripts and filings referenced in public proceedings
- Email and text communications of Judges Kelly Ayers and Wendy DePaul and their judicial assistants related to this case including those related to scheduling, objections, and disqualification/recusal.
- Visual and audio recordings of specified hearings, primarily the April 4, 2025 hearing, offered by Judge Ayers as part of a lie/threat made on the formal transcript.

17. The Court Administrator's response on August 21, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit B, p. 14), confirmed the existence of records satisfying these requests, acknowledging responsive communications but providing only partial, redacted productions without affidavits confirming complete searches or explanations for omissions. Here, the Court administrator's responses confirm sufficient identification of my legal right to clearly defined information, the Court identified and confirmed its availability (Docket #6, Exhibit B, p. 14). However, in follow-up correspondence on October 9, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit F, p. 20), Plaintiff highlighted the complete absence of any records relating to the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025 hearings in the records produced, despite the Administrator's confirmation of their existence—indicating deliberate withholding.

18. The evidence demonstrates defendants' intent to subvert the truth and conceal evidence of judicial misconduct. (Docket #6, 10, 11). The Court administrator failed to produce the requested records (relating to the 12-13-24 and 1-9-25 hearings prior to and during which, the Court obviously and severely violated plaintiff's due process rights) while providing voluminous records never requested (communications associated with all hearings not referenced in Plaintiff's requests).

19. The Court failed to respond at all to several questions and attempts to investigate the obvious failures to cooperate in good faith with these public records requests. Docket #6, p. 20-24. No court order determining confidentiality of these records has been issued or provided to Plaintiff. This failure contravenes the presumption of transparency, especially amid credible, unrefuted allegations of misconduct at the highest levels of the 13th Circuit. Given the Public Interest in uncovering systemic corruption, any exemption must be narrowly tailored (see Rhea v. Dist. Bd. of

Trustees of Santa Fe Coll., 109 So. 3d 851 (Fla. 1st DCA 2013), stressing that public records laws are to be liberally construed in favor of openness).

20. Plaintiff received responses full of tedious unrequested information while the 13th Circuit sneakily concealed the evidence actually requested and relevant to plaintiff while the Court offered purported justification for withholding the specific video at issue that will show Judge Ayers demonstrating obvious bias in open Court, lying about it, and then offering to get the video in a threatening manner. (Docket #6, 10, 11). Correspondence from Gina Justice, Court Administrator, dated August 21, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit B, pp. 13–15), September 4, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit C, p. 16), and September 8, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit D, p. 17). The Court acknowledged the existence of responsive records, but continued the pattern of clubhouse corruption in concealing the relevant evidence that would expose insider misconduct. There is nothing in the responsive documents from the 13th Circuit that constitutes a formal determination of confidentiality under Rule 2.420(d) or (e). The Court confirmed the existence of relevant evidence while failing to justify deviation from the presumption of openness, particularly given concerns of judicial misconduct that heighten the public interest in transparency (see Barron, 531 So. 2d at 118, requiring overriding public necessity for closure).
21. These responses were inadequate and failed to address key concerns, including the selective omission of materials Plaintiff requested for the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025 hearings. Instead, Ms. Justice produced only voluminous, unrequested records for unrelated proceedings, suggesting an intent to obscure the concealment of evidence of systemic misconduct and corruption in the 13th Circuit. (Docket #6, p. 13-22).
22. The September 8, 2025 letter from Ms. Justice denied access to the April 4, 2025 video recording referencing the confidential nature of Court surveillance video, without ever identifying the April 4 video as coming from the surveillance system. The Court administrator refused to acknowledge Judge Ayers' offering the video on the record, raising concerns about inconsistent treatment, open and obvious bias, and concealment of Public Records to avoid consequences within the Circuit Clubhouse. This denial is administrative and reviewable by mandamus under Rule 2.420(l). The confidentiality referenced lacks the narrow tailoring required for any exemption amid allegations of high-level misconduct in the 13th Circuit (see Media Gen. Convergence, 840 So. 2d at 1013-14, mandating specific findings to overcome the presumption of access).

23. Plaintiff has exhausted all informal remedies and administrative channels, including follow-ups on August 26, August 31, September 9, September 12, September 24, and October 9, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit F, pp. 20–24). Defendants never responded to any of the follow-up requests for documents or explanations from September 9, 2025 forward besides an email from Moore acknowledging receipt and ensuring processing in a “reasonable” time. As of November 12, 2025, no further responses or productions have been received, exacerbating the ongoing harm.

24. On October 14, 2025, Plaintiff submitted additional Public Records Requests 6, 7, and 8 to Defendants, seeking records directly related to the ongoing misconduct in Case No. 24-DR-001150 (Addendum Composite, pp. 1-12), including:

- Request 6: Handling of correspondence with Chief Judge Sabella's office, including emails/letters from January 22, February 12, March 11, August 13, and August 16, 2025, regarding ethical violations by attorney Scott Davis and Judge Ayers' bias/cover-up (Addendum Composite, pp. 1-3).
- Request 7: Communications involving Judge Felix and his assistants about Plaintiff or the case, including emergency filings (Docket Nos. 246, 245, 233, 232, 230, 210, 209, 181) and post-recusal correspondence (Addendum Composite, pp. 4-5).
- Request 8: Judge Ayers' disqualification records/complaints from January 1, 2020, to present, including those related to GAL issues or the Ayo and Iken law firm (Addendum Composite, pp. 6-7).

25. These requests received only a form acknowledgment email on October 14, 2025, with no substantive response, production, timeline, or explanation for delays (Addendum Composite, pp. 8-12, including follow-ups on October 27, 2025 and November 12, 2025, demanding timely compliance. This total silence contrasts with partial responses to earlier requests, suggesting a more direct approach to the Court's obstruction efforts. In their completely unlawful efforts to avoid consequences for the clubhouse insiders guilty of severe misconduct and directly responsible for serious harm to a Florida family, the Court's current actions demonstrate an intentional strategy to subvert the truth to cover for bad judicial actors even at the expense of the citizens they've sworn to serve. The Court has completely failed to offer any materials sought in the most recent requests (e.g., Sabella's non-responsiveness, Felix's involvement, Ayers' disqualifications), further evidencing bad faith and constructive denial.

26. Ongoing failures include:

- Intentional concealment of records relating to due process violations and bias associated with the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearings and the April 4, 2025 video, all with no good faith basis under the Florida Constitution and Rule 2.420.
- No explanation for the Court's concealment and/or lack of any communications regarding the hearings on December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025, which raise concerns about irregular proceedings and concealment given the existence of emails surrounding less controversial matters.
- No clarification on how "security" video exists only for the April 4, 2025 hearing (Docket #6, Docket #198), whether the camera recording that footage is part of an actual security system, and why no similar footage exists for other relevant hearings or cases.
- Refusal to provide any information by email, despite repeated requests, leading to inefficiencies such as Plaintiff's September emails and the Court's September 4, 2025 letter crossing in the mail. This reliance on U.S. Mail appears deliberate to delay access and violates the intent of Rule 2.420 for prompt disclosure.
- No written explanations with specific citations for any withholdings even with the detailed questions posed.
- No response to requests for affidavits describing search methods, including which devices were searched (e.g., personal devices) to confirm completeness.

27. Defendants' complete non-response to these specific concerns and requests, combined with the partial responses (raising significant concerns about strategic withholding/concealment of specific materials of relevance), provides further evidence of bias, bad faith, and systemic corruption. There is an undeniable pattern where 13th Circuit "Clubhouse" members are circling the wagons to protect fellow insiders, in violation of public access rights under Rule 2.420. Such actions undermine the presumption of transparency, especially when misconduct at the highest levels is at stake, requiring strict scrutiny and narrow tailoring of any restrictions (see Rhea, 109 So. 3d at 857).

28. This obstruction has caused ongoing harm to Plaintiff and his family. The October 9, 2025 email (Docket #6, Exhibit F, pp. 20–24) explicitly stated: "The ongoing and intentional concealment of evidence critical to my case... is causing ongoing and increasing damage to my children and my health. I do not believe there's any good faith basis to conceal the evidence identified nor even offer any clarification

regarding the video evidence. I have real concerns about the veracity of some of the representations and the court's failure to even confirm devices searched."

29. Defendants' failure to respond since their September 8, 2025 letter aside from the form response, demonstrates active concealment and bad faith, particularly in light of the pre-suit notice and the problem with misconduct, corruption, and dishonesty in the underlying case.
30. The Thirteenth Judicial Circuit is acting in bad faith, as evidenced by the deliberate pattern of delays, non-responses, and strategically incomplete disclosures that seem to protect Judge Ayers, attorney Scott Davis, and other insiders by concealing extensive evidence that would cause the Court and the bar embarrassment and likely more significant discipline. This pattern heightens the need for transparency to expose misconduct at the highest levels, as the presumption favors disclosure unless narrowly justified (see Barron, 531 So. 2d at 119).
31. The singular issue in the underlying case (24-DR-001150) is Husband's discovery efforts given Wife's concealment of marital assets at the time the parties entered a post-marital agreement without counsel. Attorney Scott Davis, representing Wife, proceeded with a legal strategy to delay, harass, burden, and obstruct Husband's access to obviously discoverable and critically relevant financial discovery, in direct violation of the Florida Bar Rules.
32. Judge Ayers actively assisted Wife and her attorney's obstruction strategies, suppressed evidence of obvious ethical misconduct from multiple attorneys, all to Husband's detriment, and actively sought to advance Wife's clearly retaliatory litigation (e.g., Docket #6, Exhibit G, pp. 25–83, detailing procedural irregularities, suppression of discovery, and failure to address ethical violations; Docket #6, Exhibit H, pp. 84–170, correspondence to Chief Judge Sabella).
33. Plaintiff sought assistance from the Chief Judge on numerous occasions as he consistently ignored the gross misconduct occurring in the Court he's sworn to oversee. (Docket #6, p. 84-170).
34. With respect to requested Court communications on the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearings (Docket #6, p. 3-4, 7-8), Ms. Gina Justice, as Court administrator, intentionally concealed relevant evidence of judicial misconduct while actively burdening Plaintiff with irrelevant and unrequested documents. (Docket #6, 10, 11).
35. The Court Administrator not only failed to comply with the Court's duties under Rule 2.420 and the Florida constitution, the evidence demonstrates intentional deceit

with the Court's voluminous response consisting of unrequested records with the relevant ones requested conspicuously absent. (Docket #6, 10, 11).

36. These actions underscore the need for unhindered public access to records to ensure accountability and strict compliance with the Court's duty to narrowly tailor any Court and administrative records withheld from production, aligning with the constitutional presumption of openness (see Media Gen. Convergence, 840 So. 2d at 1014).
37. The Judicial system has clearly allowed ethical compliance to falter to a point where the events described herein are a reality causing active harm to citizens.
38. A "Fox guarding the hen house" style of oversight dominated proceedings to date in the 13th Circuit and the Public Records request process.
39. The Florida and Federal Constitutions demand transparency to restore public trust in the institution.

V. Legal Basis for Relief

40. Under Article I, §24 of the Florida Constitution, every person has a right to inspect or copy any public record made or received in connection with the official business of any public body, officer, or employee of the state, or persons acting on their behalf, except with respect to records exempted pursuant to this section or specifically made confidential by the Constitution. This includes judicial branch records, with a strong presumption in favor of access (see Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113 (Fla. 1988); see also Woodard v. State, 885 So. 2d 444 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004)).
41. Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420 implements this constitutional right for judicial branch records, establishing procedures for access, exemptions, and review of denials through mandamus or other appropriate relief (Rule 2.420(l)). The rule presumes openness, and exemptions must be narrowly construed. The requested records are "court records" or "administrative records" under Rule 2.420(b)(1) and are not exempt under Rule 2.420(c) unless properly determined confidential, which has not occurred here. Given allegations of misconduct at the highest levels of the 13th Circuit, any claimed exemption must be justified with specificity and narrowly tailored to override the presumption (see Rhea v. Dist. Bd. of Trustees of Santa Fe Coll., 109 So. 3d 851 (Fla. 1st DCA 2013)).
42. While Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, did not apply to judicial branch records under Times Publishing Co. v. Ake, 660 So. 2d 691 (Fla. 1995), Plaintiff submits that the

level of corruption that's festered in the 13th Circuit under these facts require reassessing applicability of Chapter 119 to the Judiciary. Ake should be distinguished or reconsidered here, as the requested records (e.g., communications and videos) are administrative in nature and essential to combating corruption. Nonetheless, relief is independently available under the Federal and Florida Constitutions and Rule 2.420.

43. Defendants' failure to produce records and respond to questions about obvious failure and concealment efforts violates Rule 2.420 and entitles Plaintiff to mandamus relief under Rule 2.420(l) and attorney fees and costs under relevant common law. The Defendants' asserted exemptions are invalid, intentionally misleading, and/or overly broad under Rule 2.420(c), as no specific basis was provided that fits the facts and documents at issue, and no court order determining confidentiality exists under Rule 2.420(d) or (e). (Town of Manalapan v. Rechler, 674 So. 2d 789 (Fla. 4th DCA 1996), finding unreasonable delay or non-response constitutes bad faith warranting fees).
44. The presumption of transparency is particularly vital here to address concerns of judicial misconduct, requiring any withholding to be narrowly tailored (see Media Gen. Convergence, Inc. v. Chief Judge of the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, 840 So. 2d 1008 (Fla. 2003)). The non-responses to Requests 6-8 exemplify this pattern, violating the presumption of openness and shifting the burden to Defendants to justify exemptions (Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113 (Fla. 1988)).
45. The intentional concealment and non-responses to specific inquiries (e.g., devices searched, explanations for lack of footage/communications) demonstrate unreasonable and intentional delay, bad faith, and a pattern of inserting inefficiency in an attempt to advance concealment efforts.
46. The September 8, 2025 response's exemption claim for the April 4, 2025 video is a last-ditch attempt to justify continuing concealment of evidence the Judge offered to provide, when she attempted to use the offer as a threat that might help restore her credibility. (Docket #6, Exhibit E, pp. 18–19) This claim does not meet the requirements for a confidentiality determination under Rule 2.420(d)(1)(B) or (e), failing the narrow tailoring requirement amid high-level misconduct concerns (see Barron, 531 So. 2d at 118).
47. It was immediately after Husband insisted on the record that Ayers follow through with her threat to produce the video when the concealment efforts started, and have now continued ever since. (Docket #6, Exhibit F, pp. 20–24). There are now

multiple layers of misconduct stemming largely from Defendants' efforts to assist Mr. Davis in his misconduct to conceal financial evidence and marital assets. Plaintiff is constitutionally entitled to the very transparency that has the change to restore justice for the Citizens of Hillsborough County.

48. Additionally and alternatively, Defendants' failure to respond to the October 9, 2025 email, which asserted "ongoing and intentional concealment" and fee entitlement, further evidences active bad faith. (Docket #6, Exhibit F, pp. 20–24)
49. Plaintiff is entitled to declaratory relief for himself and on behalf of his minor children under Chapter 86, Florida Statutes, to order production of the materials, clarify the legal duties of the Defendants under Rule 2.420, and/or otherwise mandate compliance.
50. Plaintiff is entitled to attorney's fees under Rule 2.420, Chapter 86, and Common Law for Defendants' bad faith and unreasonable obstruction to accessing Public Records, including enhanced awards for bad faith based on the pattern of delays, obstruction, non-responses to follow-ups, and evidence of bias/concealment. Alternatively, fees are available under §119.12 if Chapter 119 applies, or under common law/equity for bad faith conduct (see *Wood v. Marston*, 442 So. 2d 934 (Fla. 1983)).
51. Mandamus is appropriate where a petitioner demonstrates (1) a clear legal right to the requested relief, (2) an indisputable legal duty on the part of the respondent to perform the act, and (3) the absence of any other adequate remedy at law. See *Huffman v. State*, 813 So. 2d 10, 11 (Fla. 2000). Plaintiff satisfies each element here largely based on admissions from the 13th Circuit Court administrator who responded to the first 5 requests, acknowledging the right, duty, and existence of responsive records. (Docket #6, pp. 13-17).
52. Plaintiff has a clear legal right to access judicial records under Article I, § 24 of the Florida Constitution and Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420, which establish a strong presumption of openness. Second, Defendants, as custodians of judicial and administrative records, have an indisputable legal duty to produce those records unless a valid, narrowly tailored exemption is established. No such exemption or confidentiality finding exists despite the Circuit's obvious efforts toward concealment of its systemic corruption. Plaintiff lacks any adequate alternative remedy, having exhausted informal and administrative channels without response, leaving mandamus as the only mechanism to compel compliance with critical constitutional and statutory duties.

VI. Certification/Declaration:

53. I, Christopher Hanson, declare under penalty of perjury that the following is true and correct to the best of my knowledge:

- I am acting as attorney and next friend for my minor children, whose interests are directly affected by the withheld records in the underlying litigation wrought with corruption, harmful delays and intentional obstruction subverting Truth and Justice, all actively supported by the 13th Circuit Defendants.
- I submitted the public records requests attached as Docket #6, Exhibit A (pp. 3–12).
- I received the responses attached as Docket #6, Exhibit B (pp. 13–15), Exhibit C (p. 16), and Exhibit D (p. 17), and the September 15, 2025 acknowledgment email.
- I reference the transcript excerpts attached as Docket #6, Exhibit E (pp. 18–19), which document the Court’s acknowledgment of video footage and refusal to retrieve it.
- I submitted timely follow-up correspondence, including that included within the October 9, 2025 email chain to Mike Moore, attached as Docket #6, Exhibit F (pp. 20–24).
- I filed the motion to supplement the appellate record attached as Docket #6, Exhibit G (pp. 25–83) due to the video’s critical evidence to the underlying case, which documents bias through procedural irregularities (e.g., pp. 25–26, 32–33 on video offer and non-production; pp. 27–31 on ethical violations ignored).
- Some of the records sought pertain to judicial scheduling, recusal, and procedural communications in Case No. 24-DR-001150.
- The responses from the Court Administrator confirm the existence of responsive records without qualifying the public records sought under any exemptions.
- I have experienced retaliatory conduct following lawful public records requests, including unaddressed questions that independently raise further concerns over bias, corruption and ongoing cover-up attempts during plaintiff’s year and a half under the Court’s jurisdiction.
- The Court administrator (Docket #6, Exhibits B-D) failed to address follow-ups on August 26, August 31, September 9, September 12, September 24, and October 9, 2025. Specifically, Defendants concealed relevant evidence, pursued a strategy of burying Plaintiff in irrelevant, unrequested documents, and refused to offer explanations for lack of communications produced for requested hearings, December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025. The Defendants also specifically failed to qualify the April 4, 2025 hearing video under any exemption and refused Plaintiff’s requests for clarification on "security" video

existence only for April 4, 2025, whether the camera is part of a security system, and why no footage exists for other hearing dates if it's truly "security" footage.

- Judicial officers have obstructed access to records and failed to comply with access rights under Rule 2.420, as evidenced by the pattern of ignored ethical concerns detailed in Docket #6, Exhibits G and H (pp. 84–170). This non-response pattern further confirms the bias, concealment, and "13th Circuit Clubhouse" culture where all the "members" have circled their wagons to protect insiders, violating public access rights.
- I submitted additional Public Records Requests 6, 7, and 8 on October 14, 2025 (Addendum Composite, pp. 1-12), and follow-ups, with no substantive response as of November 12, 2025, further evidencing bad faith.
- The exhibits provide solid unrefuted evidence supporting the 13th Circuit's failures, refusals, and intentional actions in violation of Plaintiff's due process rights.

Certified and executed on November 13, 2025.

/s/Christopher Hanson
 Christopher Hanson
 cahanson77@yahoo.com
 727-409-5738

VII. Prayer for Relief

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff respectfully requests that this Court:

A. Issue a writ of mandamus under Rule 2.420(l) compelling Defendants to produce the following records immediately and without hearing, as time is of the essence:

- all emails and text messages and/or any other form of written communication, sent or received by Judge Kelly Ayers, her judicial assistant, (Dwauna Heyward), and/or any other 13th Circuit representative who participated in scheduling the 12-13-24 hearing on Case No. 24-DR-1150, In Re: The Marriage of Sarah Hanson and Christopher Hanso. Specifically, I'm requesting all of these materials from December 1, 2024, to December 20, 2024, including communications with court staff, attorneys and/or their agents, or others about scheduling and/or attendance at the hearing on December 13, 2024 (per Records request, pp. 3-4),
- all emails and text messages and/or any other form of written communication, sent or received by Judge Kelly Ayers, her judicial assistant (Dwauna Heyward), and/or any other 13th Circuit representative who participated in scheduling the January 9, 2025 hearing on Case No. 24-DR-11550, In Re: The Marriage of Sarah

Hanson and Christopher Hanson. Specifically, I am requesting all of these materials from December 21, 2024, to January 20, 2025, including communications with court staff, attorneys and/or their agents, or others about scheduling and/or attendance at the hearing on January 9, 2025.

- All visual and audio recordings of the April 4, 2025 hearing,
- All emails and text messages and/or any other form of written communication sent or received by Judge Wendy J. DePaul, her judicial assistant, and/or any other 13th Circuit representative who participated in or discussed the recusal in and/or all other documentation regarding Judge DePaul's involvement with Case No. 24-DR-001150, In Re: The Marriage of Sarah Hanson and Christopher Hanson. Specifically, all materials from April 1, 2025, to May 31, 2025, including communications with court staff, other judges, attorneys and/or their agents, or others about the recusal, the decision to recuse, or the issuance of the Order of Recusal dated April 28, 2025. This includes, but is not limited to, any internal memos, notes, drafts, or correspondence related to the recusal process.
- All communications regarding the April 7, 2025 request for summary of Wife's testimony and Husband's motion to strike
- All records responsive to Public Records Requests 6, 7, and 8 dated October 14, 2025 (Addendum Composite, pp. 1-12), including handling of Sabella correspondence, Felix communications, and Ayers disqualification records.
- all public records related to the handling of concerns described in the letters and emails I sent to Chief Judge Christopher C. Sabella and/or his judicial assistant(s) concerning Case No. 24-DR-001150 (In Re: The Marriage of Sarah Hanson and Christopher Hanson) as further specified at Addendum composite (recently filed), p. 1-3.
- all public records of communications involving Judge Felix (and/or his judicial assistant(s)) about Christopher Hanson and/or Case No. 24-DR-001150 (In Re: The Marriage of Sarah Hanson and Christopher Hanson) in the Family Law Division as further specified at Addendum composite (recently filed), p. 4-5.
- all public records related to Judge Kelly Ayers' involvement in any and all disqualification scenarios, complaints, or concerns about her impartiality, honesty, and professionalism as further specified at Addendum composite (recently filed), p. 6-7.

B. Due to the bad faith and efforts in support of concealment exhibited thus far, compel Defendants to provide affidavits describing search targets, methods, including which devices were searched (e.g., personal devices), to confirm completeness of production, what applications, emails, text programs searched to confirm compliance, and if applicable, justification for failing to search personal devices including text messages of Judge Ayers, her assistant, and other individuals involved in the events described above.

C. Compel Defendants to provide written explanations, with specific evidentiary and rule-based citations, for:

- The lack of any communications regarding the hearings on December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025.
- How "security" video exists only for the April 4, 2025 hearing.
- Whether the camera recording footage on April 4, 2025, is part of an actual security system.
- Why no footage exists for other relevant hearings or cases.
- Specification on withholdings or exemptions claimed in the partial responses.
- The delays and inconsistent handling of Requests 6-8 compared to earlier requests.

D. Declare that Defendants violated Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution and Rule 2.420 through unlawful refusal, non-response to clarifications and follow-ups, refusal, and patterns of delay evidencing bias and concealment; to the extent any confidentiality determination exists, declare it invalid and vacate it under Rule 2.420(d) and (e);

E. Award attorney's fees and costs under Rule 2.420(l), §119.12 (alternative), §86.111, and common law/equity for bad faith, including enhancements;

F. Grant such other relief as the Court deems just and proper.

Respectfully submitted,

/s/Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson, as attorney and next friend for his minor children

727-409-5738

cahanson77@yahoo.com

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I HEREBY CERTIFY that a true and correct copy of the foregoing Amended Verified Petition/Complaint for Writ of Mandamus, Declaratory Relief, and Attorney's Fees was filed through the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal and service attempted via the Portal's e-service system on November 13, 2025, (with additional email service directly from Plaintiff) to the following recipients: Clerk of Court for the 13th Judicial Circuit at publicinfo@fljud13.org and rowlanda@fljud13.org, Gina Justice, Court Administrator at gina.justice@fljud13.org, and TCA@fljud13.org, Mike Moore, Public Information Officer, mike.moore@fljud13.org, Judge Kelly Ayers at famlawdivd@fljud13.org, Judge Matthew Felix at famlawdiva@fljud13.org, Judge Christopher Sabella at cornelcm@fljud13.org,

/s/ Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson, Esq.

Florida Bar No. 44094

cahanson77@yahoo.com

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE SECOND JUDICIAL CIRCUIT IN
AND FOR LEON COUNTY, FLORIDA

CASE NO.: [To Be Assigned]

(IN RE) CHRISTOPHER HANSON, individually and as attorney for himself and attorney/next friend for his minor children \[8 years old] and \[6 years old],

Petitioner,

v.

THE FLORIDA BAR, RICHARD COURTEMANCHE, ALLIE HUSTON, and ALICIA GANGI

Respondents.

VERIFIED PETITION/COMPLAINT FOR WRIT OF
MANDAMUS, DECLARATORY RELIEF, AND ATTORNEY'S FEES AND COSTS

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VERIFIED PETITION/COMPLAINT FOR WRIT OF
MANDAMUS, DECLARATORY RELIEF, AND ATTORNEY'S FEES AND COSTS

Petitioner Christopher Hanson, as attorney for himself and next friend and attorney for his minor children, files this Verified Petition for Writ of Mandamus, Declaratory Relief, and Attorney's Fees and Costs against The Florida Bar and its named officers/representatives, pursuant to Article V, Section 5(b) of the Florida Constitution, compelling Respondents to comply with their clear legal duties under the Florida Constitution and the Rules Regulating The Florida Bar, including but not limited to Rules 3-7.1 and 3-7.3, by providing engagement, transparency and access to public records related to Bar Complaint No. W015656-111025 against attorney Scott Paul Davis (RFA No. 25-6861), which among other relief requested, should be reopened for a proper investigation and discipline to deter further misconduct in the cases discussed herein, and for all future litigants in Florida.

1. Petitioner requests relief under Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420(l) for expedited review of the denial of access to judicial branch records, declaratory intervention, and relief under common law, the constitution and in equity.

2. To the extent any requested records are subject to a prior determination of confidentiality (none of which has been identified to Petitioner), this petition also seeks review and vacation of such determination as permitted under Rule 2.420(d) and (e).
3. Petitioner also seeks mandamus and/or declaratory relief relating to failures in handling the unrefuted violations described in the Davis complaint (Appendix, Item 5, pp. 40-64), conflicts of interest within the Florida Bar relating to additional disciplinary matters concerning Petitioner, Judge Ayers, and additional members and representatives of the Florida Bar.

I. Jurisdiction

4. This Court has original jurisdiction to issue writs of mandamus directing The Florida Bar and the other defendants in the performance of its regulatory functions, as the Bar operates under the Court's authority. See Art. V, § 5(b), Fla. Const. (empowering circuit courts to issue writs of mandamus); Art. V, § 15, Fla. Const., R. Regulating Fla. Bar 1-12.1.; see also The Fla. Bar v. Committee, 916 So. 2d 741 (Fla. 2005) (confirming the judiciary's supervisory authority over Bar disciplinary records and processes under Rule 3-7.1).
5. This Court also has jurisdiction over declaratory relief pursuant to Chapter 86, Florida Statutes, which empowers circuit courts to declare rights, status, and other equitable or legal relations, including in cases involving constitutional rights and administrative actions. See §86.011, Fla. Stat.
6. Additionally, this Court possesses inherent equitable jurisdiction to grant relief in equity, including injunctions and other remedies to prevent irreparable harm from ongoing

violations of constitutional and regulatory duties. See Art. V, § 5(b), Fla. Const. (granting circuit courts broad equity powers).

7. Venue is proper in Leon County as the principal place of business for The Florida Bar and the location where the cause of action accrued. See §47.011, Fla. Stat.; The Fla. Bar v. Ray, 797 So. 2d 556 (Fla. 2001) (actions against the Bar typically venued in Leon County).

II. Introduction and Parties

8. This is an action to enforce the fundamental constitutional right of access to judicial branch records under Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution, which declares that "[e]very person shall have the right to inspect or copy any public record made or received in connection with the official business of any public body, officer, or employee of the state, or persons acting on their behalf," expressly including "the legislative, executive, and judicial branches of government." Fla. Const. art. I, § 24(a).
9. This petition invokes the presumption of openness that permeates Florida's constitution and broad jurisprudence on state action, where "public trials and deliberations about court records are presumed open" and any exemptions must be narrowly tailored with the burden on the custodian to justify confidentiality. Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113, 116 (Fla. 1988).
10. Petitioner Christopher Hanson is a resident of Hillsborough County, Florida, and a member of The Florida Bar.
11. He is the complainant in the underlying Bar matter and has standing as the requester of public records under Article I, Section 24, Florida Constitution, and Rule 2.420, as the complainant in the bar complaint against Davis, and as the Respondent in Ayers' complaint

against him, with certain rights including “engagement” with the Bar in the investigation process.

12. As next friend for his minor children, he asserts their interests in records impacting their welfare in the family law case.
13. Respondent The Florida Bar is the custodian of the records at issue, operating as an arm of the judicial branch under Article V, Section 15, Florida Constitution.
14. Respondents Richard Courtemanche, Allie Huston, and Alicia Gangi are Bar officers or representatives involved in the handling, investigation, and/or denial of access to the requested records and information.
15. Petitioner seeks a writ of mandamus compelling the production of records unlawfully withheld by The Florida Bar and its officers, answers to basic questions that went unanswered due to the bar’s failing to “engage” with petitioner (in violation of their own rules), and corrective actions for failures in accountability and damage to public confidence in the judiciary these facts have produced to date.
16. These requests, identified in detail below and in relevant correspondence, relate to attorney misconduct and the Bar’s handling of a complaint against Scott Paul Davis (Florida Bar No. 0074284, RFA No. 25-6861). Appendix Items 1 and 2, p. 1-36).

III. Factual Background

A. Davis’s Misconduct and Concealment of Financial Evidence

17. The facts surrounding the bar complaint against Davis demonstrate Judicial bias and systemic corruption dominating the underlying family law case (24-DR-001150) and the

JQC's handling of Petitioner's complaint on Judge Ayers. (Appendix Items 5, 15, and 16, pp. 40-64, 185-201, 202-205).

18. The ministerial duties the Florida Bar shirked, necessitating this petition/complaint, relate to Davis's and Ayers' misconduct in concealing/suppressing clearly discoverable financial evidence at the core of the parties' dispute as Petitioner explained in his initial filing back in May of 2024.

19. The concealment and suppression of discoverable financial records violated Fla. R. Civ. P. 1.280(b) and ethical obligations under Rule 4-3.4(c) to obey discovery rules. See Appendix Item 17, pp. 244–275 (Writ for Certiorari detailing Judge Ayers' suppression of financial evidence central to equitable distribution); Appendix Item 18, pp. 276–281 (See also Item 19, pp. 282-285, Initial pleading emphasizing urgency of financial discovery).

B. Instead of Addressing Davis's Ethical Violations, Ayers Actively Assists with Suppression.

20. Judge Ayers "fixed" the underlying family law case (24-DR-001150) by repeatedly excusing Davis's misconduct while suppressing efforts to obtain financial discovery, the only reason for any litigation between the parties.

21. These actions contravened Canon 3B(7) of the Florida Code of Judicial Conduct, requiring judges to accord full right to be heard and dispose promptly of proceedings. See Appendix Item 16, pp. 202–243 (Initial brief challenging venue denial and systemic bias).

22. This suppression enabled Davis's tactics of child weaponization—using the children as leverage through unfounded allegations and prolonged litigation—causing ongoing emotional harm to the minor children and delaying resolution for over a year. See Canon 3B(7), Fla. Code Jud. Conduct and Appendix Item 17, pp. 244–275.

23. The initial misconduct involving Davis and then Ayers' refusal to address it triggered a massive cover-up that now encompasses the 13th Judicial Circuit (through withheld records and venue trapping), the Florida Bar (via non-investigation of Davis and advancement of Ayers' retaliatory complaint), and the JQC (via summary dismissal of Petitioner's complaint against Ayers without inquiry).
24. This systemic protectionism prioritizes insiders over public accountability, perpetuating the harm to Petitioner's family and eroding judicial integrity. Williams-Yulee v. Fla. Bar, 575 U.S. 433, 445 (2015) (emphasizing impartiality in disciplinary processes to avoid due process violations); See Appendix Items 16–19, pp. 202–285 (collective evidence of systemic failures, retaliatory complaints, and concealment of core records). Appendix Item 15, pp. 185-201 (JQC complaint against Ayers illustrating interconnected conflicts and lack of transparency); Appendix Item 10, pp. 97-119 (Ayers' retaliatory Bar complaint as evidence of abuse of process).

C. The Florida Bar Violates its Own Rules in Protecting Davis (and Ayers) from Accountability for their Misconduct:

25. The Florida Bar's intentional lack of transparency and refusal to engage, even in direct violation of Rules 3-7.1 and 3-7.3, have directly harmed petitioner and his family with no legitimate state interest served.
26. The only apparent motive for the refusal to engage and continuing concealment of materials exchanged with Davis from the partial production of documents (on November 10, 2025) is to cover for insiders who wish to avoid consequences for their misconduct.

27. The unrefuted and irrefutable nature of Davis's misconduct make it impossible for anyone to actually excuse or justify his (Ayers's and others') actions, so silence and concealment are the only ways to accomplish their unwavering goal to protect insiders.
28. As the Florida Supreme Court has held, the Constitution's access provision "was adopted to ensure public access to all records that by law were made or received by the personnel of these institutions or by persons acting on behalf of these institutions," underscoring that judicial records are not exempt from this mandate absent a justified exemption. Media Gen. Convergence, Inc. v. Chief Judge of the Thirteenth Jud. Cir., 840 So. 2d 1008, 1013 (Fla. 2003).
29. Here, as in any case where evidence points to broad systemic corruption and insider protectionism at the expense of litigants and the public in general, the presumption in favor of transparency is critically important given the Bar's role in regulating the legal profession and citizens' access to justice. Id.
30. In a "lawyers policing lawyers" system like The Florida Bar's self-regulatory framework, transparency is a constitutional mandate, a safeguard against inherent conflicts and potential corruption.
31. The public interest demands heightened access to records where, as here, there are allegations of broad systemic corruption and insider protectionism, enabling unchecked judicial and attorney misconduct. See The Fla. Bar v. Davis, 661 So. 2d 1193, 1197 (Fla. 1995) (noting that public confidence in judicial integrity erodes when corruption is perceived, emphasizing the need for transparency to maintain trust).

32. On February 18, 2025, Petitioner filed a detailed complaint with The Florida Bar against Attorney Scott Paul Davis (Florida Bar No. 0074284) for still unrefuted ethical violations in family law case 24-DR-001150, including delays, harassment, concealment, and child weaponization tactics. (Appendix Item 5, pp. 40-64.)
33. Despite repeated good-faith efforts to engage—documented in a 25-page email chain spanning February to November 2025—the Bar provided form acknowledgments to a fraction of his efforts and no meaningful investigation, interview, nor interest in the additional evidence and clarification offered. (Appendix Item 2, pp. 12-36.)
34. The complaint was improperly dismissed without probable cause, exonerating Davis despite substantiated allegations. (Appendix Item 6, p. 65.) To date, Davis has never disputed any of the specific facts alleged in the complaint despite many opportunities in pleadings, correspondence, and in open Court.
35. Petitioner sought closed file reviews and appeals, but the Bar's opacity and refusals to engage persisted. (Appendix Items 3-4, pp. 37-39.)

D. The Florida Bar Continues to Protect Insiders from Accountability as it Refuses to Comply with Constitutionally Mandated Transparency:

36. On November 10, 2025, in response to public records request W015656-111025, the Bar provided incomplete records, omitting substantive communications with Davis except a typographical error email. (Appendix Item 2, pp. 12-36.)
37. Petitioner's December 1, 2025, follow-up narrowed the inquiry to four specific questions about Davis communications, privilege claims, and a confidentiality index, but received no response. (Appendix Item 1, pp. 1-11.)

38. Petitioner's detailed follow up from December 15, 2025 received only further disinterest, stating, "This matter is closed."

39. This non-responsiveness mirrors the Bar's pattern since February 2025, including failures under Rule 3-7.3(c) (preliminary investigation) and Rule 3-7.1(b) (public records - concealment of rebuttal materials and correspondence with Davis).

40. The Bar's handling contrasts sharply with its advancement of a vague, retaliatory complaint against Petitioner by Judge Kelly Ayers (File No. 2026-10,395(13F)), requiring Petitioner's formal response while potentially excusing Davis entirely. (Appendix Items 9-12, pp. 96-127.)

41. The withheld records are essential to ensuring accountability for misconduct, restoring fairness in the family law case, and rehabilitating confidence in the judiciary.

E. The Florida Bar fails to meet its Burden in Justifying the Refusals to Engage and Comply with Constitutional Transparency

42. The Bar has never offered any explanation nor any rebuttal materials for its decision to dismiss the bar complaint beyond the absurd idea that it was deferring the disciplinary issues to co-conspirator (also guilty of severe misconduct), Ayers.

43. No exemptions apply in that the Florida Bar has still not even disclosed whether rebuttal materials exist nor what correspondence with Davis was ever sent or received.

44. Per The Florida Bar, "the matter is closed" making the records public under Rule 3-7.1(b), which expressly defines "public record" to include "any reports, correspondence, papers, and other materials furnished to, served on, or received from the respondent." See R.

Regulating Fla. Bar 3-7.1(b) (emphasizing that closed cases without probable cause become public records); see also The Fla. Bar v. Committe, 916 So. 2d 741, 745 (Fla. 2005) (interpreting Rule 3-7.1 to require public access absent valid confidentiality exemptions).

45. Specifically, the Florida Bar continues to conceal records, correspondence, and other materials sent to or received from Attorney Davis fall squarely within this definition, while refusing to answer basic questions. (Appendix Items 1, 16, pp. 1-11, 202-205).

46. The Bar refuses even to confirm whether a response or rebuttal materials were ever submitted by Davis, a position that defies the plain language of Rule 3-7.1 and undermines the constitutional presumption of openness articulated in Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113, 116 (Fla. 1988).

47. The burden is on the custodian to justify its refusal to engage with Petitioner on the Bar Complaint and any claimed exemptions from .

48. These refusals to engage, answer the simple questions and/or provide a privilege log are directly contrary to Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution.

49. Such secrecy erodes public confidence and makes judicial intervention imperative.

IV. Conflicts of Interest and Systemic Corruption

50. The Bar's conduct underscores systemic conflicts of interest.

51. Its refusal to investigate substantiated and unrefuted allegations against Attorney Scott Paul Davis parallels the retaliatory complaint advanced by Judge Kelly Ayers against Petitioner—a complaint filed as File No. 2026-10,395(13F) and advanced by the Bar despite its vague

and unsupported (even unnamed) allegations. (Appendix Items 9-10, pp. 96-119; see also Appendix Item 11, pp. 120-122 (Petitioner's response to retaliatory complaint).)

52. At the same time, the Bar dismissed the Davis complaint without requiring Mr. Davis to offer any alternative explanation for the severe and intentional pattern of ethical violations outlined in Petitioner's Bar complaint. (Appendix Item 6, p. 65)

53. This selective enforcement and use of the Bar to protect insiders and attack those who demand accountability violates due process and expands corruption in the judicial system. See Williams-Yulee v. Fla. Bar, 575 U.S. 433, 445 (2015) (discussing the importance of impartiality in Bar disciplinary processes to avoid due process concerns); see also The Fla. Bar v. Ray, 797 So. 2d 556, 559 (Fla. 2001) (emphasizing fair application of disciplinary rules to maintain public trust).

54. This disparity and the continuing refusals to comply with constitutionally mandated transparency confirms the institutional bias favoring judicial insiders over complainants, warranting mandamus to address the absurdity and restore equity. (See Appendix Item 15, pp. 185-201 (related JQC complaint against Judge Ayers illustrating interconnected conflicts)).

55. The underlying family law misconduct ongoing for more than a year exemplifies the harm to litigants that including judicial bias in case 24-DR-001150, further compounds these issues. (Appendix Items 17, 18, pp. 206-275).

56. Petitioner's motion to disqualify Judge Ayers details patterns of favoritism and non-transparency that the Bar and JQC ignored. (Appendix Item 7, pp. 66-78.)

57. The Bar's non-engagement perpetuates this cycle, as evidenced in ongoing appellate motions challenging systemic failures. (Appendix Item 13, pp. 129-141.)

58. Such conduct not only harms Petitioner's family but undermines the Bar's regulatory integrity.

V. Legal Arguments for Mandamus and Relief

A. Mandamus to Compel Record Production and Reopen the Bar Complaint for Proper Handling Consistent with the Facts and Law described Herein:

59. A petitioner seeking a writ of mandamus must establish three key elements: (1) a clear legal right to the requested relief; (2) that the respondent has an indubitable legal duty to perform the requested action, which must be ministerial rather than discretionary; and (3) the absence of any other adequate legal remedy.

i. Clear legal right:

60. Petitioner has a clear legal right to the requested relief, including full access to public records related to Bar Complaint No. W015656-111025 and the reopening of the investigation into attorney Scott Paul Davis's misconduct, as guaranteed by Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution, which mandates public access to judicial branch records, and by Rule 3-7.1 of the Rules Regulating The Florida Bar, which defines such correspondence and reports as part of the public record absent justified exemptions—which none exist here. See *The Fla. Bar v. Committee*, 916 So. 2d 741, 745 (Fla. 2005) (mandamus appropriate to enforce access to Bar records under Rule 3-7.1 where confidentiality not established).

61. The Bar's Failure to Engage and Provide Transparency Under Rule 3-7.1: Rule 3-7.1(b) defines "public record" broadly to include "any reports, correspondence, papers ... furnished to, served on, or received from the respondent."

62. Petitioner has repeatedly requested confirmation of communications with Mr. Davis beyond a minor typo email, yet the Bar refuses to disclose or even index such materials, claiming privilege in direct conflict with Rule 3-7.1(b). (Appendix Items 1-2, pp. 1-36.)

63. This opacity violates the Bar's mandate for constitutional transparency, as Florida's constitution and due process require access to records impacting private rights.

64. The Bar's position—that only a judicial finding of misconduct triggers action—creates an absurd barrier when the judge (Ayers) is implicated, enabling systemic evasion to the great detriment of citizens and their confidence in the judicial system.

ii. Indubitable Legal Duty (Ministerial, Not Discretionary)

65. Respondents, including The Florida Bar and its officers Richard Courtemanche, Allie Huston, and Alicia Gangi, have an indubitable legal duty to perform the requested actions, which are ministerial in nature—such as providing access to non-confidential records under Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420 and conducting a proper preliminary investigation under Rule 3-7.3(c)—as these duties involve no discretion but rather mandatory compliance with established rules to ensure transparency and accountability in attorney discipline (see Appendix Item 17, pp. 244-275, detailing unaddressed violations).

66. To rehabilitate confidence in these institutions, the Bar must immediately produce: · All communications with Mr. Davis or his representatives; (Appendix Item 1, pp. 1-11

(unanswered questions on these communications)) or a sworn affidavit confirming none exist;

- A detailed privilege/confidentiality index for any withheld items;
- Confirmation of searches, including personal devices of all Bar employees and representatives who worked on the case; and
- A written explanation of the search process and devices searched to ensure compliance and transparency.
- Sworn statements from defendants described further below.

67. Accordingly, mandamus and/or declaratory relief is necessary to require the Bar to reopen the complaint against Mr. Scott Davis and perform a proper investigation with the engagement required by the rules. See Tyson v. Fla. Bar, 826 So. 2d 265, 267 (Fla. 2002) (entertaining mandamus petition to compel Bar to reopen disciplinary investigation where initial closure was inadequate); see also Fla. Bar v. Thompson, 979 So. 2d 917, 919 (Fla. 2008) (affirming court's authority to review Bar actions via mandamus for failure to fulfill duties).

68. As part of the order, necessary to ensure accountability and protect the public, Petitioner requests the Court appoint an independent counsel and/or tribunal to oversee the investigation into the Davis complaint.

69. The Court's authority to compel reopening of a disciplinary matter arises from its inherent supervisory power over The Florida Bar under Article V, Section 15 of the Florida Constitution.

70. Independent oversight is imperative given the levels of insider protectionism and systemic corruption at the expense of litigants.

iii. No Other Adequate Remedy at Law

71. Petitioner has no other adequate remedy at law, as informal requests for records and engagement have been ignored or denied despite months of documented efforts (as evidenced by the email correspondence in Appendix Items 1-2, pp. 1-36), and administrative appeals within The Florida Bar are unavailable or ineffective given the systemic issues alleged, leaving mandamus as the only means to compel compliance and prevent irreparable harm to public confidence in the judicial system.

72. Without this writ, the Bar's ongoing failures will continue to perpetuate unchecked attorney misconduct, further eroding trust in Florida's legal institutions and causing direct, ongoing harm to Petitioner, his minor children, and other litigants similarly situated, with no alternative forum or process capable of providing timely and complete relief.

B. Declaratory Relief:

73. Petitioner seeks a declaration that Respondents' withholding violates Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution, Rule 3-7.1, and Rule 2.420, as the records are public and no valid exemption justifies secrecy.

74. This pattern—advancing a retaliatory complaint from Judge Ayers while dismissing substantiated allegations against Davis—demonstrates selective enforcement and institutional self-preservation.

75. This further justifies declaratory relief including payment of petitioner's attorney's fees and costs to enforce constitutional transparency and deter future misconduct.
76. Florida courts have emphasized that transparency is essential to maintain trust in judicial and quasi-judicial bodies. See *Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc.*, 531 So. 2d 113, 116 (Fla. 1988) (presumption of openness places burden on custodian to justify confidentiality); *Florida Bar v. Ray*, 797 So. 2d 556 (Fla. 2001) (truth as defense to criticism; supports exposure of misconduct).
77. Given the Bar's refusal to engage with the complainant and its failure to justify dismissal, declaratory relief is necessary to enforce constitutional mandates and deter future misconduct.
78. Petitioner further seeks a declaration that Respondents' advancement of a retaliatory complaint against Petitioner while simultaneously ignoring substantiated allegations against Attorney Scott Paul Davis constitutes an abuse of process and violates Petitioner's due process rights under the Florida and United States Constitutions.
79. Such selective enforcement and systemic bias undermine public confidence in the integrity of the disciplinary system and warrant judicial intervention to prevent further harm and restore fairness. See *Williams-Yulee v. Fla. Bar*, 575 U.S. 433, 446 (2015) (highlighting due process implications in uneven Bar enforcement).

C. Public Interest, Hardship, and Irreparable Harm

80. The obstacles the 13th Circuit and the Florida Bar have created to avoid transparency and having to explain their excusal of such obvious and intentional misconduct would be determinative for most litigants; they would simply never have access to justice. (See

Appendix Item 14, pp. 142-184, referencing the article "Foxes Guarding the Courthouse"
 Link: <https://x.com/Truthoverchaos/status/1992245722901577796?s=20>.)

81. Even more concerning, the obstacles to engagement and transparency would forever bury the misconduct David and Ayers committed in these facts for over a year.
82. Petitioner is in a unique position in that his many years of litigation experience allowed him to notice and document these almost unbelievably obvious and severe violations of the ethical rules for over a year; as pointed out in the article, "Foxes Guarding the Courthouse," this is the perfect storm to bring accountability to those guilty of ethical violations including those at the Florida Bar who violated their own rules, in part of the attempted cover-up. (See Appendix Item 14, pp. 142-184).
83. These obstacles to transparency and refusals to engage cause significant delays and damages during times that are inherently difficult and stressful; perpetuating systemic issues like insider protectionism and avoiding transparency mandates places future litigants, who rely on the Bar to uphold ethical standards under Article V, Section 15 of the Florida Constitution, at increased risk of harm. (See Appendix Items 5, 15, and 16, pp. 40-64, 185-201, 202-205, evidencing unaddressed misconduct in the underlying family law case (24-DR-001150) and related complaints.)
84. The facts of this case are likely not unique, raising concern over how many families Ayers' and Davis's misconduct unfairly impacted in the time prior to and after the events described herein, creating increased urgency for action from this Court. (See Appendix Item 17, pp. 244-275, detailing suppression of evidence central to family welfare.)

85. This hardship is compounded by the Bar's refusal to engage, forcing Petitioner into this petition as a last resort, with no adequate compensation for the time, stress, and family suffering caused by a dispute that should have been resolved over a year ago but for the misconduct and cover-ups described herein.

D. Bad Faith and Willful Non-Compliance:

86. Respondents' actions evidence bad faith, including willful delays, strategic concealment of information/documents, and selective enforcement.

87. The Bar ignored repeated requests for engagement under the rules since February 2025, provided incomplete records, and failed to justify exemptions, suggesting an intent to shield insiders amid corruption allegations.

88. Bad faith warrants mandatory fees under § 119.12(1), Fla. Stat., where unlawful refusal occurs (even analogously for judicial records should the Court refuse expansive consideration of 119.12(1)), as courts award fees to deter such conduct and promote compliance. *New Times, Inc. v. Monroe County Sheriff's Office*, 245 So. 3d 740 (Fla. 3d DCA 2018). See also *Bd. of Trs., Jacksonville Police & Fire Pension Fund v. Lee*, 189 So. 3d 120, 125 (Fla. 2016) (holding that agencies must pay fees for unlawful withholding of public records, even absent bad faith, to encourage compliance).

E. Attorney's Fees and Costs:

89. Petitioner is entitled to attorney's fees and costs under multiple grounds, including Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420(l) for mandamus relief from denials of access to judicial records; Chapter 86, Florida Statutes, and §86.111 for declaratory relief based on bad faith and unreasonable obstruction; and common law and equity principles for

Respondents' pattern of delays, non-responses, failure/refusal to engage, obstruction, bias, and concealment, warranting enhanced awards as exemplified in *Town of Manalapan v. Rechler*, 674 So. 2d 789 (Fla. 4th DCA 1996) (unreasonable delay or non-response constitutes bad faith) and *Wood v. Marston*, 442 So. 2d 934 (Fla. 1983) (fee awards for bad faith conduct).

90. Alternatively, fees are available under §119.12, Florida Statutes, if Chapter 119 applies, particularly given the systemic corruption in the 13th Circuit necessitating a reassessment or distinction of *Times Publishing Co. v. Ake*, 660 So. 2d 691 (Fla. 1995), where the requested records are administrative in nature and essential to combating corruption; under equitable principles and public interest exceptions to deter future misconduct and prevent burdens on citizens enforcing constitutional guarantees, as affirmed in *Woodard v. State*, 885 So. 2d 444 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004) (fee entitlement in mandamus actions implicating public interest transparency); and independently under the Federal and Florida Constitutions for violations of Article I, Section 24 and due process rights.
91. Respondents' unlawful withholding of records and aggressive refusal to engage as required by the rules, all in bad faith, evidenced by ongoing delays since February 2025, selective omissions, and complete non-responses to recent inquiries on information that must be in the public record, further supports this entitlement.
92. Courts have recognized that mandamus actions involving transparency justify fee awards to deter future misconduct and ensure citizens are not burdened for enforcing constitutional guarantees. *Woodard v. State*, 885 So. 2d 444 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004) (affirming fee entitlement in mandamus actions implicating public interest transparency).

See also *Bd. of Trs. v. Lee*, 189 So. 3d at 125 (mandatory fees for unlawful records withholding to promote access). VI. V. Clear Legal Duty and No Adequate Remedy

VI. Conclusion:

93. The Bar has a ministerial duty to engage with the complainant, conduct at least a preliminary investigation, and disclose public records.

94. It's failed in all of those duties as described herein and demonstrated in the appendix materials.

95. Mandamus is appropriate where, as here, administrative remedies are exhausted and no alternative exists. See *Fla. Bar v. Thompson*, 979 So. 2d 917 (Fla. 2008). ; see also *Tyson v. Fla. Bar*, 813 So. 2d at 1022 (mandamus lies to compel Bar's performance of clear duties in disciplinary matters).

96. As Petitioner has made clear throughout this process, time is of the essence and timely orders on these issues are appropriate given the Bar's failure to respond or otherwise engage for several months.

VII. Prayer for Relief

WHEREFORE, in addition to the relief already requested, Petitioner respectfully prays this Court:

1. Declare Respondents' actions relating to the deficiencies described above violative of Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution; Rule 3-7.1; and Rule 2.420

2. Issue a writ of mandamus compelling:

- Immediate production of all requested records including but not limited to all materials sent to and/or received from Mr. Davis and/or anyone on his behalf. Specifically, this includes all communications involving Mr. Davis to or from Alicia Gangi, Allie Huston, and all other bar employees and representatives or a sworn statement confirming none exist;

- A detailed privilege log;

- Searches of personal devices of all Bar employees and representatives involved in the matter;

- A written explanation of the search process and devices searched;

3. Reopen the Davis complaint and conduct a proper investigation required by the Rules.

4. Require Mandatory engagement with Petitioner regarding the Bar's handling of the Davis complaint under Rule 3-7.3(c).

5. Appoint independent counsel or tribunal to oversee the Davis investigation and the initial mishandling of it to ensure impartiality, accountability, and public confidence.

6. Require Ms. Gangi and Ms. Huston to complete sworn statements explaining the failure/refusal to "engage" with Petitioner regarding the Davis bar complaint and describing any conversations with Mr. Davis and anyone else with whom the complaint and related matters were discussed. Order Ms. Gangi and Ms. Huston to appear for depositions should questions remain after review of the sworn statements.

7. Require Mr. Courtemanche to Huston to complete a sworn statements explaining the refusal to comply with bar rules and transparency requirements with an order to appear for deposition should questions remain after review of the sworn statements.

8. Order Judge Ayers to provide a sworn statement advising of any and all statements from Petitioner she believes to be untrue and dismiss the retaliatory Bar complaint against Petitioner (File No. 2026-10,395(13F)) as an abuse of process and violation of due process rights.
9. Refer the Judicial Qualifications Commission's dismissal of Petitioner's complaint against Judge Ayers to the Florida Supreme Court for review and reassessment, given the systemic conflicts and lack of transparency documented herein. (Appendix Item 15, pp. 185-201.)
10. Appoint another independent counsel or tribunal to oversee the investigation and handling of bar complaints (not yet filed due to concerns of bias, insider protectionism and systemic corruption in the FL Bar, but) necessary for other individuals involved in the facts discussed herein. The Bar finding the obvious misconduct in those related cases still to come would further highlight the Bar's failures in the Davis case, so an independent counsel is necessary for objectivity.
11. Find Section 119 applicable to these proceedings involving significant systemic corruption and a quasi-judicial body acting more as a state agency, making Chapter 119's requirements critical for public protection.
12. Award reasonable attorney fees and costs under Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420(l) for mandamus relief; Ch. 86, Fla. Stat., and §86.111 for declaratory relief based on bad faith and obstruction; common law/equity for Respondents' delays, non-responses, failure to engage, obstruction, bias, and concealment, warranting enhanced awards per Town of Manalapan v. Rechler, 674 So. 2d 789 (Fla. 4th DCA 1996) and Wood v. Marston, 442 So. 2d 934 (Fla. 1983). Additionally and alternatively under §119.12, Fla. Stat., if Ch. 119 applies, given the agency like functions of the Florida Bar and systemic corruption requiring reassessment of Times Publishing Co. v. Ake, 660

So. 2d 691 (Fla. 1995); under equitable/public interest principles to deter misconduct per Woodard v. State, 885 So. 2d 444 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004); and under the Florida Constitutions for violations of Art. I, § 24 and due process rights.

13. Pursuant to Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420(l), grant expedited review of Respondents' denial of engagement and access to Bar records, within 30 days of this filing, to prevent further irreparable harm from ongoing opacity, delays in family law proceedings, and erosion of public confidence in the judicial system, as detailed in Sections III (Factual Background) and V. C (Public Interest, Hardship, and Irreparable Harm)

14. Grant such other relief as the Court deems just and proper to ensure transparency, deter future misconduct, and restore public confidence.

15. Petitioner specifically requests a jury trial for any and all issues so triable.

Verification:

I, Christopher Hanson, on December 17, 2025, swear under penalty of perjury that the foregoing is true and correct based on my personal knowledge.

/s/ Christopher Alan Hanson
Christopher Alan Hanson

Certificate of Service

I HEREBY CERTIFY that a true and correct copy of the foregoing Verified Petition for Writ of Mandamus, Declaratory Relief, and Attorney's Fees has been furnished by email to:

The Florida Bar
Attn: Richard Courtemanche, Allie Huston, Alicia Gangi,
651 East Jefferson Street

Tallahassee, Florida 32399-2300

rcourtemanche@floridabar.org; acapintake@floridabar.org; agangi@gunster.com

on this 17th day of December, 2025.

/s/ Christopher Alan Hanson

Christopher Alan Hanson

FL Bar No. 44094

Cahanson77@yahoo.com

727-409-5738

3934 E Eden Roc Cir

Tampa FL 33634



ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICE OF THE COURTS
THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT OF FLORIDA

December 18, 2025

**ORIGINAL SENT VIA USPS
& SCANNED COPY SENT VIA EMAIL**

Mr. Christopher Hanson
3934 E. Eden Roc Circle
Tampa, Florida 33634-7418
Cahanson77@yahoo.com

Dear Mr. Hanson:

Your correspondence sent to Christina Novia on October 14, 2025, regarding your *"Public Records Request – Handling of Correspondence with Chief Judge Christopher C. Sabella's Office Regarding Case No. 24-DR-001150"* was forwarded on to me for response.

As you have been advised in previous correspondence, Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, does not apply to records of the judicial branch of government. *Times v. Ake*, 660 So. 2d 255 (Fla. 1995) (the judicial branch of government is not an "agency" subject to Chapter 119, Florida Statutes). Therefore, we are treating your public records request as a request for administrative records of the judicial branch in accordance with Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420 and article I, section 24 of the Florida Constitution.

According to Rule 2.420(m)(3), fees for copies of judicial records are the same as provided in section 119.07, Florida Statutes. Section 119.07(4)(a)1 authorizes the assessment of 15 cents per page and section 119.07(4)(d) authorizes the assessment of a special service charge if the nature or volume of public records is such as to require extensive use of information technology resources or extensive clerical or supervisory assistance.

The nature and volume of the records your broad request seeks will require extensive clerical or supervisory assistance. As such, prior to furnishing any of the judicial records that you have requested, we will need to receive an advance deposit of the special services charge.

In calculating an estimate of the special services charge to fulfill this specific request regarding records related to the handling of correspondence with Chief Judge Sabella, 1,122 emails have been identified that may be responsive to your broad public records request. The total estimated special services charge of \$512.19, as documented below, does not include

Mr. Christopher Hanson
 December 18, 2025
 Page 2

shipping charges or the 15-cent per page duplication cost. We cannot estimate the shipping and duplication charges until we determine how many non-confidential records are responsive to your request.

FUNCTION	TIME	RATE	COST
Paralegal to review 1,122 emails for confidential information and, if applicable, redact confidential information from those records	Estimated time: 9.35 hours (30 seconds per e-mail = $1,122 \times 30 = 33,660$ seconds $\div$ 60 seconds = 561 minutes $\div$ 60 minutes = 9.35 hours)	\$40.04 per hour (\$29.66 base pay plus 35% benefits)	\$374.37
Staff counsel to review paralegal's work	Estimated time = 1.5 hours	\$91.88 per hour (\$68.06 base pay plus 35% benefits)	\$137.82
TOTAL ESTIMATED SPECIAL SERVICES CHARGE			\$512.19

Please be advised that in order to begin the work of reviewing the identified records for confidential information, we must first receive a deposit of \$512.20. You may submit a check for this amount made payable to "BOCC" to my assistant: Janice Albury, Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, George Edgecomb Courthouse, 800 East Twiggs Street, Room 604, Tampa FL 33602.

After the records are reviewed and confidential information is redacted from these records, a final invoice will be prepared and provided to you indicating the special services charge actually incurred, the shipping charges, and the duplication costs. If the amount due on the final invoice is more than your deposit, then you will be required to pay the difference prior to delivery of the records. If the amount due on the final invoice is less than your deposit, we will start a refund process when we send you the non-confidential records.

Sincerely,



Richard T. Melendi
 Chief Deputy Court Administrator - Operations

cc: K. Angela Smith, Interim Court Administrator



ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICE OF THE COURTS
THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT OF FLORIDA

December 17, 2025

**ORIGINAL SENT VIA USPS
& SCANNED COPY SENT VIA EMAIL**

Mr. Christopher Hanson
3934 E. Eden Roc Circle
Tampa, Florida 33634-7418
Cahanson77@yahoo.com

Dear Mr. Hanson:

This letter is response to our email exchange of December 3, 2025, regarding your "Narrowed *scope of Public Records Request for Ayers and Felix materials and Request for immediate compliance.*"

As you have been advised in previous correspondence, Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, does not apply to records of the judicial branch of government. *Times v. Ake*, 660 So. 2d 255 (Fla. 1995) (the judicial branch of government is not an "agency" subject to Chapter 119, Florida Statutes). Therefore, we are treating your public records email request as an amended request for administrative records of the judicial branch in accordance with Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420 and article I, section 24 of the Florida Constitution.

According to Rule 2.420(m)(3), fees for copies of judicial records are the same as provided in section 119.07, Florida Statutes. Section 119.07(4)(a)1 authorizes the assessment of 15 cents per page and section 119.07(4)(d) authorizes the assessment of a special service charge if the nature or volume of public records is such as to require extensive use of information technology resources or extensive clerical or supervisory assistance.

The nature and volume of the records your amended request seeks will require extensive clerical or supervisory assistance. As such, prior to furnishing any of the judicial records that you have requested, we will need to receive an advance deposit of the special services charge.

In calculating an estimate of the special services charge to fulfill the amended request regarding Judge Felix's records, 2,154 emails have been identified that may be responsive to your amended public records request. The total estimated special services charge of \$973.39, as documented below, does not include shipping charges or the 15-cent per page duplication

Mr. Christopher Hanson
 December 17, 2025
 Page 2

cost. We cannot estimate the shipping and duplication charges until we determine how many non-confidential records are responsive to your request.

FUNCTION	TIME	RATE	COST
Paralegal to review 2,164 emails for confidential information and, if applicable, redact confidential information from those records	Estimated time: 18.0 hours (30 seconds per e-mail = $2,164 \times 30 = 64,920$ seconds + 60 seconds = 1,082 minutes + 60 minutes = 18.0 hours)	\$40.04 per hour ($\29.66 base pay plus 35% benefits)	\$720.72
Staff counsel to review paralegal's work	Estimated time = 2.75 hour	\$91.88 per hour ($\68.06 base pay plus 35% benefits)	\$252.67
TOTAL ESTIMATED SPECIAL SERVICES CHARGE			\$973.39

Please be advised that in order to begin the work of reviewing the identified records for confidential information, we must first receive a deposit of \$973.39. You may submit a check for this amount made payable to "BOCC" to my assistant: Janice Albury, Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, George Edgecomb Courthouse, 800 East Twiggs Street, Room 604, Tampa FL 33602.

After the records are reviewed and confidential information is redacted from these records, a final invoice will be prepared and provided to you indicating the special services charge actually incurred, the shipping charges, and the duplication costs. If the amount due on the final invoice is more than your deposit, then you will be required to pay the difference prior to delivery of the records. If the amount due on the final invoice is less than your deposit, we will start a refund process when we send you the non-confidential records.

Sincerely,



Richard T. Melendi
 Chief Deputy Court Administrator - Operations

cc: K. Angela Smith, Interim Court Administrator



ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICE OF THE COURTS
THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT OF FLORIDA

December 17, 2025

**ORIGINAL MAILED VIA USPS
& SCANNED COPY SENT VIA EMAIL**

Mr. Christopher Hanson
3934 E. Eden Roc Circle
Tampa, Florida 33634-7418
Cahanson77@yahoo.com

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According to Rule 2.420(m)(3), fees for copies of judicial records are the same as provided in section 119.07, Florida Statutes. Section 119.07(4)(a)1 authorizes the assessment of 15 cents per page and section 119.07(4)(d) authorizes the assessment of a special service charge if the nature or volume of public records is such as to require extensive use of information technology resources or extensive clerical or supervisory assistance.

The nature and volume of the records your amended request seeks will require extensive clerical or supervisory assistance. As such, prior to furnishing any of the judicial records that you have requested, we will need to receive an advance deposit of the special services charge.

In calculating an estimate of the special services charge to fulfill the amended request regarding Judge Ayers' records, 432 emails have been identified that may be responsive to your amended public records request. The total estimated special services charge of \$236.02, as documented below, does not include shipping charges or the 15-cent per page duplication

Mr. Christopher Hanson
December 17, 2025
Page 2

cost. We cannot estimate the shipping and duplication charges until we determine how many non-confidential records are responsive to your request.

FUNCTION	TIME	RATE	COST
Paralegal to review 432 emails for confidential information and, if applicable, redact confidential information from those records	Estimated time: 3.6 hours (30 seconds per e-mail = $432 \times 30 = 12,960$ seconds $\div 60$ seconds = 216 minutes + 60 minutes = 3.6 hours)	\$40.04 per hour (\$29.66 base pay plus 35% benefits)	\$144.14
Staff counsel to review paralegal's work	Estimated time = 1.0 hour	\$91.88 per hour (\$68.06 base pay plus 35% benefits)	\$91.88
TOTAL ESTIMATED SPECIAL SERVICES CHARGE			\$236.02

Please be advised that in order to begin the work of reviewing the identified records for confidential information, we must first receive a deposit of \$236.02. You may submit a check for this amount made payable to "BOCC" to my assistant: Janice Albury, Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, George Edgecomb Courthouse, 800 East Twiggs Street, Room 604, Tampa FL 33602.

After the records are reviewed and confidential information is redacted from these records, a final invoice will be prepared and provided to you indicating the special services charge actually incurred, the shipping charges, and the duplication costs. If the amount due on the final invoice is more than your deposit, then you will be required to pay the difference prior to delivery of the records. If the amount due on the final invoice is less than your deposit, we will start a refund process when we send you the non-confidential records.

Sincerely, .



Richard T. Melendi
Chief Deputy Court Administrator - Operations

cc: K. Angela Smith, Interim Court Administrator

Re: Additional Public Records Requests, Follow up for Compliance on Previous requests, and the Court's bad faith in attempting to avoid Constitutional Duties

From: cahanson77@yahoo.com (cahanson77@yahoo.com)

To: publicinfo@fljud13.org; tca@fljud13.org; melendrt@fljud13.org; truthoverchaos@outlook.com

Date: Friday, December 19, 2025 at 10:22 AM EST

Good morning. I received your recent correspondence detailing quotes for public records access, just to determine cost of reproduction.... that already totals something approaching \$2,000.

Before I consider paying so much money for these records, I need to know that the 13th Circuit is not going to engage in the type of the still unexplained activity described below - document dumping unrequested records in an attempt to hide the intentional concealment. As explained again below - "The issue, as I've repeatedly explained, is that your office engaged in classic "document dumping" with a side of "intentional concealment"—a form of discovery abuse where a party floods the requester with voluminous, irrelevant materials (in this case, communications from unrequested hearings) to bury or conceal the specifically targeted records."

This is exactly what I believe the 13th Circuit did in relation to materials on the 12-13-24 and 1-9-25 hearing materials addressed below. It demonstrates a willingness to violate any semblance of ethical duties when the objective is protecting insiders like Ayers.

This needs a response. What is the 13th Circuit's position on this. It was a narrow issue when I requested these materials months ago. The Court's attempt to hide its deceit and concealment did not work. Please respond with the Court's position today. It has gone on far too long, in bad faith.

Thank you for your cooperation and I look forward to hearing from you.

Chris

On Thursday, December 4, 2025 at 05:07:18 PM EST, cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com> wrote:

Good afternoon, Mr. Melendi,

Thank you for your response, but it is blatantly disingenuous and further exemplifies the 13th Circuit's pattern of obstruction and bad-faith tactics in handling public records requests. You reference the August 21, 2025, mailed response and the records I picked up on August 26, 2025—as if I were unaware of them. Of course I know; I immediately scanned those 377 pages (including duplicates) and emailed them back to your office to create a verifiable record of what was produced. The issue, as I've repeatedly explained, is that your office engaged in classic "document dumping" with a side of "intentional concealment"—a form of discovery abuse where a party floods the requester with voluminous, irrelevant materials (in this case, communications from unrequested hearings) to bury or conceal the specifically targeted records.

At this point, it's blatantly obvious it's not an honest mistake; it's sanctionable bad-faith conduct under Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420 and the Florida Constitution. It's insider protectionism no matter the judicial misconduct or the damage that it causes. It's reprehensible conduct for 13th Circuit professionals to act this manner - intentionally hindering access and eroding constitutional rights. It certainly qualifies as willful misconduct that exposes individuals to personal liability under 42 U.S.C. § 1983 for what's far beyond deliberate indifference to due process and public access rights under the First and Fourteenth Amendments.

I've sent you the chain containing the timely and persistent follow up on the 12-13-24 and 1-9-25 records multiple times.

This is from the attached email I sent back on 8-31-25 enclosing the paper copies provided:

"I picked up paper copies of the records after paying the requested fees at the courthouse the day I first received the letter. However, I've encountered issues that require further action: incomplete/unreadable records, missing communications, and a lack of documentation regarding devices searched. The provided documents lack critical communications, such as documents involving the authority to schedule the December 13, 2024, hearing on such an emergent basis, over a pro se litigant's objections. Of particular concern is the after-hours decisions on December 12, 2024. No records show Judge Ayers directing or being informed of the scheduling, despite my objection to the date due to unavailability (emails to Heyward, December 11 and 12, 2024). This contrasts with the Court's handling of other emergency motions, such as my December 30, 2024, motion, which received judicial review. No communications indicate Judge Ayers was aware of Scott Davis's intent not to attend the January 9, 2025, hearing, despite his email to Heyward on January 8, 2025, stating his intent not to attend, which elicited an immediate objection from myself. It's concerning that these documents were not produced in the initial response. Please ensure a search for all text messages and after-hours communications related to the hearings on December 13, 2024 and

January 9, 2025, as they are critical to the records request. Also, no records confirm that my objections to the December 13, 2024, hearing or Davis's non-attendance at the January 9, 2025, hearing were forwarded to Judge Ayers. Please verify whether these communications were shared with her, as their absence suggests a procedural oversight critical to my appeal (Case No. 2D2025-1936).]The absence of any documented correspondence between Judge Ayers and Dwauna Heyward regarding the scheduling of the December 13, 2024, hearing, my objection to it due to unavailability (emails to Heyward, December 11 and 12, 2024), and my objection to Scott Davis's non-attendance at the January 9, 2025, hearing (emails to Heyward and Davis, January 8-9, 2025) is highly irregular, especially given Ayers's documented involvement in other case management matters. There is a concern over a lack of judicial oversight that prejudiced my due process rights as a pro se litigant."

I scanned those in and provided them back to you contemporaneously in anticipation of something like this. I am surprised that a judicial organization like the 13th Circuit can be this corrupt although you all certainly confirm it again and again. The Administrator's misconduct with the "document dumping" further illustrates the intentional concealment with respect to the hearings that involve serious attorney and judicial misconduct. It also confirms that you consider such correspondence "public records" The amount of emails for the unrequested hearings confirm for me that you all are hiding some really interesting stuff. It still doesn't give you the right to conceal it.

What has the 13th Circuit done to comply with its constitutional obligations in response to my 8-31 email quoted above and the various follow ups also in the chain??

All you're doing is delaying the inevitable and ruining another Christmas for this family. I hope someone there still has some integrity and becomes a whistleblower on the truly disgusting levels of corruption that have infected your organization.

The 13th Circuit is not above the constitution and certainly not above the truth. If you are telling me that for the 12-13-24 and 1-9-25 hearings, there is no correspondence responsive to the requests, provide an affidavit confirming a thorough search (including personal devices and accounts) by close of business tomorrow. Otherwise, produce them immediately, without further excuses or fees. What do you hope to accomplish by continuing to dodge these simple issues? I look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,
Christopher A. Hanson, Esq.
Florida Bar No. 44094

727-409-5738

cahanson77@yahoo.com

On Thursday, December 4, 2025 at 03:09:20 PM EST, Melendi, Rick <melendrt@fljud13.org> wrote:

Good afternoon Mr. Hanson,

This email serves as a follow-up response to your email of December 3, 2025 at 4:38 p.m.

As it relates to your request for materials related to the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearings, a public records response addressing the records from those dates was mailed to you on August 21, 2025. In fact, a revised records response dated August 26, 2025, along with the records satisfying the request were produced and picked up by you at the Courts Business Center on August 26, 2025.

Sincerely,

Rick Melendi

From: cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com>

Sent: Wednesday, December 3, 2025 4:38 PM

To: Info, Public <publicinfo@fljud13.org>; recordsrequests@fljud13.org; TCA <TCA@fljud13.org>; Melendi, Rick <MELENDRT@fljud13.org>

Subject: Re: Additional Public Records Requests, Follow up for Compliance on Previous requests, and the Court's bad faith in attempting to avoid Constitutional Duties

Caution: This is an external email. Please take care when clicking links or opening attachments. When in doubt, contact the Helpdesk.

Good afternoon. That is completely unacceptable as to the longstanding requests for materials related to the 12-13-24 and 1-9-25 hearings that the Administrator's office purposefully concealed, while providing the equivalent of what was requested, but only for all of the hearings, not requested, and thus not relevant. If you're trying to restart the clock on that, it's patently absurd and just another transparent attempt at delay, obstruction and concealment, further demonstrating the need for searches of all relevant personal devices about coordination and insider protectionism.

If the "amended public records request" is referring only to the 2 narrowed requests specifically relating to your recent cost estimates on Ayers and Felix materials, I could understand that.

Please clarify your position and explain why I still do not have those materials on the 12-13-24 and 1-9-25 hearings so I may continue to take appropriate action.

Thank you for your cooperation.

On Wednesday, December 3, 2025 at 03:47:48 PM EST, Melendi, Rick <melendrt@fjud13.org> wrote:

Good afternoon Mr. Hanson,

In accordance with your email request of December 2, 2025, please be advised that we are treating your requests as an Amended Public Records Request. A search of the records consistent with the outlined terms of your amended requests, specifically contained in the - **Narrowed scope of Public Records Requests for Ayers and Felix materials and Request for Immediate compliance** section of your email, will be

conducted and a response will be provided in accordance with Rule 2.420(m) of the Florida Rules of General Practice and Judicial Administration.

Thank you for your attention in this matter.

Sincerely,

Rick Melendi

From: cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com>

Sent: Tuesday, December 2, 2025 6:15 AM

To: Melendi, Rick <MELENDRT@fljud13.org>; Info, Public <publicinfo@fljud13.org>; recordsrequests@fljud13.org; TCA <TCA@fljud13.org>

Subject: Additional Public Records Requests, Follow up for Compliance on Previous requests, and the Court's bad faith in attempting to avoid Constitutional Duties

Caution: This is an external email. Please take care when clicking links or opening attachments. When in doubt, contact the Helpdesk.

Good afternoon Mr. Melendi. I received 2 letters from you via mail since our conversation and email below. It only took you about 2 minutes to send the email below. I requested during our conversation and many other times throughout my efforts to obtain constitutional transparency, that you send such correspondence by email. Is there a reason why you're continuing to use mail and only obliged with the request for emailing documents on the one occasion reflected below?

I am writing primarily in response to your recent letters dated November 25, 2025, and November 26, 2025, regarding my public records requests for materials related to Judges Ayers and Felix. Before addressing the excessive fee demands outlined in those letters, I must first highlight my concerns over whether the 13th Circuit will ever simply provide relevant and consequential materials in its possession given the clear pattern of obstruction in your office's handling of my requests. While a relatively minor one, the refusal to simply email documents seems to be an effort to, at a minimum, slow down my efforts to obtain transparency. I think forcing me to pick up printed copies was part of that attempt to blur the lines of what was actually produced. I foresaw that concern and immediately scanned everything provided to me and sent it back to the 13th Circuit electronically, thus creating a record of precisely what was produced.

There is a very serious and sneaky violation of the Judicial code of conduct when one looks at my initial records requests and the Court's voluminous responsive documents. The Court, thru its administrator at the time, engaged in bad faith litigation/discovery tactics usually employed only by the most unscrupulous of lawyers:

- **"Selective Disclosure as Obstruction: Overburdening with Unrequested Records to Evade Relevant Production"**
- **"Concealment Through Volume: Provision of Irrelevant Materials as a Tactic to Hinder Access to Targeted Records"**

Given that the Court has unrefutably engaged in these tactics, and still has not produced the relevant communications requested all the way back in July demonstrates a willingness to conceal evidence of insider misconduct at all costs. I'll proceed with the state court litigation and proceed to Federal Courts to expose this as soon as time permits. However, I understand you were not involved in the production of those records. I hope that you and/or Ms. K. Angela Smith, interim Court Administrator will see how blatant and severe the cover up attempts have been and begin to offer real transparency consistent with your constitutional duties. I intend to pursue all available civil claims against all those involved in such egregious misconduct that has already impacted me and my family significantly.

Intentionally Deceitful, Obstructive and Bad Faith Production: Flooding with Irrelevant Records to Conceal and Deny Access to Requested Materials

As detailed in my initial public records requests (see the attached Composite of First 5 Public Records Requests.pdf, particularly the requests dated July 24, 2025, and subsequent follow-ups), I specifically sought all emails, text messages, and other communications related to the scheduling or attendance at the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025, hearings in Case No. 24-DR-001150. These requests were narrow, targeted, and directly tied to allegations of procedural irregularities and potential misconduct in my case—issues that are central to my ongoing appeal and my amended petition for writ of mandamus (Case No. 25-CA-10255).

In response to these narrow, targeted requests, your office has provided correspondence related to other hearings (which I did not request), while completely withholding or ignoring the materials for the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025, hearings. This selective production does not fulfill my requests and raises obvious concerns about intentional concealment.

Under Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420, you have a duty to produce all responsive records without unreasonable delay or artificial barriers. Providing irrelevant materials while evading the core requests constitutes an extremely concerning constructive denial and further evidence of bad faith, especially given the public interest in transparency regarding judicial bias and systemic corruption. The 13th Circuit's reactions to my attempts to ensure constitutional transparency are antithetical to the Court's most basic function providing further evidence of wrongdoing and raising even greater concerns about what the Court system is hiding on behalf of Ayers and others.

The 13th Circuit's apparent bad faith and intentional avoidance of constitutional transparency include violations of various Rules on Judicial conduct:

- Canon 2A of the Florida Code of Judicial Conduct (requiring judges and staff to avoid impropriety and the appearance of impropriety, which is violated by tactics that suggest manipulation to protect insiders and erode public trust in the judiciary).
- Canon 3B(2) of the Florida Code of Judicial Conduct (requiring judges to ensure court officials and staff act ethically, breached by failing to oversee

administrators who engage in obstructive responses).

- Canon 3B(7) of the Florida Code of Judicial Conduct (requiring judges to accord every person the right to be heard according to law, violated by obstructing access to relevant records, thereby denying due process in ongoing litigation).
- Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420 (mandating custodians provide access without unreasonable delay or barriers, breached by selective or obstructive production that creates artificial hurdles to transparency)

Request for bare minimum compliance with my initial public Records requests from July 2025 seeking correspondence and materials related to the 12-13-24 and 1-9-25 hearings clearly and sneakily concealed ever since.

I request immediate production of the withheld correspondence for the specified hearings, including any communications on personal devices. If these records do not exist, please provide an affidavit confirming a thorough search, including the devices and accounts searched. Failure to comply promptly will be added as additional grounds in the public records litigation strengthening my claim for attorney's fees and costs, and potential damages against individuals who violated their duties with actual malice under 42 U.S.C. § 1983 (authorizing personal liability against state actors for intentional or deliberate indifference to violations of federal constitutional rights, such as due process under the 14th Amendment, where qualified immunity may be overcome if the conduct was objectively unreasonable and the right was clearly established) and Florida Statute § 768.28(9)(a) (waiving sovereign immunity and allowing personal tort liability for state employees or agents who act in bad faith, with malicious purpose, or in a manner exhibiting wanton and willful disregard of human rights, safety, or property, which aligns with an "actual malice" or willful misconduct standard in obstructing public records access tied to constitutional protections. I would hope that someone within the 13th Circuit, perhaps the interim administrator, will see that supporting a corrupt judge and system to the detriment of citizens is wrong. All I'm asking of you and the Ms. Smith is to follow your constitutional mandates and seek whistleblower protection if necessary.

Regardless, there is no basis for the sneaky manner in which the Court burdened me with voluminous records, not requested, while withholding the equivalent for the

hearings requested.

Please immediately provide me with all correspondence and materials relating to the 12-13-24 and 1-9-25 hearings. Or provide some justification for the Court's handling of it to date. Failure to accomplish that this week is a willful violation of 42 U.S.C. § 1983 and will require Civil Litigation for damages on that basis alone if not rectified.

Unreasonable fee demands designed to deter my efforts to obtain records under the constitution to protect insider misconduct: Request for itemized breakdown,

Regarding the fee demands—nearly \$8,000 for Judge Ayers' disqualification materials and \$350 for Judge Felix's records—these appear grossly inflated, unjustified, and demanded as part of a larger pattern to continue to conceal further evidence of Judge Ayers' misconduct. I believe any continuing attempts to support or protect Ayers' at the expense of me and my family are intentionally malicious and unlawful. Special service charges are limited to actual costs for "extensive" requests, based solely on the lowest-paid employee's salary and benefits for time directly spent. *Please provide an immediate itemized breakdown, including:*

- *Specific tasks performed or anticipated.*
- *Hours estimated, with hourly rates.*
- *Justification for classifying these requests as "extensive."*
- *Any consideration of a fee waiver or reduction due to the overwhelming public interest in exposing potential judicial misconduct and systemic corruption in the 13th Circuit, as detailed in my petition* (see AGO 2000-11).

These fees seem designed to deter access, which violates Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution. To mitigate costs, I request the option to inspect the records in person on-site at your office, without any copying charges, as permitted under § 119.07(1)(a), F.S., which allows free inspection under supervision. Please advise on available times for such an inspection and confirm that no fees will apply for review alone.

Narrowed scope of Public Records Requests for Ayers and Felix materials and Request for immediate compliance.

Additionally, to further narrow the scope and reduce potential costs, for the Judge Felix records, please limit the search to communications, emails, pleadings, or correspondence specifically related to venue transfer or change of venue in Case

No. 24-DR-001150, including any from or referencing Chris Hanson (or Christopher Hanson), as well as keywords such as "Ayers," "venue change," "transfer venue," "bias," "recusal," "misconduct," "bias," "Hanson v. Hanson," "due process violation," "disqualification," "conflict of interest," or "appeal transfer." This refinement should make the request less burdensome while focusing on the most relevant materials. For the Judge Ayers requests, please produce only the requested records for all cases that involve the law firm, Ayo and Iken. Again, time is of the essence. You've already identified thousands of emails. Please narrow that to include only cases involving Ayo and Iken and let me know when I can review those materials avoiding additional costs meant to deter my efforts to obtain constitutional transparency.

Further Inquiries Regarding the Court's Ongoing Concealment of Video of the April 4, 2025 Hearing Offered by Judge Ayers on the Record in Open Court

Regarding the April 4, 2025 hearing video, which Judge Ayers explicitly referenced and offered to obtain during the proceedings (as reflected on page 75 of the hearing transcript), I inquire whether the 13th Circuit has conducted a formal balancing test under Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution and cases like Barron v. Florida Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113 (Fla. 1988), weighing the overwhelming public interest in transparency—particularly in exposing judicial bias and misconduct—against any claimed security exemption under Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420(c)(8) and Fla. Stat. § 119.071(3)(a).

Judge Ayers' on-the-record statement introducing the video's relevance and her intent to provide it post-hearing appears to waive or undermine any blanket exemption, yet your office continues to classify it as non-disclosable "surveillance footage" without explanation, contributing to unreasonable delays in violation of § 119.07(1), F.S., especially as I have been awaiting responsive materials since July 2025.

Has anyone at the 13th Circuit, including Chief Judge Sabella or relevant staff, even viewed the video to assess its contents or confirm its classification? Please clarify the distinction between "security cameras" (as claimed) and cameras specifically designed or positioned to capture courtroom hearings, including whether this video was recorded via a dedicated judicial recording system rather than general surveillance. To facilitate review and ensure compliance, please provide a privilege log or detailed description identifying the camera(s), system, and technical specifications used for the recording, along with any metadata or logs showing

access or review history, within 5 business days to avoid further escalation in my mandamus petition. This serves as an additional and separate Public Records request for the these materials.

Conclusion:

I hope that under the interim Court Administrator, Ms. Smith, I will begin to find some compliance. I do not seem to have her email address, but please forward this to her with a copy to me. Given the 13th Circuit's demonstrated bad faith in handling prior requests—flooding me with unrequested materials while concealing the very communications I sought for the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025, hearings—it is absurd and further indicative of obstruction to now demand over \$8,000 for additional records. This pattern of evasion, in direct violation of constitutional duties under Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution and § 119.07, F.S., undermines any claim to good faith and bolsters my arguments for fee waivers, expedited production, and personal liability for those involved

As I noted in my November 13, 2025, email (attached for reference), I remain open to clarifying any aspects of my requests to facilitate compliance. However, the pattern of delays, selective responses, and prohibitive fees must end. Please respond substantively this week or I will proceed with further escalating the litigation to eventually involve claims for personal liability for willful and malicious violations of public duties. I understand how badly the Court wants this to go away. It will not happen until there are consequences for all involved in this intentional corruption involving so many different actors all willing to harm my family to protect insiders. This goes against the most basic duty you all have as Court officials and eventually, it will be addressed with the seriousness it requires.

Thank you for your immediate attention. Sincerely,

Christopher A. Hanson

3934 E Eden Roc Cir

Tampa, FL 33634

727-409-5738

cahanson77@yahoo.com

Attachments:

- [Recent responses to records requests demanding over \\$8,000 for transparency](#)
- [Composite of first 5 public records requests.pdf](#)
- [11-13 follow up on records email to Melendi.pdf](#)
- [10-9-25 EMAIL chain to Moore.pdf](#)

On Thursday, November 20, 2025 at 05:32:38 PM EST, Melendi, Rick <melendrtr@fljud13.org> wrote:

Good evening Mr. Hanson,

As you requested during our conversation today at 4:50 p.m., attached is a copy of the letter I mailed to you on November 19, 2025.

Sincerely,

Rick Melendi



Rick Melendi
Chief Deputy
Court
Operations
800 E. Twiggs
St.
Edgecomb
6040
Tampa, FL
33602
P: (813) 272-
5371
www.fljud13.org

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
IN AND FOR HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA
CIVIL DIVISION

CHRISTOPHER HANSON,
Plaintiff/Petitioner,

vs.

CASE NO.: 25-CA-10255
DIVISION: "B"

THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT COURT
CLERK OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT,
CHIEF JUDGE CHRISTOPHER C.
SABELLA, JUDGE KELLY AYERS, GINA
JUSTICE (or current court administrator), MIKE
MOORE,
Defendants/Respondents.

Verified motion to disqualify all 13th Judicial Circuit Judges and for reassignment to a neutral circuit Pursuant to § 38.10, Fla. Stat.; Fla. R. Gen. Prac. & Jud. Admin. 2.160; and Canon 3E(1)

Introduction and procedural posture

1. This is an original circuit court action under Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, and Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution, seeking a writ of mandamus to compel production of unlawfully withheld public records, declaratory relief, and attorney's fees and costs, directly impacting Plaintiff and his minor children in Case No. 24-DR-001150.
2. The withheld records concern a yearlong pattern of severe misconduct and systemic corruption. Plaintiff seeks documentation including that related to judicial communications, scheduling, recusal, hearing videos, and related materials likely to produce further evidence of and explanation for the bias, corruption, and misconduct within the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit throughout the proceedings in Case No. 24-DR-001150.

3. On October 15, 2025, this Court entered an order transferring this case to the Second District Court of Appeal. On October 16, 2025, the Court vacated that transfer order. The Court has indicated it believes it lacks jurisdiction to consider any claim against another judge in this circuit but will retain the case because nonjudicial respondents are named.
4. The barrier presented here is not subject-matter jurisdiction; it is an institutional conflict of interest. The proper remedy is disqualification of all Thirteenth Judicial Circuit judges and reassignment to a neutral circuit.

Legal basis for disqualification and reassignment

5. Section 38.10, Florida Statutes, requires disqualification where a party fears they will not receive a fair trial due to bias or interest. Rule 2.160(f) mandates that a legally sufficient motion be granted immediately, with no further action taken by the disqualified judge. Canon 3E(1) requires disqualification where impartiality might reasonably be questioned.
6. A circuit-wide institutional conflict arises where the court itself is a named defendant, sitting judges (including the Chief Judge) are parties, and the litigation challenges the administrative integrity and conduct of circuit personnel. In such circumstances, reassignment outside the circuit is functionally mandatory to preserve due process and public confidence.
7. There is an institutional due process problem with respect to the 13th Circuit's handling of any litigation involving the undersigned either as a party or as an attorney.
8. Pursuant to Walls v. State, 910 So. 2d 432 (Fla. 4th DCA 2005), and Mulligan v. Mulligan, 877 So. 2d 791 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004), disqualification of a judge in one matter due to bias, conflict, or the appearance of impropriety extends broadly to related or

interconnected proceedings involving the same parties, attorneys, or institutional interests, ensuring the preservation of due process and public confidence in the judiciary.

9. In Walls, the Fourth District Court of Appeal granted a writ of prohibition disqualifying a trial judge in a criminal case where the judge had previously recused herself in an unrelated pending matter involving the same defendant, holding that such prior recusal created legally sufficient grounds for disqualification to avoid any reasonable fear of partiality.
10. Similarly, in Mulligan, the court mandated disqualification across all cases involving a specific attorney after the judge recused in one instance due to a personal conflict with that attorney, emphasizing that recusal in a single case necessitates removal from any related or ongoing matters to prevent systemic bias.
11. Here, the institutional entanglement and conflicts inherent in this public records action—where the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit itself, its Chief Judge, and other judges are named defendants accused of misconduct, bias, and concealment directly tied to the underlying family law proceedings in Case No. 24-DR-001150, create an irreconcilable appearance of impropriety for all judges within the circuit. This requires disqualification not only in this case but also in the related family law matter to uphold the integrity of the judicial process.

Factual background

12. Between July 24, 2025 and September 4, 2025, Plaintiff submitted multiple public records requests to the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit and the Clerk, seeking judicial disqualification and recusal records, administrative communications concerning the GAL issue, transcripts referenced in public proceedings, emails and texts of Judges Kelly Ayers

and Wendy DePaul and their judicial assistants related to scheduling and objections, and visual and audio recordings of specified hearings.

13. Despite statutory deadlines and persistent follow-up, Defendants failed to produce requested records, provide lawful justifications, or respond to specific inquiries. Partial responses from Court Administrator Gina Justice on August 21, September 4, and September 8, 2025 acknowledged the existence of responsive records but asserted exemptions and demanded payment without full production. The Court uniformly failed to respond as to what devices were searched as part of the response process. Communications related to the hearings and issues with extreme bias concerns were conspicuously absent from the responses.
14. The September 8, 2025 response specifically denied access to the April 4, 2025 hearing video based on confidentiality claims, despite Judge Ayers referencing and offering the video on the record, raising concerns of inconsistent treatment and concealment efforts once her threat to produce the video did not produce the result she hoped.
15. Plaintiff exhausted informal remedies and administrative channels with follow-ups on August 26, August 31, September 9, September 12, September 24, and October 9, 2025. There were no substantive responses following September 9, 2025 beyond an acknowledgment from Mike Moore, constituting constructive denial and evidence of bad faith.
16. Specific failures include: no affidavits describing search methods or devices (including personal devices); no explanation for the lack of communications regarding the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearings; no clarification as to the existence of “security” video only for April 4, 2025 (Docket #198), whether the camera is part of a

security system, and why no similar footage exists for other hearings; refusal to provide information by email and reliance on U.S. Mail to delay access; and no written explanations with specific statutory citations for any withholdings.

17. Defendants' non-response to targeted inquiries, coupled with partial responses and the absurd bias and results in the related family law case, reveal bias and a "clubhouse" rules protection pattern among circuit insiders, violating Florida public records law. This obstruction has caused ongoing harm to Plaintiff and his family, including escalating damage to the children and Plaintiff's health.
18. The pattern of delays, non-responses, and incomplete disclosures appears designed to protect Judge Ayers and avoid production of evidence that could result in embarrassment or discipline. The underlying family case hinges on Husband's financial discovery efforts in the face of Wife's concealment of marital assets; court actions have assisted obstruction and suppressed evidence of ethical misconduct by multiple attorneys.
19. Exhibits attached to the Petition and prior filings include: composite requests; Gina Justice's letters; the September 8, 2025 video denial; April 4, 2025 transcript excerpts documenting the court's acknowledgment of video; the October 9, 2025 email chain to Mike Moore; and correspondence to Chief Judge Sabella detailing non-responses.
(Docket #6).

Clarification regarding prior transfer order and Escambia County

20. The vacated transfer order cited § 26.012, *Dept. of Com'ty Affrs. v. Escambia Cnty.*, 582 So. 2d 1237, 1239 (Fla. 1st DCA 1991). *Escambia* involved a jurisdictional framework where circuit court review of certain quasi-judicial actions was barred; it did not involve the circuit itself as a party nor an institutional conflict necessitating disqualification. Here,

other circuits have jurisdiction to hear a mandamus action compelling ministerial public records duties; the impediment is local judicial conflict, not a statewide jurisdictional bar.

Verified declaration

21. I, Christopher Hanson, declare under penalty of perjury that the statements made herein and those from the Verified Petition and corresponding Exhibit Composite (Docket #3, 6), all incorporated here by reference, are true and correct to the best of my knowledge.

Relief requested

22. Disqualify all judges of the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit from presiding over this case and the related case, Case No. 24-DR-001150, based on *Walls* and *Mulligan*.
23. Request administrative reassignment by this Court, the 13th Circuit's Chief Judge, and/or the Chief Justice of the Florida Supreme Court to a neutral judge in another circuit (e.g., the Tenth Judicial Circuit, Polk County).
24. Maintain the case in circuit court jurisdiction, consistent with Article V, § 5(b), Florida Constitution, and § 26.012, Florida Statutes, and proceed under Rule 2.160(f) with immediate disqualification and no further action by any conflicted judge.
25. Award attorney's fees and costs under § 119.12, Florida Statutes, and grant such other relief as is just and proper.

Certified and executed on October 31, 2025,

/s/ Christopher Hanson
 Christopher Hanson, Esq.
 Florida Bar No. 44094
 cahanson77@yahoo.com |
 727-409-5738

Certificate of Service

I HEREBY CERTIFY that a true and correct copy of the foregoing Verified Motion to Disqualify All 13th Judicial Circuit Judges and for Reassignment to a Neutral Circuit, along with all accompanying exhibits (if any), was filed through the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal and service attempted via the Portal's e-service system on October 31, 2025, (with additional email service directly from Plaintiff) to the following recipients: Clerk of Court for the 13th Judicial Circuit at info@hillsclerk.com 13th Judicial Circuit Court at rowlanda@fljud13.org, TCA@fljud13.org, as Court Administrator per email from Gina Justice who left her employment at the 13th Circuit, Mike Moore, Public Information Officer, mike.moore@fljud13.org Judge Kelly Ayers at famlawdivd@fljud.org Judge Christopher Sabella at cornelcm@fljud13.org.

/s/ Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson, Esq.

Florida Bar No. 44094

cahanson77@yahoo.com (<mailto:cahanson77@yahoo.com>)

727-409-5738

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE SECOND JUDICIAL CIRCUIT IN
AND FOR LEON COUNTY, FLORIDA

CASE NO.: [To Be Assigned]

(IN RE) CHRISTOPHER HANSON, individually and as attorney for himself and attorney/next friend for his minor children \[8 years old] and \[6 years old],

Petitioner,

v.

THE FLORIDA BAR, RICHARD COURTEMANCHE, ALLIE HUSTON, and ALICIA GANGI

Respondents.

VERIFIED PETITION/COMPLAINT FOR WRIT OF
MANDAMUS, DECLARATORY RELIEF, AND ATTORNEY'S FEES AND COSTS

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VERIFIED PETITION/COMPLAINT FOR WRIT OF
MANDAMUS, DECLARATORY RELIEF, AND ATTORNEY'S FEES AND COSTS

Petitioner Christopher Hanson, as attorney for himself and next friend and attorney for his minor children, files this Verified Petition for Writ of Mandamus, Declaratory Relief, and Attorney's Fees and Costs against The Florida Bar and its named officers/representatives, pursuant to Article V, Section 5(b) of the Florida Constitution, compelling Respondents to comply with their clear legal duties under the Florida Constitution and the Rules Regulating The Florida Bar, including but not limited to Rules 3-7.1 and 3-7.3, by providing engagement, transparency and access to public records related to Bar Complaint No. W015656-111025 against attorney Scott Paul Davis (RFA No. 25-6861), which among other relief requested, should be reopened for a proper investigation and discipline to deter further misconduct in the cases discussed herein, and for all future litigants in Florida.

1. Petitioner requests relief under Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420(l) for expedited review of the denial of access to judicial branch records, declaratory intervention, and relief under common law, the constitution and in equity.

2. To the extent any requested records are subject to a prior determination of confidentiality (none of which has been identified to Petitioner), this petition also seeks review and vacation of such determination as permitted under Rule 2.420(d) and (e).
3. Petitioner also seeks mandamus and/or declaratory relief relating to failures in handling the unrefuted violations described in the Davis complaint (Appendix, Item 5, pp. 40-64), conflicts of interest within the Florida Bar relating to additional disciplinary matters concerning Petitioner, Judge Ayers, and additional members and representatives of the Florida Bar.

I. Jurisdiction

4. This Court has original jurisdiction to issue writs of mandamus directing The Florida Bar and the other defendants in the performance of its regulatory functions, as the Bar operates under the Court's authority. See Art. V, § 5(b), Fla. Const. (empowering circuit courts to issue writs of mandamus); Art. V, § 15, Fla. Const., R. Regulating Fla. Bar 1-12.1.; see also The Fla. Bar v. Committee, 916 So. 2d 741 (Fla. 2005) (confirming the judiciary's supervisory authority over Bar disciplinary records and processes under Rule 3-7.1).
5. This Court also has jurisdiction over declaratory relief pursuant to Chapter 86, Florida Statutes, which empowers circuit courts to declare rights, status, and other equitable or legal relations, including in cases involving constitutional rights and administrative actions. See §86.011, Fla. Stat.
6. Additionally, this Court possesses inherent equitable jurisdiction to grant relief in equity, including injunctions and other remedies to prevent irreparable harm from ongoing

violations of constitutional and regulatory duties. See Art. V, § 5(b), Fla. Const. (granting circuit courts broad equity powers).

7. Venue is proper in Leon County as the principal place of business for The Florida Bar and the location where the cause of action accrued. See §47.011, Fla. Stat.; The Fla. Bar v. Ray, 797 So. 2d 556 (Fla. 2001) (actions against the Bar typically venued in Leon County).

II. Introduction and Parties

8. This is an action to enforce the fundamental constitutional right of access to judicial branch records under Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution, which declares that "[e]very person shall have the right to inspect or copy any public record made or received in connection with the official business of any public body, officer, or employee of the state, or persons acting on their behalf," expressly including "the legislative, executive, and judicial branches of government." Fla. Const. art. I, § 24(a).
9. This petition invokes the presumption of openness that permeates Florida's constitution and broad jurisprudence on state action, where "public trials and deliberations about court records are presumed open" and any exemptions must be narrowly tailored with the burden on the custodian to justify confidentiality. Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113, 116 (Fla. 1988).
10. Petitioner Christopher Hanson is a resident of Hillsborough County, Florida, and a member of The Florida Bar.
11. He is the complainant in the underlying Bar matter and has standing as the requester of public records under Article I, Section 24, Florida Constitution, and Rule 2.420, as the complainant in the bar complaint against Davis, and as the Respondent in Ayers' complaint

against him, with certain rights including “engagement” with the Bar in the investigation process.

12. As next friend for his minor children, he asserts their interests in records impacting their welfare in the family law case.
13. Respondent The Florida Bar is the custodian of the records at issue, operating as an arm of the judicial branch under Article V, Section 15, Florida Constitution.
14. Respondents Richard Courtemanche, Allie Huston, and Alicia Gangi are Bar officers or representatives involved in the handling, investigation, and/or denial of access to the requested records and information.
15. Petitioner seeks a writ of mandamus compelling the production of records unlawfully withheld by The Florida Bar and its officers, answers to basic questions that went unanswered due to the bar’s failing to “engage” with petitioner (in violation of their own rules), and corrective actions for failures in accountability and damage to public confidence in the judiciary these facts have produced to date.
16. These requests, identified in detail below and in relevant correspondence, relate to attorney misconduct and the Bar’s handling of a complaint against Scott Paul Davis (Florida Bar No. 0074284, RFA No. 25-6861). Appendix Items 1 and 2, p. 1-36).

III. Factual Background

A. Davis’s Misconduct and Concealment of Financial Evidence

17. The facts surrounding the bar complaint against Davis demonstrate Judicial bias and systemic corruption dominating the underlying family law case (24-DR-001150) and the

JQC's handling of Petitioner's complaint on Judge Ayers. (Appendix Items 5, 15, and 16, pp. 40-64, 185-201, 202-205).

18. The ministerial duties the Florida Bar shirked, necessitating this petition/complaint, relate to Davis's and Ayers' misconduct in concealing/suppressing clearly discoverable financial evidence at the core of the parties' dispute as Petitioner explained in his initial filing back in May of 2024.

19. The concealment and suppression of discoverable financial records violated Fla. R. Civ. P. 1.280(b) and ethical obligations under Rule 4-3.4(c) to obey discovery rules. See Appendix Item 17, pp. 244–275 (Writ for Certiorari detailing Judge Ayers' suppression of financial evidence central to equitable distribution); Appendix Item 18, pp. 276–281 (See also Item 19, pp. 282-285, Initial pleading emphasizing urgency of financial discovery).

B. Instead of Addressing Davis's Ethical Violations, Ayers Actively Assists with Suppression.

20. Judge Ayers "fixed" the underlying family law case (24-DR-001150) by repeatedly excusing Davis's misconduct while suppressing efforts to obtain financial discovery, the only reason for any litigation between the parties.

21. These actions contravened Canon 3B(7) of the Florida Code of Judicial Conduct, requiring judges to accord full right to be heard and dispose promptly of proceedings. See Appendix Item 16, pp. 202–243 (Initial brief challenging venue denial and systemic bias).

22. This suppression enabled Davis's tactics of child weaponization—using the children as leverage through unfounded allegations and prolonged litigation—causing ongoing emotional harm to the minor children and delaying resolution for over a year. See Canon 3B(7), Fla. Code Jud. Conduct and Appendix Item 17, pp. 244–275.

23. The initial misconduct involving Davis and then Ayers' refusal to address it triggered a massive cover-up that now encompasses the 13th Judicial Circuit (through withheld records and venue trapping), the Florida Bar (via non-investigation of Davis and advancement of Ayers' retaliatory complaint), and the JQC (via summary dismissal of Petitioner's complaint against Ayers without inquiry).
24. This systemic protectionism prioritizes insiders over public accountability, perpetuating the harm to Petitioner's family and eroding judicial integrity. Williams-Yulee v. Fla. Bar, 575 U.S. 433, 445 (2015) (emphasizing impartiality in disciplinary processes to avoid due process violations); See Appendix Items 16–19, pp. 202–285 (collective evidence of systemic failures, retaliatory complaints, and concealment of core records). Appendix Item 15, pp. 185-201 (JQC complaint against Ayers illustrating interconnected conflicts and lack of transparency); Appendix Item 10, pp. 97-119 (Ayers' retaliatory Bar complaint as evidence of abuse of process).

C. The Florida Bar Violates its Own Rules in Protecting Davis (and Ayers) from Accountability for their Misconduct:

25. The Florida Bar's intentional lack of transparency and refusal to engage, even in direct violation of Rules 3-7.1 and 3-7.3, have directly harmed petitioner and his family with no legitimate state interest served.
26. The only apparent motive for the refusal to engage and continuing concealment of materials exchanged with Davis from the partial production of documents (on November 10, 2025) is to cover for insiders who wish to avoid consequences for their misconduct.

27. The unrefuted and irrefutable nature of Davis's misconduct make it impossible for anyone to actually excuse or justify his (Ayers's and others') actions, so silence and concealment are the only ways to accomplish their unwavering goal to protect insiders.
28. As the Florida Supreme Court has held, the Constitution's access provision "was adopted to ensure public access to all records that by law were made or received by the personnel of these institutions or by persons acting on behalf of these institutions," underscoring that judicial records are not exempt from this mandate absent a justified exemption. Media Gen. Convergence, Inc. v. Chief Judge of the Thirteenth Jud. Cir., 840 So. 2d 1008, 1013 (Fla. 2003).
29. Here, as in any case where evidence points to broad systemic corruption and insider protectionism at the expense of litigants and the public in general, the presumption in favor of transparency is critically important given the Bar's role in regulating the legal profession and citizens' access to justice. Id.
30. In a "lawyers policing lawyers" system like The Florida Bar's self-regulatory framework, transparency is a constitutional mandate, a safeguard against inherent conflicts and potential corruption.
31. The public interest demands heightened access to records where, as here, there are allegations of broad systemic corruption and insider protectionism, enabling unchecked judicial and attorney misconduct. See The Fla. Bar v. Davis, 661 So. 2d 1193, 1197 (Fla. 1995) (noting that public confidence in judicial integrity erodes when corruption is perceived, emphasizing the need for transparency to maintain trust).

32. On February 18, 2025, Petitioner filed a detailed complaint with The Florida Bar against Attorney Scott Paul Davis (Florida Bar No. 0074284) for still unrefuted ethical violations in family law case 24-DR-001150, including delays, harassment, concealment, and child weaponization tactics. (Appendix Item 5, pp. 40-64.)
33. Despite repeated good-faith efforts to engage—documented in a 25-page email chain spanning February to November 2025—the Bar provided form acknowledgments to a fraction of his efforts and no meaningful investigation, interview, nor interest in the additional evidence and clarification offered. (Appendix Item 2, pp. 12-36.)
34. The complaint was improperly dismissed without probable cause, exonerating Davis despite substantiated allegations. (Appendix Item 6, p. 65.) To date, Davis has never disputed any of the specific facts alleged in the complaint despite many opportunities in pleadings, correspondence, and in open Court.
35. Petitioner sought closed file reviews and appeals, but the Bar's opacity and refusals to engage persisted. (Appendix Items 3-4, pp. 37-39.)

D. The Florida Bar Continues to Protect Insiders from Accountability as it Refuses to Comply with Constitutionally Mandated Transparency:

36. On November 10, 2025, in response to public records request W015656-111025, the Bar provided incomplete records, omitting substantive communications with Davis except a typographical error email. (Appendix Item 2, pp. 12-36.)
37. Petitioner's December 1, 2025, follow-up narrowed the inquiry to four specific questions about Davis communications, privilege claims, and a confidentiality index, but received no response. (Appendix Item 1, pp. 1-11.)

38. Petitioner's detailed follow up from December 15, 2025 received only further disinterest, stating, "This matter is closed."

39. This non-responsiveness mirrors the Bar's pattern since February 2025, including failures under Rule 3-7.3(c) (preliminary investigation) and Rule 3-7.1(b) (public records - concealment of rebuttal materials and correspondence with Davis).

40. The Bar's handling contrasts sharply with its advancement of a vague, retaliatory complaint against Petitioner by Judge Kelly Ayers (File No. 2026-10,395(13F)), requiring Petitioner's formal response while potentially excusing Davis entirely. (Appendix Items 9-12, pp. 96-127.)

41. The withheld records are essential to ensuring accountability for misconduct, restoring fairness in the family law case, and rehabilitating confidence in the judiciary.

E. The Florida Bar fails to meet its Burden in Justifying the Refusals to Engage and Comply with Constitutional Transparency

42. The Bar has never offered any explanation nor any rebuttal materials for its decision to dismiss the bar complaint beyond the absurd idea that it was deferring the disciplinary issues to co-conspirator (also guilty of severe misconduct), Ayers.

43. No exemptions apply in that the Florida Bar has still not even disclosed whether rebuttal materials exist nor what correspondence with Davis was ever sent or received.

44. Per The Florida Bar, "the matter is closed" making the records public under Rule 3-7.1(b), which expressly defines "public record" to include "any reports, correspondence, papers, and other materials furnished to, served on, or received from the respondent." See R.

Regulating Fla. Bar 3-7.1(b) (emphasizing that closed cases without probable cause become public records); see also The Fla. Bar v. Committe, 916 So. 2d 741, 745 (Fla. 2005) (interpreting Rule 3-7.1 to require public access absent valid confidentiality exemptions).

45. Specifically, the Florida Bar continues to conceal records, correspondence, and other materials sent to or received from Attorney Davis fall squarely within this definition, while refusing to answer basic questions. (Appendix Items 1, 16, pp. 1-11, 202-205).

46. The Bar refuses even to confirm whether a response or rebuttal materials were ever submitted by Davis, a position that defies the plain language of Rule 3-7.1 and undermines the constitutional presumption of openness articulated in Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113, 116 (Fla. 1988).

47. The burden is on the custodian to justify its refusal to engage with Petitioner on the Bar Complaint and any claimed exemptions from .

48. These refusals to engage, answer the simple questions and/or provide a privilege log are directly contrary to Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution.

49. Such secrecy erodes public confidence and makes judicial intervention imperative.

IV. Conflicts of Interest and Systemic Corruption

50. The Bar's conduct underscores systemic conflicts of interest.

51. Its refusal to investigate substantiated and unrefuted allegations against Attorney Scott Paul Davis parallels the retaliatory complaint advanced by Judge Kelly Ayers against Petitioner—a complaint filed as File No. 2026-10,395(13F) and advanced by the Bar despite its vague

and unsupported (even unnamed) allegations. (Appendix Items 9-10, pp. 96-119; see also Appendix Item 11, pp. 120-122 (Petitioner's response to retaliatory complaint).)

52. At the same time, the Bar dismissed the Davis complaint without requiring Mr. Davis to offer any alternative explanation for the severe and intentional pattern of ethical violations outlined in Petitioner's Bar complaint. (Appendix Item 6, p. 65)

53. This selective enforcement and use of the Bar to protect insiders and attack those who demand accountability violates due process and expands corruption in the judicial system. See Williams-Yulee v. Fla. Bar, 575 U.S. 433, 445 (2015) (discussing the importance of impartiality in Bar disciplinary processes to avoid due process concerns); see also The Fla. Bar v. Ray, 797 So. 2d 556, 559 (Fla. 2001) (emphasizing fair application of disciplinary rules to maintain public trust).

54. This disparity and the continuing refusals to comply with constitutionally mandated transparency confirms the institutional bias favoring judicial insiders over complainants, warranting mandamus to address the absurdity and restore equity. (See Appendix Item 15, pp. 185-201 (related JQC complaint against Judge Ayers illustrating interconnected conflicts)).

55. The underlying family law misconduct ongoing for more than a year exemplifies the harm to litigants that including judicial bias in case 24-DR-001150, further compounds these issues. (Appendix Items 17, 18, pp. 206-275).

56. Petitioner's motion to disqualify Judge Ayers details patterns of favoritism and non-transparency that the Bar and JQC ignored. (Appendix Item 7, pp. 66-78.)

57. The Bar's non-engagement perpetuates this cycle, as evidenced in ongoing appellate motions challenging systemic failures. (Appendix Item 13, pp. 129-141.)

58. Such conduct not only harms Petitioner's family but undermines the Bar's regulatory integrity.

V. Legal Arguments for Mandamus and Relief

A. Mandamus to Compel Record Production and Reopen the Bar Complaint for Proper Handling Consistent with the Facts and Law described Herein:

59. A petitioner seeking a writ of mandamus must establish three key elements: (1) a clear legal right to the requested relief; (2) that the respondent has an indubitable legal duty to perform the requested action, which must be ministerial rather than discretionary; and (3) the absence of any other adequate legal remedy.

i. Clear legal right:

60. Petitioner has a clear legal right to the requested relief, including full access to public records related to Bar Complaint No. W015656-111025 and the reopening of the investigation into attorney Scott Paul Davis's misconduct, as guaranteed by Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution, which mandates public access to judicial branch records, and by Rule 3-7.1 of the Rules Regulating The Florida Bar, which defines such correspondence and reports as part of the public record absent justified exemptions—which none exist here. See *The Fla. Bar v. Committe*, 916 So. 2d 741, 745 (Fla. 2005) (mandamus appropriate to enforce access to Bar records under Rule 3-7.1 where confidentiality not established).

61. The Bar's Failure to Engage and Provide Transparency Under Rule 3-7.1: Rule 3-7.1(b) defines "public record" broadly to include "any reports, correspondence, papers ... furnished to, served on, or received from the respondent."
62. Petitioner has repeatedly requested confirmation of communications with Mr. Davis beyond a minor typo email, yet the Bar refuses to disclose or even index such materials, claiming privilege in direct conflict with Rule 3-7.1(b). (Appendix Items 1-2, pp. 1-36.)
63. This opacity violates the Bar's mandate for constitutional transparency, as Florida's constitution and due process require access to records impacting private rights.
64. The Bar's position—that only a judicial finding of misconduct triggers action—creates an absurd barrier when the judge (Ayers) is implicated, enabling systemic evasion to the great detriment of citizens and their confidence in the judicial system.

ii. Indubitable Legal Duty (Ministerial, Not Discretionary)

65. Respondents, including The Florida Bar and its officers Richard Courtemanche, Allie Huston, and Alicia Gangi, have an indubitable legal duty to perform the requested actions, which are ministerial in nature—such as providing access to non-confidential records under Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420 and conducting a proper preliminary investigation under Rule 3-7.3(c)—as these duties involve no discretion but rather mandatory compliance with established rules to ensure transparency and accountability in attorney discipline (see Appendix Item 17, pp. 244-275, detailing unaddressed violations).
66. To rehabilitate confidence in these institutions, the Bar must immediately produce: · All communications with Mr. Davis or his representatives; (Appendix Item 1, pp. 1-11

(unanswered questions on these communications)) or a sworn affidavit confirming none exist;

- A detailed privilege/confidentiality index for any withheld items;
- Confirmation of searches, including personal devices of all Bar employees and representatives who worked on the case; and
- A written explanation of the search process and devices searched to ensure compliance and transparency.
- Sworn statements from defendants described further below.

67. Accordingly, mandamus and/or declaratory relief is necessary to require the Bar to reopen the complaint against Mr. Scott Davis and perform a proper investigation with the engagement required by the rules. See Tyson v. Fla. Bar, 826 So. 2d 265, 267 (Fla. 2002) (entertaining mandamus petition to compel Bar to reopen disciplinary investigation where initial closure was inadequate); see also Fla. Bar v. Thompson, 979 So. 2d 917, 919 (Fla. 2008) (affirming court's authority to review Bar actions via mandamus for failure to fulfill duties).

68. As part of the order, necessary to ensure accountability and protect the public, Petitioner requests the Court appoint an independent counsel and/or tribunal to oversee the investigation into the Davis complaint.

69. The Court's authority to compel reopening of a disciplinary matter arises from its inherent supervisory power over The Florida Bar under Article V, Section 15 of the Florida Constitution.

70. Independent oversight is imperative given the levels of insider protectionism and systemic corruption at the expense of litigants.

iii. No Other Adequate Remedy at Law

71. Petitioner has no other adequate remedy at law, as informal requests for records and engagement have been ignored or denied despite months of documented efforts (as evidenced by the email correspondence in Appendix Items 1-2, pp. 1-36), and administrative appeals within The Florida Bar are unavailable or ineffective given the systemic issues alleged, leaving mandamus as the only means to compel compliance and prevent irreparable harm to public confidence in the judicial system.

72. Without this writ, the Bar's ongoing failures will continue to perpetuate unchecked attorney misconduct, further eroding trust in Florida's legal institutions and causing direct, ongoing harm to Petitioner, his minor children, and other litigants similarly situated, with no alternative forum or process capable of providing timely and complete relief.

B. Declaratory Relief:

73. Petitioner seeks a declaration that Respondents' withholding violates Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution, Rule 3-7.1, and Rule 2.420, as the records are public and no valid exemption justifies secrecy.

74. This pattern—advancing a retaliatory complaint from Judge Ayers while dismissing substantiated allegations against Davis—demonstrates selective enforcement and institutional self-preservation.

75. This further justifies declaratory relief including payment of petitioner's attorney's fees and costs to enforce constitutional transparency and deter future misconduct.
76. Florida courts have emphasized that transparency is essential to maintain trust in judicial and quasi-judicial bodies. See *Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc.*, 531 So. 2d 113, 116 (Fla. 1988) (presumption of openness places burden on custodian to justify confidentiality); *Florida Bar v. Ray*, 797 So. 2d 556 (Fla. 2001) (truth as defense to criticism; supports exposure of misconduct).
77. Given the Bar's refusal to engage with the complainant and its failure to justify dismissal, declaratory relief is necessary to enforce constitutional mandates and deter future misconduct.
78. Petitioner further seeks a declaration that Respondents' advancement of a retaliatory complaint against Petitioner while simultaneously ignoring substantiated allegations against Attorney Scott Paul Davis constitutes an abuse of process and violates Petitioner's due process rights under the Florida and United States Constitutions.
79. Such selective enforcement and systemic bias undermine public confidence in the integrity of the disciplinary system and warrant judicial intervention to prevent further harm and restore fairness. See *Williams-Yulee v. Fla. Bar*, 575 U.S. 433, 446 (2015) (highlighting due process implications in uneven Bar enforcement).

C. Public Interest, Hardship, and Irreparable Harm

80. The obstacles the 13th Circuit and the Florida Bar have created to avoid transparency and having to explain their excusal of such obvious and intentional misconduct would be determinative for most litigants; they would simply never have access to justice. (See

Appendix Item 14, pp. 142-184, referencing the article "Foxes Guarding the Courthouse"
Link: <https://x.com/Truthoverchaos/status/1992245722901577796?s=20>.)

81. Even more concerning, the obstacles to engagement and transparency would forever bury the misconduct David and Ayers committed in these facts for over a year.
82. Petitioner is in a unique position in that his many years of litigation experience allowed him to notice and document these almost unbelievably obvious and severe violations of the ethical rules for over a year; as pointed out in the article, "Foxes Guarding the Courthouse," this is the perfect storm to bring accountability to those guilty of ethical violations including those at the Florida Bar who violated their own rules, in part of the attempted cover-up. (See Appendix Item 14, pp. 142-184).
83. These obstacles to transparency and refusals to engage cause significant delays and damages during times that are inherently difficult and stressful; perpetuating systemic issues like insider protectionism and avoiding transparency mandates places future litigants, who rely on the Bar to uphold ethical standards under Article V, Section 15 of the Florida Constitution, at increased risk of harm. (See Appendix Items 5, 15, and 16, pp. 40-64, 185-201, 202-205, evidencing unaddressed misconduct in the underlying family law case (24-DR-001150) and related complaints.)
84. The facts of this case are likely not unique, raising concern over how many families Ayers' and Davis's misconduct unfairly impacted in the time prior to and after the events described herein, creating increased urgency for action from this Court. (See Appendix Item 17, pp. 244-275, detailing suppression of evidence central to family welfare.)

85. This hardship is compounded by the Bar's refusal to engage, forcing Petitioner into this petition as a last resort, with no adequate compensation for the time, stress, and family suffering caused by a dispute that should have been resolved over a year ago but for the misconduct and cover-ups described herein.

D. Bad Faith and Willful Non-Compliance:

86. Respondents' actions evidence bad faith, including willful delays, strategic concealment of information/documents, and selective enforcement.

87. The Bar ignored repeated requests for engagement under the rules since February 2025, provided incomplete records, and failed to justify exemptions, suggesting an intent to shield insiders amid corruption allegations.

88. Bad faith warrants mandatory fees under § 119.12(1), Fla. Stat., where unlawful refusal occurs (even analogously for judicial records should the Court refuse expansive consideration of 119.12(1)), as courts award fees to deter such conduct and promote compliance. *New Times, Inc. v. Monroe County Sheriff's Office*, 245 So. 3d 740 (Fla. 3d DCA 2018). See also *Bd. of Trs., Jacksonville Police & Fire Pension Fund v. Lee*, 189 So. 3d 120, 125 (Fla. 2016) (holding that agencies must pay fees for unlawful withholding of public records, even absent bad faith, to encourage compliance).

E. Attorney's Fees and Costs:

89. Petitioner is entitled to attorney's fees and costs under multiple grounds, including Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420(l) for mandamus relief from denials of access to judicial records; Chapter 86, Florida Statutes, and §86.111 for declaratory relief based on bad faith and unreasonable obstruction; and common law and equity principles for

Respondents' pattern of delays, non-responses, failure/refusal to engage, obstruction, bias, and concealment, warranting enhanced awards as exemplified in *Town of Manalapan v. Rechler*, 674 So. 2d 789 (Fla. 4th DCA 1996) (unreasonable delay or non-response constitutes bad faith) and *Wood v. Marston*, 442 So. 2d 934 (Fla. 1983) (fee awards for bad faith conduct).

90. Alternatively, fees are available under §119.12, Florida Statutes, if Chapter 119 applies, particularly given the systemic corruption in the 13th Circuit necessitating a reassessment or distinction of *Times Publishing Co. v. Ake*, 660 So. 2d 691 (Fla. 1995), where the requested records are administrative in nature and essential to combating corruption; under equitable principles and public interest exceptions to deter future misconduct and prevent burdens on citizens enforcing constitutional guarantees, as affirmed in *Woodard v. State*, 885 So. 2d 444 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004) (fee entitlement in mandamus actions implicating public interest transparency); and independently under the Federal and Florida Constitutions for violations of Article I, Section 24 and due process rights.

91. Respondents' unlawful withholding of records and aggressive refusal to engage as required by the rules, all in bad faith, evidenced by ongoing delays since February 2025, selective omissions, and complete non-responses to recent inquiries on information that must be in the public record, further supports this entitlement.

92. Courts have recognized that mandamus actions involving transparency justify fee awards to deter future misconduct and ensure citizens are not burdened for enforcing constitutional guarantees. *Woodard v. State*, 885 So. 2d 444 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004) (affirming fee entitlement in mandamus actions implicating public interest transparency).

See also Bd. of Trs. v. Lee, 189 So. 3d at 125 (mandatory fees for unlawful records withholding to promote access). VI. V. Clear Legal Duty and No Adequate Remedy

VI. Conclusion:

93. The Bar has a ministerial duty to engage with the complainant, conduct at least a preliminary investigation, and disclose public records.

94. It's failed in all of those duties as described herein and demonstrated in the appendix materials.

95. Mandamus is appropriate where, as here, administrative remedies are exhausted and no alternative exists. See Fla. Bar v. Thompson, 979 So. 2d 917 (Fla. 2008). ; see also Tyson v. Fla. Bar, 813 So. 2d at 1022 (mandamus lies to compel Bar's performance of clear duties in disciplinary matters).

96. As Petitioner has made clear throughout this process, time is of the essence and timely orders on these issues are appropriate given the Bar's failure to respond or otherwise engage for several months.

VII. Prayer for Relief

WHEREFORE, in addition to the relief already requested, Petitioner respectfully prays this Court:

1. Declare Respondents' actions relating to the deficiencies described above violative of Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution; Rule 3-7.1; and Rule 2.420

2. Issue a writ of mandamus compelling:

- Immediate production of all requested records including but not limited to all materials sent to and/or received from Mr. Davis and/or anyone on his behalf. Specifically, this includes all communications involving Mr. Davis to or from Alicia Gangi, Allie Huston, and all other bar employees and representatives or a sworn statement confirming none exist;

- A detailed privilege log;

- Searches of personal devices of all Bar employees and representatives involved in the matter;

- A written explanation of the search process and devices searched;

3. Reopen the Davis complaint and conduct a proper investigation required by the Rules.

4. Require Mandatory engagement with Petitioner regarding the Bar's handling of the Davis complaint under Rule 3-7.3(c).

5. Appoint independent counsel or tribunal to oversee the Davis investigation and the initial mishandling of it to ensure impartiality, accountability, and public confidence.

6. Require Ms. Gangi and Ms. Huston to complete sworn statements explaining the failure/refusal to "engage" with Petitioner regarding the Davis bar complaint and describing any conversations with Mr. Davis and anyone else with whom the complaint and related matters were discussed. Order Ms. Gangi and Ms. Huston to appear for depositions should questions remain after review of the sworn statements.

7. Require Mr. Courtemanche to Huston to complete a sworn statements explaining the refusal to comply with bar rules and transparency requirements with an order to appear for deposition should questions remain after review of the sworn statements.

8. Order Judge Ayers to provide a sworn statement advising of any and all statements from Petitioner she believes to be untrue and dismiss the retaliatory Bar complaint against Petitioner (File No. 2026-10,395(13F)) as an abuse of process and violation of due process rights.
9. Refer the Judicial Qualifications Commission's dismissal of Petitioner's complaint against Judge Ayers to the Florida Supreme Court for review and reassessment, given the systemic conflicts and lack of transparency documented herein. (Appendix Item 15, pp. 185-201.)
10. Appoint another independent counsel or tribunal to oversee the investigation and handling of bar complaints (not yet filed due to concerns of bias, insider protectionism and systemic corruption in the FL Bar, but) necessary for other individuals involved in the facts discussed herein. The Bar finding the obvious misconduct in those related cases still to come would further highlight the Bar's failures in the Davis case, so an independent counsel is necessary for objectivity.
11. Find Section 119 applicable to these proceedings involving significant systemic corruption and a quasi-judicial body acting more as a state agency, making Chapter 119's requirements critical for public protection.
12. Award reasonable attorney fees and costs under Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420(l) for mandamus relief; Ch. 86, Fla. Stat., and §86.111 for declaratory relief based on bad faith and obstruction; common law/equity for Respondents' delays, non-responses, failure to engage, obstruction, bias, and concealment, warranting enhanced awards per Town of Manalapan v. Rechler, 674 So. 2d 789 (Fla. 4th DCA 1996) and Wood v. Marston, 442 So. 2d 934 (Fla. 1983). Additionally and alternatively under §119.12, Fla. Stat., if Ch. 119 applies, given the agency like functions of the Florida Bar and systemic corruption requiring reassessment of Times Publishing Co. v. Ake, 660

So. 2d 691 (Fla. 1995); under equitable/public interest principles to deter misconduct per Woodard v. State, 885 So. 2d 444 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004); and under the Florida Constitutions for violations of Art. I, § 24 and due process rights.

13. Pursuant to Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420(l), grant expedited review of Respondents' denial of engagement and access to Bar records, within 30 days of this filing, to prevent further irreparable harm from ongoing opacity, delays in family law proceedings, and erosion of public confidence in the judicial system, as detailed in Sections III (Factual Background) and V. C (Public Interest, Hardship, and Irreparable Harm)

14. Grant such other relief as the Court deems just and proper to ensure transparency, deter future misconduct, and restore public confidence.

15. Petitioner specifically requests a jury trial for any and all issues so triable.

Verification:

I, Christopher Hanson, on December 17, 2025, swear under penalty of perjury that the foregoing is true and correct based on my personal knowledge.

/s/ Christopher Alan Hanson
Christopher Alan Hanson

Certificate of Service

I HEREBY CERTIFY that a true and correct copy of the foregoing Verified Petition for Writ of Mandamus, Declaratory Relief, and Attorney's Fees has been furnished by email to:

The Florida Bar
Attn: Richard Courtemanche, Allie Huston, Alicia Gangi,
651 East Jefferson Street

Tallahassee, Florida 32399-2300

rcourtemanche@floridabar.org; acapintake@floridabar.org; agangi@gunster.com

on this 17th day of December, 2025.

/s/ Christopher Alan Hanson

Christopher Alan Hanson

FL Bar No. 44094

Cahanson77@yahoo.com

727-409-5738

3934 E Eden Roc Cir

Tampa FL 33634

**IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
IN AND FOR HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA
FAMILY LAW DIVISION**

Case No.: 24-DR-001150

Division: D

CHRISTOPHER HANSON,

Petitioner,

v.

SARAH HANSON,

Respondent.

HUSBAND’S VERIFIED EMERGENCY MOTIONS FOR PUBLIC ACCESS, VIDEO AND AUDIO RECORDING, and ZOOM BROADCAST OF OCTOBER 17, 2025 HEARING and ALL FUTURE HEARINGS and VERIFIED EMERGENCY MOTION FOR SANCTIONS INCLUDING STRIKING ALL OF WIFE’S OBJECTIONS TO FINANCIAL DISCOVERY, AWARDING HUSBAND FEES AND COSTS, AND REFERRAL OF MISCONDUCT TO THE APPROPRIATE AGENCIES FOR FURTHER INVESTIGATION

COMES NOW, the Husband, CHRISTOPHER HANSON, and respectfully moves this Court to ensure public transparency, procedural integrity, and due process for Husband and the children, by granting the relief requested herein without the need for a hearing:

1. Husband requests the October 17, 2025 hearing scheduled for 12:00 be recorded to ensure adequate public and press access and to protect integrity of the judicial process given the massive corruption revealed in the 13TH Circuit in this case to date.
2. The past year and a half prove that the 13th Circuit's family law division operates as a clubhouse where club member interests and relationships control over the facts, the law, and a litigant's right to a fair proceeding. (Docket #112, 183, 192, 197, 198, 209, 209, 211).
3. The seemingly insurmountable problem Husband now faces is that at least four “club members”—Davis, Ayers, Hodz, and HHD representatives—have acted in a manner so reprehensible that it requires significant and uncomfortable realizations and consequences. (See Husband/Appellant’s Initial and Reply briefs recently filed in this case, docket numbers to be provided)

4. Realizations and consequences that are so serious, involving people with so much influence that the Florida Bar violates all of its own rules in sweeping Mr. Davis's conduct under the rug, at least in response to the first bar complaint. (See attached correspondence with the Florida bar outlining all of the failures and intentional blindness to such obvious and harmful misconduct).
5. What is truly terrifying about the present situation is that both the Chief Judge, the Florida Bar and the Second DCA have failed to address the misconduct nor offer any assistance in correcting these clear injustices and corruption despite being on notice of the problems. (See p. 5-25 for email chain outlining the bar's violation of its own rules in handling the Davis complaint, lack of any good faith effort to comply with its critical oversight role, and intentional ignorance and disinterest in Davis's misconduct).
6. The reason the Florida bar mishandled this investigation and refused to hold Davis accountable must be investigated as it's indicative of corruption reaching the highest levels of oversight designed to protect the public from such misconduct.
7. These facts demonstrate that the Florida bar is not protecting citizens from even extremely egregious and dishonest misconduct that harms children.
8. Public access and opinion seem to be the only safeguards that have a chance of bringing consequences to these corrupt actors given the course of events the past year and a half.
9. This Court still has a responsibility to protect Husband's and the children's due process rights. See J.B. v. Florida Department of Children & Family Services, 768 So.2d 1060 (Fla. 2000); Deshaney v. Winnebago County Dept. of Social Services, 489 U.S. 189 (1989).
10. In order to do that, this Court must address the facts and the corrupt results Ayers forced over the facts and the law, which will obviously bring some tension between club members, something Judge Felix seems completely unwilling to encounter.
11. It's imperative that the Court record the October 17, 2025 hearing and all future hearings in this matter—both video and audio—and all such recordings made accessible to the public and press via live Zoom broadcast, consistent with the Florida Constitution's guarantee of open courts and the public's right to observe judicial proceedings.
12. This request is made notwithstanding any stay and is procedurally necessary to protect Husband's rights in light of the Court's insistence on proceeding with a

hearing on Attorney Davis's latest purported "emergency," which remains entirely undefined.

13. The Court is continuing the same harmful, unnecessary path Judge Ayers inflicted on the family based upon the "Club house culture" in the 13th Circuit in which relationships control over the law, facts, and litigant's rights.
14. While Judge Ayers was disqualified as Husband pointed out the absurdity of her conduct and orders, her open bias against Husband shown in Court, lying about her bias, and then offering video evidence, (with another lie – suggesting it would support her lie about not rolling her eyes at Husband), then refusing to provide it, Judge Felix has taken over the case without acknowledging, and possibly without even understanding the extent of corruption and baseless actions Judge Ayers forced on this family.
15. Judge Ayers and the 13TH Circuit have refused to provide the video of the April 4, 2025 hearing despite multiple requests both through this case and through the public records law.
16. The entire case is in a posture that defies the facts, law, and logic, as the 13th Circuit ignores Husband's due process, the misconduct of "club members" and the injustices packed into a year and a half of unchecked ethical violations with pure and readily observable dishonesty, all to the detriment of children.
17. Yet Judge Felix continues to allow Mr. Davis's ethical violations to go unchecked while refusing to address the damage caused by past corruption.
18. It appears that the 13TH Circuit has circled the wagons and intends on protecting all of the corrupt actors in it, over the welfare and due process rights of Husband and the 6 and 7 year old children harmed by the complete violation of public trust.
19. If Judge Felix refuses to acknowledge the massive corruption scandal in front of him, the transparency referenced in the Florida Constitution is imperative to have any chance at restoring fairness and confidence in the local judicial system.
20. Constitutional safeguards are paramount when there is evidence of active, ongoing Court corruption hurting citizens. See Deshaney v. Winnebago County Dept. of Social Services, 489 U.S. 189, 196 (1989); J.B. v. Florida Dep't of Children & Family Servs., 768 So. 2d 1060, 1064 (Fla. 2000)
21. The public has a right to observe these proceedings, and Husband has a right to a transparent record of what occurs in a courtroom that has repeatedly refused to acknowledge or correct its own misconduct.

22. And there is apparently no damage too great to ever violate what appears to be the #1 13th Circuit club house rule - protect fellow club members.
23. The requested relief is narrowly tailored to ensure transparency, accountability, and protection of the litigant's rights and does not interfere with any stay or pending appellate matters.
24. A hearing is unnecessary because the Record is replete with uncontradicted evidence that demonstrates the corruption and injustices throughout the past year and a half, requiring emergency relief.

WHEREFORE, in order to begin to rehabilitate judicial integrity. Husband respectfully requests that this Court:

- A. Record the October 17, 2025 hearing set for 12:00 p.m. with both audio and video and make that available to the parties and if requested the public;
- B. Extend this order to all future hearings in this matter;
- C. Allow public and/or press access to all future hearings,
- D. Provide permission to the parties to provide zoom information on the hearings to non-parties
- E. Strike all of Wife's objections to financial discovery,
- F. Order complete responses to Husband's Requests for production within 10 days,
- G. Award attorney's fees, costs and all other appropriate penalties and discipline under this Court's authority,
- H. The Court cancel the October 17, 2025 hearing, issue the orders referenced herein, requiring compliance, while otherwise maintaining the stay to remain in place while Husband's financial discovery proceeds.
- I. Grant such other relief as is just and proper including but not limited to an order striking all of Wife's financial objections.

Respectfully submitted,

Christopher Hanson
Self-represented Litigant

727-409-5738
cahanson77@yahoo.com

VERIFICATION

I, Christopher Hanson, hereby verify that I have read the foregoing motion and that the facts stated therein are true and correct to the best of my knowledge and belief.

Executed this 12th day of October, 2025.

/s/Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson

Cahanson77@yahoo.com

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I HEREBY CERTIFY that a true and correct copy of the foregoing to all parties on the Court's eservice list via the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal and/or email on October 12, 2025,

/s/Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson

Cahanson77@yahoo.com

Christopher A Hanson

From: cahanson77@yahoo.com
Sent: Friday, October 10, 2025 8:49 AM
To: ACAPIntake; agangi@gunster.com; Christopher Hanson
Subject: FW: For Allie Huston and Alicia Gangi - Public comments on bar process, request for objections on ethical grounds and follow up on Bar's compliance with its own Rules in investigating Attorney Scott Davis (RFA No. 25-6861)

Good morning. In light of your continuing silence on all of this, lack of any further appeal, review or conversation offered, and complete lack of transparency regarding any purported investigation and on how the determination was reached, I have no choice but to make public comments on this. I did not ask for any of this. I'm just trying to get some information that was improperly concealed from me, relevant to a significant fraud perpetrated on me. I never wanted any of this public or to work on it myself at all, let alone for years. You're leaving me no choice.

Ms. Huston and Ms. Gangi - you are the 2 individuals the bar has disclosed as reviewing the case and making a determination (without talking to me or providing any information whatsoever to rebut the violations described and the direct harm they're causing to my family), that does exactly the opposite of the Florida bar's purpose. This creates an enormous public hazard with certain harm, continuing in my own family. I'm confident in saying that each of you is intentionally working to excuse and sweep obvious and harmful misconduct under the rug. I know it's a serious accusation, but it's one that I believe your silence, in light of the bar's own rules, confirms.

I would love to be wrong and be able to drop this. Please explain to me what I'm missing, or be advised that I'll be offering this information to anyone and everyone that might be interested including other authorities, employers, media, etc. That seems to be the only option I have given what's required of me as a Florida attorney.

I'd appreciate an ethics opinion. I understand that I'm still under the Florida bar and truly don't want to do anything to cause more problems. I called the FLorida bar earlier this week trying to get an ethics opinion, and I felt a bit sorry for the guy I talked to. He simply "couldn't help me" with the issues I'm having. If you think anything I'm doing is dishonest or unethical in any way, please let me know. Efficiency in getting results in all this this remains my top concern, now since May of 2024.

Thank you for any cooperation or assistance you may be willing to offer.

On Friday, October 3, 2025 at 04:42:05 PM EDT, cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com> wrote:

Good afternoon. You'll find attached a pleading recently filed in the 13th Circuit Court based on additional ethical violations committed by Mr. Davis this week. Obviously, speaking out against the Florida bar is a new terrifying chapter in all of this. However, after researching my obligations, I'm certain that I'm doing the right thing by insisting on further review of every action and actor that looks the other way in the face of such intentional, unethical, and harmful attorney action. I'm uncertain over precisely how to initiate that so I invite the bar and/or ACAP to offer any solutions, process, or hearing that offers meaningful review. Otherwise, I'll take every action I can with every Court I can until someone chooses citizens over protecting attorneys. Please let me know if you have any ideas or if you believe anything that I've alleged is inaccurate in any way. Thank you for your cooperation.

Chris Hanson

On Monday, September 29, 2025 at 03:22 PM EDT, cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com> wrote:

Good afternoon. I'm writing to formally express concern regarding the handling and purported investigation into my complaint referenced above. I called again last Friday 9-26-25 attempting to speak with someone directly, but my only option was to leave another message. In light of the extensive history of my diligent follow-ups and repeated requests for updates and transparency, and ACAP's complete failure to engage as required by rule, I have a responsibility to investigate further. The bar's actions the last several months reflect a broader pattern of neglect and opacity, very likely intentional, that undermines the integrity of the Bar's oversight process.

The Florida Bar's refusal to engage, explain, or even acknowledge the existence of investigative materials raises serious questions about procedural fairness, transparency, and compliance with its own rules. I suspect you will eventually find that my case is not ambiguous—it is a clear matter of right and wrong, Truth and outright malicious lies for the purpose of harassment, delay, and concealment of evidence. The reckless lawfare from Davis breezed right by the 13th Judicial Circuit, and now the Florida Bar as well.

The complete lack of transparency and any appearance of a good faith investigation is readily apparent and obviously inconsistent with the Bar's own Rules. The fact that the complaint involves systemic corruption within the 13th Circuit, and yet the Bar violates its own transparency rules is quite troubling and I hope that as attorneys each of you can see why that is. This unchecked onslaught of dishonest and bad faith litigation caused demonstrable harm to my children and what should be their innocent years.

Mr. Davis's conduct and the complicity of the Florida Bar and others put my children in a position where their Mom has to create conflict and actively weaponize the children in her attempt to manufacture a basis for her absurd motions, obviously pursued for improper grounds, in direct violation of the Rules. The children have lived under these completely unnecessary circumstances that create an appearance for them that is the precise opposite of true. Obviously, it's caused enormous pain within my family and the bar's blanket dismissal of all of that the past several months is nothing short of cruel.

How can the bar accept this as a consequence of litigation? Please understand that the Florida Bar's complete failure to follow its own rules in this has only recharged my capacity to obtain transparency and a real investigation. In that light, please maintain any and all communications and other materials the Florida Bar may have with any connection to this process.

I saw your blanket, preemptive dismissal of any follow up concerns I may have—as referenced in the attached letter that I received Saturday. To date, I still have not received a copy of the material that was apparently produced to Mr. Davis with an August 6 letter, but not to me, despite multiple requests, some of which you'll find below.

Instead, the bar took time to send me a letter enclosing a new version of an old letter, simply correcting an obvious typo. That appears to be the extent of the work the Bar shared with me, which—if that's the extent of the bar's efforts—it demonstrates such absurdity in its incompetence or worse, one can barely believe it. As a licensed and paying member of the Florida Bar or just as a citizen suffering harm from attorney misconduct, I certainly believe that I deserve better than what the Bar has given my concerns. I'm making another good faith request for transparency and investigation

materials. Failure to respond will demonstrate actual concealment of information related to any investigation at least in my opinion.

Partial Timeline of Requests for Engagement from the Florida Bar

This timeline reflects repeated efforts to engage the Florida Bar under its own procedural rules, including:

- **Rule 3-7.3(c)**: Mandating preliminary investigation unless the complaint is clearly unfounded.
- **Rule 3-7.4(g)**: Governing the respondent's right to submit rebuttal materials and triggering review of all related submissions.

The timeline also reflects my good faith efforts to submit sworn statements and request transparency regarding any investigative materials or procedural steps taken.

- **June 26**: Initial complaint with supporting documentation.
- **July 21, 25, 30**: Follow-up emails requesting acknowledgment and engagement.
- **August 7, 14**: Submission of additional evidence and sworn statements.
- **September 1, 12, 23**: Final pleas for transparency and reconsideration—none of which received substantive response.

This timeline reflects not only persistence, but the Bar's failure to meet its own standards of responsiveness and procedural fairness.

Rights of a Bar Complainant

Under the Florida Bar Rules, I am entitled to:

- **Acknowledgment and engagement** under *Rule 3-7.3(c)*, which mandates preliminary investigation unless the complaint is clearly unfounded.
- **Submission of rebuttal materials** under *Rule 3-7.4(g)*—which entitles the respondent (in this case, Mr. Davis) to submit a response, and which should trigger a review process that includes consideration of all materials submitted by the complainant and respondent.
- **Transparency and explanation** of outcomes, especially when the complaint involves sworn evidence and serious allegations.
- **Protection from prejudicial conduct** under *Rule 4-8.4(d)*, which applies not only to attorneys but to the Bar's own handling of complaints.

The Bar's refusal to share any alternative review of the facts or explain its rationale violates these principles. It undermines public confidence and shields misconduct from scrutiny. Hypothetically, if someone with influence over the Florida bar wanted this "swept under the rug," it appears that the bar's handling of my complaint would be the easiest way to do that. Please provide me with some information or some explanation that might restore some confidence in the Florida bar.

Reasonable Questions and Document Requests

To understand the process and assess whether the Bar complied with its own rules, I respectfully request answers to the following:

1. **Was a preliminary investigation conducted or authorized under Rule 3-7.3(c)?** If so, who conducted it, and what materials were reviewed?
2. **Did Mr. Davis submit any rebuttal materials under Rule 3-7.4(g)?** If so, why have I not received a copy? Will you provide copies of those materials now?
3. **Was there any discussion or coordination with the JQC or anyone within the judiciary or judicial oversight?** Please provide any applicable communications or at least whether you will or will not confirm whether any such contact occurred.
4. **Who were the assigned investigators and reviewers at each stage of the process?** I understand the initial decision maker was Ms. Huston and the final decision maker was Ms. Gangi. I do not understand anything in between. The limited information I've received fails to clarify the process, the investigators involved, or the decision makers at each stage. If this information exists, it should be provided. If it does not, or if the Bar refuses to disclose it, that refusal should be explicitly acknowledged. I will assume the Bar is refusing to provide this information if I don't hear back from you by Wednesday at 5pm.
5. **Investigative materials and anything conflicting with the facts and evidence of violations, intent, and harm I alleged.** I want to reiterate my many prior requests for any and all documentation not protected from disclosure. If you will not provide, please at least confirm whether such materials exist and preserve them in case needed for future proceeding
6. **Was anyone ever contacted regarding this complaint, including Mr. Davis, judicial officers, or third-party witnesses?** If so, please provide a list of individuals or offices contacted, the nature of the outreach, and any responses received. If no such outreach occurred, please confirm that no external contact was made. I know that I was not contacted despite several requests to offer more information supporting my complaint. Is there anything justifying or even just documenting the failure to contact me, the complainant, opposing counsel, and the litigant? Other than the reviewers/investigators and any witnesses, is there any other individual who played any role in the assessment, investigation, and/or determination reached?
7. **What policies or procedures govern the Florida Bar's handling of complaints involving systemic corruption or coordinated misconduct?** Given the gravity of such allegations, what safeguards exist to ensure transparency, independence, and accountability in the review process? If no such procedures exist, please explain why the Bar applies less transparency in cases where heightened scrutiny is warranted.
8. **What standards guided the Florida Bar's decision in this matter?** Based on published rules and oversight principles, the following factors are critical:
 1.
 - **Clarity of the violation:** Is there any evidence that contradicts the clear ethical breaches documented in my complaint? If so, please identify it.
 - **Intent and mental state:** Is there any evidence suggesting Mr. Davis acted without intent or recklessness? If so, please provide it.
 - **Degree of harm caused:** Is there any evidence that disputes my sworn statements regarding the harm to my children and the broader impact on the judicial process? If so, please explain.
 - **Pattern or duration of misconduct:** Is there any evidence that this was an isolated incident rather than part of a broader pattern? If so, please clarify.
 - **Public interest and protection:** Is there any evidence that supports the conclusion that no disciplinary action is needed to protect the public or uphold confidence in the legal system? If so, please provide it and/or an explanation on how the bar reached its conclusion.

These factors are consistent with the Florida Bar's own disciplinary framework and constitutional mandate under **Article V, §15**, as well as its obligations under **Rule 3-**

7.3(c) and Rule 4-8.4(d). I request that any evidence contradicting these considerations be disclosed and explained. If no such evidence exists, the Bar should affirmatively state that fact.

9. .

Absent a response, I will assume the Bar is not only refusing to answer these questions, but also refusing to confirm whether the relevant materials exist.

Constitutional and Oversight Concerns

The seriousness of the Florida Bar's failure is underscored by its constitutional and ethical obligations:

- **Article V, §15 of the Florida Constitution** grants the Supreme Court authority to regulate the admission and discipline of attorneys. This power carries a duty to ensure transparency and protect the public from misconduct.
- **Rule 3-7.3(c)** requires preliminary investigation unless a complaint is clearly unfounded. Silence and refusal to engage are not permissible substitutes for review.
- **Rule 4-8.4(d)** prohibits conduct prejudicial to the administration of justice. Shielding misconduct—especially when it harms children—is a direct violation.

The Florida Bar's failure to act in this matter not only undermines its own rules but erodes public trust in the legal system. Oversight is not discretionary—it is a constitutional mandate. It's important to make it clear that these failures have consequences. I've enclosed a picture so you have an image of some of the people your failures impact. The litigation tactics Davis employs and of which the at least implicitly approves are tearing a family a part - specifically because they are so demonstrably and universally false. The suffering is not hypothetical—it is direct, personal, and ongoing. The harm they've endured as a result of Mr. Davis's ethical violations and the Florida Bar's refusal to intervene exemplifies the broader danger these systemic failures pose to families across Florida. I hope that will help you understand why I'll never stop exposing those who've allowed this to happen to my children and likely, countless others.

There has never been a complaint about me in my career. Likewise, there's never been a complaint about me as a father. Even with all the ugliness Davis has brought, there are no allegations of any impropriety as a father. I will always uphold the law and tell the truth, regardless of the consequences. I'm now concerned about retaliation from the Florida bar and related individuals, as I'm forced to expose systemic failures that are so harmful to Florida families. I feel a strong sense of obligation as a Florida attorney to expose these harmful failures even if that means going against the bar, the 13th Circuit, and Mr. Davis.

The next step will be including this email correspondence and the history described herein as part of the record in a pending appeal before the Second District Court of Appeal as well as sharing it with various lawmakers, the Public, and Supreme Court representatives. I encourage and accept any cooperation you all will offer and willing to go thru all proper channels. I've already pointed out deep systemic corruption within the 13th Circuit and this utter lack of transparency and any semblance of a neutral investigation cause me grave concerns over the competence and/or possible corruption within those acting on behalf of the bar. Truth and Justice are black and white in this case. Any one that fails to see the truth is really trying to avoid it, begging a whole new set of questions.

I again ask that this matter be reviewed with the seriousness it deserves and at the highest levels within the bar and Supreme Court if necessary. I require at least acknowledgment and some good faith action to demonstrate cooperation by Wednesday October 1, 2025 at 5pm EST even if you cannot get all of the answers by then. At least show me that the bar has some interest in a fair process because there is absolutely nothing in the record supporting that, and your silence demonstrates that you know all of this quite well.

Sincerely,

Chris Hanson

On Tuesday, September 23, 2025 at 09:19:41 AM EDT, cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com> wrote:

Good morning. I really don't mean to be difficult about this. I waited to send this. However, I can't help but be frustrated about this response in light of the experience I'm having in the 13th Circuit and the course of events with the Florida bar. I've made credible, unrefuted allegations of obvious ethical violations and described the damaged they're causing to my family. Everything the Florida bar has done (to my knowledge) demonstrates a complete lack of concern and oversight for such outrageous conduct from an attorney. There appears to be deep systemic problems where the people of Florida are simply at the mercy of the lawyers who operate free from ethical restraints, with Judges that collude with them. I never asked for any of this, but I will make it my career to ensure that changes.

Despite several offers and even requests, no one from the Florida bar has ever discussed the case with me or provided any basis for the prior findings that completely dismissed these obvious violations. The bar fails to respond to multiple inquiries on the appeal status. When I finally get a response, it's dismissive and essentially conclusive in that I shouldn't expect anyone to ever contact me about my concerns.

Does someone disbelieve any of my allegations? Any basis for that if so? I

I hope you can understand why I have some concerns about bias and/or other impropriety in the review and investigation process. Is there someone higher up either at the bar, ACAP, or the Supreme Court, with whom I may speak about these concerns? I'm going to get on the phone today or later this week in hopes of reaching someone. Please let me know if you have any information, you can offer or if someone is willing to speak with me about my concerns. Thank you.

Chris

On Friday, September 19, 2025 at 05:26:04 PM EDT, ACAPIntake <acapintake@floridabar.org> wrote:

Good afternoon:

This matter remains under review of the grievance committee chair. You will be informed of the outcome of that review via US mail.

Thank you,

Allie Huston, Esq.

Attorney/Consumer Assistance Program (ACAP)

From: cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com>

Sent: Friday, September 12, 2025 9:25 PM

To: Alicia Gangi <agangi@gunster.com>; ACAPIntake <acapintake@floridabar.org>; ACAP Mail <acap@floridabar.org>; Christopher Hanson <truthoverchaos@outlook.com>

Subject: Re: Follow-Up on Inquiries into Status of Investigation into Attorney Scott Davis (RFA No. 25-6861) and Receipt of Recent Correspondence

Good evening all. I'm not sure how this sent already, but I'm just fixing a couple of issues on it and will hope you find this one first. I am once again following up on my several prior inquiries as to the status of this investigation and requests to speak with someone. I last emailed on September 1, and the automatic reply requested up to seven days for ACAP to review and respond. We'll be over 2 weeks out by Monday.

Please try to understand the urgency of my concerns here. They're well documented in our prior correspondence, and I won't repeat all of them. But the continuing lack of any response or even acknowledgment of my good faith requests for some information here are really difficult to understand. I would hope that as a litigant, a complainant, or even just as an 18 year Florida attorney with an excellent reputation, the Florida bar would be more responsive and decisive in handling unethical attorney behavior.

Is there a rule against speaking with me? Or is there some reason the bar is ignoring this obvious misconduct and my requests for a conversation that I don't know? Something preventing an investigation or discipline in the case? Someone please help me to understand. I find all of this very unnerving both personally and professionally. If ACAP believes Mr. Davis's conduct is acceptable, please have the courtesy to have a discussion with me so I can make every effort before having to continue to escalate this very obvious problem with corruption infecting Tampa Courts.

ACAPs automatic email suggests responses within 7 days are standard. Just from the email chain below, you can see where I have followed up for answers to the same, yet expanding, list of questions, for several months, with no response other than what appear to be attempts to quietly sweep this misconduct under the rug. I hope I'm wrong, but please at least communicate with me. My children are being actively weaponized thru active, ongoing misconduct. I've made you all aware of that as clearly as I can. Please provide some response this coming week

And this isn't a litigation is ugly issue. It's misconduct. Please respond to me this week with some information about the status. Again, I do not consider any of these emails confidential so please let me know immediately if I'm mistaken on

that. I do not wish to have problems with the Florida bar, nor anyone else. I'm just going to continue following the truth and doing the right thing and hope eventually that Fixes some of these things that are clearly broken.

I see there is a Florida Bar Board of Governors meeting coming up in Tampa next week. If possible, I'd like the opportunity to present some information to anyone part of this review process at or around the same time as the meeting. Please let me know the status of the current review/appeal and what the options are moving forward. Thank you for your attention to this matter.

Chris Hanson.

[Sent from Yahoo Mail for iPhone](#)

On Monday, September 1, 2025, 8:05 PM, cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com> wrote:

I hope this email finds you well. I am following up on my previous correspondence dated August 14, 2025, with Ms. Gangi (attached below) and my ongoing communications with the Florida Bar's Attorney/Consumer Assistance Program (ACAP) regarding the investigation into Attorney Scott Davis in connection with my dissolution of marriage case (Lower Tribunal No. 24-DR-001150, 13th Judicial Circuit; Appellate Case No. 2D2025-1936). As a reminder, my initial complaint, outlined concerns about Mr. Davis's conduct during the proceedings, which has become more egregious and harmful in the months since the several months initial complaint. I have not filed additional complaints as it's part of the same course of conduct. However, it's important that the bar deal with this in a timely fashion given the ongoing harm from it and systemic corruption within the 13th Circuit delaying any relief. There are currently 2 issues up on appeal.

I recently received the letter dated August 25, 2025, from Ms. Schuyler, notifying me of a typographical error in the July 16, 2025, closing letter and enclosing a revised version. I appreciate the effort to correct the record for accuracy. However, the mailing I received did not include the enclosure previously sent to other recipients, but not the undersigned, as requested below. Please provide that at your earliest convenience.

More importantly, I'm still confused about why no one has contacted me about this investigation. I can provide you with definitive evidence (used consistently with the Florida Rules) that prove both the violations and the harm they caused. If you're drafting letters to enclose new letters for a simple typo, I'd expect that contacting me about the basis for conclusions and the status of the investigation are very reasonable requests.

I wanted to reiterate my interest in understanding the process and next steps more fully. I'm continuing to appeal the bar's determination. As I understand it, the investigation is with Ms. Gangi, but still is very much active in terms of her review. If I'm mistaken on that, please let me know ASAP. I would like to respectfully request clarification on a few points:

1. **Status and Timeline:** Could you please provide an update on the current stage of the investigation, including any recent developments or an estimated timeline for completion? I understand processes can vary, but this information would help me stay informed.
2. **Burden of proof/standard for proceeding with discipline:** I do not understand the Bar's conclusions to date. There are many intentional violations that the evidence shows beyond any reasonable doubt. And I know just how damaging the violations have been to my family. From my review of the Florida bar's mission statement, the certainty of the violations and the harm they're actively causing support action. What is it that's justifying inaction to the point of no one ever even contacting me?
3. **Scope of Review:** I am interested in learning more about the steps involved, such as whether interviews with potential witnesses (e.g., Ms. Hodz or Ms. Samarkos) have been conducted or if additional documentation from Mr. Davis has been requested. This would assist me in ensuring all relevant information is considered.
4. **Documentation and Criteria:** Please share copies of documents in the file to date, or explain the criteria for continuing or closing a complaint? I am also unclear on whether a "bar counsel" review occurred around April 2025, and any guidance on that would be helpful. Additionally, it would be useful to know how the Bar ensures thorough outreach during investigations, such as contacting complainants or witnesses for input, especially when compared to the prompt correction of administrative errors like the recent typo.
5. **Next Steps for Appeal or Review:** Please advise on where we are in the appellate process and what the next step is to ensure that I give the Bar every option and all information necessary to do the right thing and protect Floridians here.

These concerns stem from the ongoing impact on my family, and I am eager to cooperate fully. If there is any additional information I can provide to assist, please let me know. Thank you for your time and attention to this matter—I value the Florida Bar's role in maintaining professional standards and look forward to your response within the next week.

Sincerely,

Christopher Hanson
Self-Represented Litigant
Email: cahanson77@yahoo.com
Phone: 727-409-5738

On Thursday, August 14, 2025 at 01:02:02 PM EDT, cahanson77@yahoo.com
<cahanson77@yahoo.com> wrote:

Good Afternoon Ms. Gangi. You'll see below, both the reason for the conduct and where I asked the ACAP reps about whether it's acceptable to reach out to you. I did not hear back. I am not copying Mr. Davis on this correspondence although can add him in or I understand if you need to provide him with all of my correspondence. I'm writing to request any information available about the investigation to date and offer my information and assistance in your investigation. It's an unusual situation in that I'm the complainant, opposing party, and opposing attorney, all in one person. No one from the bar has ever contacted me about the investigation.

This is my first involvement in the bar complaint process after 16 plus year in high volume litigation. I know that Mr. Davis broke the rules and intentionally continues to do so. I also see how much damage that is causing to my children and my family. I assumed those were the top criteria in determining whether the bar takes action? I have seen a couple of letters in which the bar decided not to pursue, and then the second was part of the review process which reached the same conclusion. There was nothing ever provided to me that offered any explanation for the well documented facts other than ongoing, intentional ethical violations. If the bar has any documentation on the investigation, could you please provide me what you have or let me know how to proceed in getting it.

I know it's easy to look at this and think it's 2 attorneys bickering and maybe some "sour grapes" from a divorce, and move on. I can assure you with detailed facts to back it up, that is not the case. I find this to be extremely concerning antics from an attorney and I'm hoping that there's something or someone in the bar process that will take action to deter this type of grossly unethical behavior.

I'm happy to provide further back up documentation if requested. Please let me know if you need anything and if there's anything on the bar's investigation you can provide. Thank you for your cooperation.

Chris Hanson

727-409-5738

----- Forwarded Message -----

From: cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com>

To: ACAPIntake <acapintake@floridabar.org>; Christopher Hanson <truthoverchaos@outlook.com>; acap@floridabar.org <acap@floridabar.org>; cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com>

Sent: Thursday, August 7, 2025 at 12:25:41 AM EDT

Subject: Scott Davis bar complaint - RFA No. 25-6861 - Request for Bar Counsel review, Chief Branch Discipline Counsel and/or Grievance Committee chair

Good evening. I did receive the attached correspondence in the mail. I wanted to inquire about a couple of things. The letter references an enclosure, "copy of complainant's letter," although I did not receive it. I am not certain which letter or possibly email that references. Will you please provide me with a copy.

Also, I have not received a copy of anything that Mr. Davis submitted. If he's offered some explanation for the many violations I've described, I certainly need to have that. Despite my best efforts, he has offered no explanation of which I'm aware. And worse, the violations are ongoing and escalating, demonstrating a complete indifference to the ethical rules.

Please let me know if you will provide me with the file documents on the investigation to date. Do you have any materials that explain the bar's criteria on whether to close a complaint or continue the disciplinary process. I still struggle to understand closure without contacting me or providing me any explanation Mr. Davis may have offered to the bar.

Is it acceptable for me to reach out to Ms. Gangi and offer further documentation? Either way, please pass along my eagerness to cooperate with a real investigation into the issues I've laid out the past few months. I look forward to hearing from you on the above. Thank you for your cooperation.

Chris Hanson

On Wednesday, July 30, 2025 at 01:48:03 PM EDT, cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com> wrote:

Good afternoon. Please excuse this interruption, especially if there is investigation going on in the background. It's been over a week, and I've not heard anything about the next review/appeal option.

I'm hoping you can understand my concern here. I've worked very hard to lay out ethical violations in black and white. No one has ever attempted to explain Mr. Davis's conduct in a manner that even suggests an explanation without rule violations. I know I can prove beyond any reasonable doubt that his entire litigation strategy at the core of the case is a severe rule violation in that he seeks only to delay and conceal.

The significant expense and damage from his violations are constantly in front of me and have been for more than a year. There is a very serious problem with corruption in the 13th Circuit. I'm unaware of what, if anything the bar has done to actually investigate this complaint. I do know that no one has talked to the complainant, the opposing party, or the opposing attorney who has extensive documentation about the violations and damage.

It's impossible to take the bar's investigation seriously under these circumstances. I'm going to continue working to expose every part of this, both for myself and due to my responsibilities as a Florida attorney. Even if it seems people don't want to listen, I'm skilled and experienced enough to know exactly how to prove all of this and how damaging it will be for other families if it's allowed to continue.

Please provide a response at your earliest convenience. Thank you for your cooperation.

Chris

On Friday, July 25, 2025 at 12:16:57 PM EDT, cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com> wrote:

Hi Ms. Huston. I received your email from earlier today enclosing the July 16th letter previously mailed to me. Thank you for the additional copy, but I'd already sent the below in relation to my review of the letter received in the mail.

I sent the inquiries below in order to proceed to the next review/appeal option and follow up on continuing concerns that I have.

I'm a bit confused about the review that's been completed to date. I received the initial determination from the bar and the July 16 letter from the director of ACAP. The letter references the decision "by bar counsel." Is that an additional step where some review or investigation took place or just the initial determination that I received back in April I believe?

Please let me know if you need anything from me in order to continue the review/appeal process. I know firsthand the extent and damage of these violations and it's important that I do whatever I can to discourage this as an accepted manner of practice in Florida. Thank you.

Chris

On Tuesday, July 22, 2025 at 06:54:56 AM EDT, cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com> wrote:

Please excuse the additional email. I forgot to add the complaint name and number in the subject. That's the only change from the email last night at 10:56. Please let me know if you need anything more from me. Thank you.

Chris

On Monday, July 21, 2025 at 10:56:41 PM EDT, cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com> wrote:

Good evening. I'm very disappointed to receive the decision from the Director of ACAP. Obviously, I want to appeal further - is there a "bar counsel" review step? I'd like to request that, the chief branch discipline counsel and/or the Grievance Committee chair review options, whatever is next.

I'm also very interested in what investigation was done. Please allow this to serve as a formal request for any and all documentation related to any investigation completed by the bar in relation to this complaint.

No one has ever reached out to me about this. Did anyone reach out to Ms. Hodz or Ms. Samarkos? It's very difficult to take this process seriously when the process takes longer than the high estimate, and no one reached out to the complainant, the opposing litigant, or the opposing attorney.

Again, I do not consider any of this correspondence as confidential. If there is any rule that prevents me from making these documents and this correspondence public, please let me know ASAP.

Please also let me know if you need anything more from me in order to proceed with the appellate options requested herein. Thank you.

Chris Hanson

On Monday, July 21, 2025 at 08:32:46 AM EDT, cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com> wrote:

Good morning Ms. Huston. Please excuse the additional follow up email. As you know, there are a few layers of additional appeal/review in this matter, and I plan to exhaust all of them if necessary. I am trying to stay on top of this to make sure it's properly and timely addressed both for myself and other litigants and attorneys in the future. No consequences will only further embolden attorneys willing to commit such violations as this case proves.

This is a very straightforward case of misconduct. I reviewed the concerning course of actions with Mr. Davis back in November of 2024. He has offered no alternative explanation for his litigation tactics that might create a bit of nuance as to whether there are true Rule violations. Worse, Mr. Davis has continued to commit ethical violations since then including a veiled threat of physical violence against me and continuing to obstruct all discovery efforts (even admittedly non-objectionable ones).

As previously addressed below, The May 6th letter suggests it may take "up to 60 days" for the investigation. I'm confused over how we're at 75 days, and I've heard nothing about the investigation. I am the complainant, opposing litigant, and opposing attorney in this matter yet no one has even contacted me about it. As I've mentioned, I will need to either supplement the prior complaint or file a new one describing all of the subsequent misconduct. Please let me know if you can offer any guidance on how best to proceed with that.

I waived any attorney client privilege with all of the attorneys who represented me. Ms. Hodz and Ms. Samarkos were both part of separate calls with Mr. Davis that completely changed their outlook on my sole objective in the case and their willingness to even pursue it on my behalf. There is no privilege or confidentiality that prevents them from talking about those conversations. I hope that your investigator has pursued that information?

No one has reached out to me about literally anything related to this over year long history of consistent rule violations from Mr. Davis. In about 18 years of practice, this is my one and only bar complaint I've filed, and never had one filed against me. There's no allegation that I've stated anything inaccurate or committed any rule violations myself. It seems to me that this should be about the simplest, fastest investigation in bar history, yet it's already gone over 25 percent beyond the high estimate for the investigatory period. Can you please help me understand that?

You have an attorney, completely unrestrained by the ethical rules actively and knowingly weaponizing my children in an attempt to thwart discovery. I hope there is a real disciplinary process occurring in the background. Please let me know if you can provide me with any information on the status of investigation and/or reach out to the investigator to encourage interviews with myself and the relevant witnesses including Ms. Samarkos and Ms. Hodz. Thank you.

Chris Hanson

----- Forwarded Message -----

From: cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com>

To: ACAPIntake <acapintake@floridabar.org>; Christopher Hanson <truthoverchaos@outlook.com>

Sent: Tuesday, July 8, 2025 at 07:56:02 AM EDT

Subject: Re: Request for Closed File Review - Scott Davis bar complaint - RFA No. 25-6861

Good morning. The May 6 letter I received about the investigation described an investigation that could take up to 60 days. No one has contacted me about any of this. I would hope that would be part of any investigation about such misconduct if the goal is to address it. Please let me know if I can offer any assistance. It will be extremely frustrating if the bar finds another way to ignore this conduct, especially if that determination is made without first interviewing me about these subjects.

There are many clear violations of the ethical rules in these facts for which Mr. Davis has offered no explanation or objection. I can offer concise explanations and supporting documents for all of it that will make it very easy for your investigator. Mr. Davis's entire strategy in the case is in itself a violation of the ethical rules. This is precisely why we need a disciplinary process for attorneys.

I'm confused about why I've not been contacted and we're now over the 60 days. Is there any update or information that you can provide me on the process and when I will hear from an investigator or on the result of the investigation?

Please let me know if I can assist in any way or if you would like me to forward any additional documentation to you or if new violations need to go in a separate bar complaint. Thanks.

Chris

On Monday, June 30, 2025 at 10:18:52 AM EDT, cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com> wrote:

Got it. Thank you for the update. There's additional documentation I can provide from the period covered in the current complaint and some subsequent events that I can certainly share. I do not want to hold up the process with new and additional information although it is available if anyone is interested in more information. I know the 60 days is just about over. I look forward to hearing from you. Sincerely,

Chris

On Monday, June 30, 2025 at 09:02:52 AM EDT, ACAPIntake <acapintake@floridabar.org> wrote:

Good morning:

This matter remains under review to determine if closure was appropriate. You will be notified of the decision in writing.

Thank you,

Allie Huston, Esq.

Attorney/Consumer Assistance Program (ACAP)

From: cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com>
Sent: Thursday, June 26, 2025 8:35 AM
To: ACAPIntake <acapintake@floridabar.org>
Subject: Re: Request for Closed File Review - Scott Davis bar complaint - RFA No. 25-6861

Good morning. I still have not heard anything about the status of the investigation. I plan on pursuing every review and appellate option available as described in the recent correspondence. I have not seen anything in the mail although I think that's the least reliable manner of communication. May I opt to receive notice by email or phone in addition?

I'm also attaching a couple of recent emails from Mr. Davis in which he continues with his delay, harass, burden, and conceal strategy, repeatedly insulting me, as he's done in the past multiple times.

What he's done and soon to be ex-wife have done is criminal. And they're like cornered animals trying to hide it. It's a very scary situation. I plan on making everything public this weekend if I don't have some results either thru the bar or thru the Court case.

The fact that helpless litigants go thru situations like this is shocking and desperately needs attention and serious consequences. Please provide me with an update on the status before the end of the week. Thank you for your attention to this matter.

Chris Hanson

On Friday, June 13, 2025 at 01:37:40 PM EDT, cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com> wrote:

Good afternoon. I have not seen any determination nor request for information. I have extensive evidence in hearing transcripts, various pleadings, and email correspondence documenting an intentional strategy of delay and concealment through various additional violations of the ethical rules. The offense is ongoing and the damage is substantial. I understand the court proceedings are separate from the bar inquiry. However, the ongoing violations are severe and continue to harm 2 minor children. I may be able to provide some documentation that will make it easier to understand the course of events of the past year and how they all fit with this ongoing patter of delay, harass, burden, and conceal.

Please let me know if I can assist in any way. I continue to think that allowing a bar member to continue practicing the way Mr. Davis does when there's conclusive evidence of ongoing and intentional ethical violations presents a hazard to all Florida residents his conduct may impact. Thank you for your consideration.

On Thursday, May 15, 2025 at 12:07:54 PM EDT, cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com> wrote:

Good afternoon. Thank you for confirming with the letter and below. I had not received the letter when I sent the email. I have extensive documentation relating primarily to hearing transcripts and correspondence with Mr. Davis. Please let me know if I can provide that info or assist in any other way. Thanks,

Chris

On Wednesday, May 14, 2025 at 05:16:36 PM EDT, ACAPIntake <acapintake@floridabar.org> wrote:

Good afternoon:

You were sent correspondence via US mail on May 6, 2025 that this matter is now under review to determine if closure was appropriate. You will be notified of the decision in writing. The letter further notes that each of these reviews may take as long as 60 days to complete. This letter was sent to the address you provided on the initial complaint form.

Thank you,

Allie Huston, Esq.

Attorney/Consumer Assistance Program (ACAP)

From: cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com>
Sent: Saturday, May 10, 2025 10:25 AM
To: ACAPIntake <acapintake@floridabar.org>; Christopher Hanson <truthoverchaos@outlook.com>
Subject: Re: Request for Closed File Review - Scott Davis bar complaint - RFA No. 25-6861

Good morning. I hoped that I would hear something back by now. Please let me know if the Florida Bar will be addressing this any further and when I can expect to hear anything. Thank you.

Chris Hanson

On Wednesday, April 30, 2025 at 10:37:03 AM EDT, cahanson77@yahoo.com wrote:

Good morning. I'm forwarding my initial bar complaint previously sent, with the FL bar's 2-24-25 response. You will also find attached that letter Attorney Allie Huston.

I'm extremely confused and disappointed by the letter. The sentence that apparently provides the basis for closure without investigation is, "The matters upon which your allegations are premised present questions of law and involve a dispute over which a court has jurisdiction."

I'm not sure I even understand that. It seems to me that it describes every case in litigation ever. Does that mean that any misconduct in relation to litigation is of no concern to the Florida bar?

Regardless, the attached Florida bar letter from 2-24-25 is not a good faith response to a very serious and detailed bar complaint, at least in my opinion. I'm an 18 year attorney, AV rated, with no disciplinary issue. This is the first bar complaint that I have ever filed. I've talked to the bar about other lawyers' misconduct and always felt as though the bar discouraged complaints. I hoped that if I did ever need to file a complaint, the bar would take it seriously. Unfortunately, it appears to me that the Florida bar is more interested in limiting/closing disputes than addressing them. In the attached complaint, I provided clear, undisputed facts that demonstrate multiple violations of the professional rules at the very core of this case, having a very significant impact on the opposing party/attorney and his children. I had hoped the Florida bar is here precisely for this type of case.

Seeing how the Florida bar was so dismissive of good faith concerns about an unethical attorney who's causing real suffering for a family is beyond disheartening. I've tried addressing this with the chief Judge, my local state rep, state senator, and others. This is a problem at the core of the divorce litigation at least in Hillsborough County.

I've talked to enough other people who've experienced divorce in Hillsborough County that I'm convinced that corruption is a prevalent issue for litigants. It's allowing lawyers to break the rules to hurt people often at their lowest. I did not ask for any of this. The only thing I wanted since day one was some very fair reciprocal discovery. That's all I'm seeking now. It is Mr. Davis's unethical behavior that's the driving force interrupting and largely ruining a year of our family's lives. It's a problem for many families in the Tampa area that must be addressed.

I feel an obligation to publish extensive documentation about my case and all that I've done to protect my family from a corrupt process. Perhaps worse is the lack of any institution willing or able to help with an obvious example of attorney and even judicial misconduct. I've seen corruption and unethical behavior many times throughout my career. This case is the first one I've had where an attorney's entire litigation strategy (delay, obstruct, and harass to avoid discovery obligations) is in direct violation of the rules. It's quite obvious that even the decision to bring the children into the divorce was motivated entirely by the desire to avoid the financial discovery Husband seeks.

I don't view the correspondence to or from the Florida bar as privileged, but if there is some authority to suggest otherwise, please let me know. While I'm extremely frustrated with the bar's February 24, 2025 response, I do not want to break any rules if I can avoid it.

You'll also find a recent motion to disqualify Judge Ayers attached. I'm in the process of submitting a JQC complaint on her. There is additional conduct from Mr. Davis that will likely need to go in a separate complaint if this one is not reopened with an investigation that can continue through additional conduct all the way up through yesterday.

I have extensive documentation on top of that provided that I'm happy to provide upon request. Please let me know if you have any questions and whether you will be reopening the file for fresh and comprehensive consideration. Thank you and have a great afternoon.

Chris Hanson

727-409-5738

Good evening.

----- Forwarded Message -----

From: cahanson77@yahoo.com

To: ACAPIntake@floridabar.org

Cc: Christopher Hanson

Sent: Tuesday, February 18, 2025 at 11:42:03 AM EST

Subject: Bar complaint regarding Scott Paul Davis, FL bar #115540

To whom it may concern - please find attached a copy of a bar complaint form on attorney Scott Davis with supporting documentation. I have extensive documents and information I can provide. This is my first experience with a bar complaint in almost 20 years in the profession. Please let me know if I can assist or

if you are able to provide any estimated timeline. Thank you for your cooperation, and I look forward to hearing from you.

Chris Hanson

Please note: Florida has very broad public records laws. Many written communications to or from The Florida Bar regarding Bar business may be considered public records, which must be made available to anyone upon request. Your e-mail communications may therefore be subject to public disclosure.